

The art of be an entrepreneur

Third edition

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Marcos Constandse Madrazo

Author's edition, 2025

Third edition ©

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The master in the art of life
AND He does not distinguish between his work and his play:
work and leisure, mind and body,

education and recreation, love and religion; he
can hardly distinguish which is which.

He simply perceives his vision of perfection
in everything he does; he lets others decide whether
he is playing or working.
In his eyes, he always does both.

Zen Buddhist Text

Summary

Marcos Constandse Madrazo's *El arte de ser empresario* (*The Art of Being an Entrepreneur*) is a profound reflection on the moral and spiritual essence of entrepreneurship. Far from a traditional business manual, it invites readers to see economic activity as part of the larger cosmic process of evolution. For Constandse, the entrepreneur is not simply a wealth creator but a conscious agent of transformation — a participant in the same universal force that turns matter into life and life into consciousness. The book blends philosophy, science, and practical wisdom, proposing that the success of any enterprise must be grounded in the ethical and spiritual growth of the individual.

At the heart of Constandse's vision lies the *impulso evolutivo*, or evolutionary impulse. He traces this from the birth of the universe to the emergence of human creativity and work. Everything that exists is energy in motion, carrying information and purpose, and the entrepreneur continues this creative flow, shaping new realities through imagination and will. For Constandse, work itself is sacred — not a burden, but love in action — the means by which human beings fulfill their role in the universe's ongoing creation.

Constandse grounds his philosophy in what he calls the *imperativo ético*: "The other, like me, is an end of creation, not a means." Every economic activity, he argues, must serve human dignity and the collective good. Profit, efficiency, and productivity only have value when they uplift others. This principle turns entrepreneurship into a spiritual practice, aligning business with the purpose of evolution itself. Ethical intention joined with discipline and creativity becomes the foundation for both inner peace and social progress.

A particularly striking aspect of the book is Constandse's conception of the company as a living organism. Each organization, he explains, possesses its own DNA — a mission, vision, and spirit that must be nurtured for it to thrive. The entrepreneur's task is to guide this organism toward balance and meaning, ensuring that capital, labor, and leadership evolve together. In this way, the enterprise becomes a microcosm of the universe: a space where creativity, ethics, and productivity converge in harmony.

In the closing pages, Constandse shares his personal journey from self-doubt to fulfillment through passionate work. He describes how devotion to his vocation allowed him to overcome insecurity and find purpose, revealing that entrepreneurship is not only an economic endeavor but a path of self-realization. *El arte de ser empresario* is thus both a philosophical and practical guide — teaching that the true art of being an entrepreneur is, ultimately, the art of becoming fully human.

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Prologue to the third edition

Following the second edition of ***The Art of Being an Entrepreneur***, Grupo Xcaret invited me to give a talk on the DNA, mission, vision, and spirit of a company. The message I structured to share these concepts seemed perfectly suited to be included in this new edition of ***The Art of Being an Entrepreneur***. Thus, the third edition of the book consists of an introduction with the generic concept and philosophical foundation of entrepreneurship, what an entrepreneur is, what a company is, its DNA, mission, vision, and spirit, and closing with a biographical note that appeared in the previous edition. In the final pages of the second edition, I added some memories from my childhood and youth. The reason I included these biographical notes has to do with the distorted perception I had of myself: ***ugly, stupid, fat, and shy*** at that stage of my life, and how, over the years, my inferiority complexes, very strong in my childhood and adolescence, disappeared without psychological treatment. My self-concept improved radically simply by dedicating myself passionately to my work. Work gradually made up for my shortcomings, so that by the time I reached 32 or 33, I no longer had any feelings related to the complexes that had tormented me so much during my childhood, adolescence, and early youth. Therefore, I consider it very important to share them in this book as well. This is despite the fact that I define my other recent publication, ***And the Best Is Yet to Come!***, as a philosophical self-help essay.

When I wrote my previous book, ***And the Best Is Yet to Come!***, I realized that I included concepts related to my worldview as an entrepreneur that I hadn't included in ***The Art of Being an Entrepreneur***. So, starting with the second edition of this book, I've integrated those ideas with some additional notes.

This edition of ***The Art of Being an Entrepreneur*** expresses a philosophical and practical vision of the reason for being an entrepreneur, imbuing it with certain moral and personal characteristics that I consider most congruent with entrepreneurial activity. I want to emphasize that this activity is practiced by countless very different people. It is not possible to establish universal qualities in entrepreneurial work; however, it is appropriate to universalize the basis and foundations of this practice, regardless of the personal characteristics of those who practice it.

I believe that providing a ***theoretical and philosophical*** foundation for business activity and complementing it with ***the virtues*** I find most conducive to developing this practice opens up a much more complete view of business perception as a whole.

I decided to include some of the entire texts from the book ***And the Best Is Yet to Come!*** because I believe that the dialogue established between them and the content of this book enriches this new edition. In ***And the Best Is Yet to Come!***, these concepts are used to foster a full ethical awareness of business activity. For me, this profession is my closest example for transferring the moral principles of solidarity and utility that tend to seek the common good to many other human endeavors, as these are the ones that give ***meaning*** to the individual life of each of us. By accepting and understanding ***the fundamental intention*** of our decisions and actions, we can find inner peace, which is what is required for ***happiness***. In ***The Art of Being an Entrepreneur***, these texts achieve two objectives: to give ***value*** to business activity by attributing a meaning congruent with the universe and its evolution, and to complement it with the qualities or ***virtues*** that entrepreneurs must develop to be successful in their work.

I believe the publication of both books, ***And the Best Is Yet to Come!*** and ***The Art of Being an Entrepreneur***, is timely at this time, given that left-wing populist movements are delegitimizing business activity, as they did in the days of the rise of communism, and are attempting to revive the concept of ***class struggle around the world***, which is so damaging to the harmonious evolution of societies.

In general, people on the left (even idealists) denigrate the business work model, as they associate it with a boss (government, company, person, etc.) and a group of employees with “the ghost of exploitation.”

From the first to the second. There is no other way to generate production and true progress than through work. The famous punishment of "earning one's bread by the sweat of one's brow" is not a punishment; it's an absolute reality. If I don't work, someone else has to do it to support me. The government, which supports many, needs others to work, produce, and generate resources so they can pay taxes, which it uses to support itself and those who don't work.

The question isn't whether we should work or not, whether by divine command or as an acceptance of areality that compels us to satisfy our needs. This is where factors such as productivity, efficiency, the application of new technologies, and so on, come into play.

I don't see work as a punishment—I've worked all my life—nor as a sacrifice, nor as a form of exploitation, but rather as a means of **self-realization** that gives meaning to life. We are capable of producing what is adequate to satisfy our needs and those of others, and doing so sustainably and sustainably.

Today, more than ever, people need to unite, to integrate into communities and social structures that encourage those who have more to become aware of the shortcomings of those who have less, and that encourage those who have less to understand that work and education are the tools for achieving a better quality of life. We can be entrepreneurs, collaborators, and employees united to improve and optimize the world we live in with the goal of achieving **the common good**.

Thus, this paper attempts to clarify the philosophical and ethical foundations of entrepreneurial work, as well as the individual virtues and characteristics favorable to entrepreneurial activity, one of the many ways to "earn a living."

The pursuit of happiness through work is the ultimate goal of this book.

Marcos Constandse Madrazo
Cancun, Quintana Roo, 2025

The evolutionary impulse

The most evolved peoples are those who have managed to penetrate the knowledge of the world, which has allowed them to partially understand how that world works. Through the scientific method, observation, and experimentation, they have developed practical techniques (technologies) to harness the accumulated energy produced by nature for their own benefit.

The deepest essence of our being is **energy with information**. This is what quantum physics has **shown us**. We've made progress in this regard, as we've **realized** this reality. Although we don't fully understand it, **we know** it's true; what we don't know is what it looks like.

There's a theory that the smallest particles in the universe are vibrations that can be transformed into matter. Ultimately, we don't know how this works. What we do know is that the energy of the universe can **be transformed**, although it will always be the same. New energy doesn't emerge, nor does existing energy disappear.

But what is the essence of this vibration, which also contains information? There is something we can deduce: this **information** has a mission and a meaning, a **reason for being**. We can deduce it when we observe the **evolutionary process of the universe** and the trajectory that gives rise to us.

Our essence was born in the **Big Bang** and, over the 14 billion years that have passed, we evolved from particles in **chaos** (stardust) to human beings.

This is a reality that we cannot deny, we have **realized**, we have **discovered** that **we exist (I think, therefore I am, Descartes 1596-1650)**. We know what we're made of, what constitutes us; that's not an illusion or an imagination; it's a **tangible and demonstrable reality** that has no political, religious, or economic overtones. That reality is in itself the mission, the fundamental reason, the evolutionary impulse that we know exists because we are tangible proof of it.

But we don't know what it is! That's where different opinions arise, different ways of observing it or trying to understand it. So far, we haven't been able to **scientifically prove it**; there's no method that allows us to do so.

experience it in order to observe and deduce what it is, where it originates. That evolutionary flow that Teilhard de Chardin said would be **the spiritualization of matter, the natural tendency of matter to return to its origin**, there are some religious leaders and great thinkers who have identified it as the **expression of the will of the universe**, a will that is born from the **intention** to be what one is, and that will we call God. Around this enormous uncertainty of the origin of origins, of the creative principle of the universe, myths, religions, beliefs, ideologies, etc. have developed.

My position is simple: **I realize that it exists** simply because I exist, because **I am**. I call that **faith**. I am convinced that this ultimate reality exists: the essence of essences, the origin of the universe, which in short is **the reason for everything, its origin**. The Freemasons have called it **the architect of the universe**; in different religious traditions, it is known as Tao in China, Allah in Islam, Brahma in India, spirits in shamanic traditions, or God in Western culture. They all refer to the same thing.

So I have faith. Not the blind faith of ignorance, nor the kind that hides fear, nor the faith that denies reality, nor the kind that believes what someone tells me. I have faith in humanity, which has slowly come to understand, obeying our desire to better understand reality. Thanks to that **spirit**.

that drives us to change the world around us, to penetrate it, to master it, to investigate it, and to improve it. This is not to acknowledge that for some it may not be clear. Why? In what sense, and with what reason? My point of view is that humanity **already knows this**. What I call **the fundamental rights of man** were what humanity decided to recognize in 1948, and it is what we must all **guarantee** to everyone. I realize that to achieve this, we must have **the intention and the will**. I call intention applied with will **work**, and others call it **love**, although I also refer to it.

like love.

My vocation

All of the above allows us to understand from what point of view I observe my position and that of others who, like me, share the experience of **being an entrepreneur**.

I will try to explain some of the opposing positions that exist in the various visions of the entrepreneur.

Abundance, well-being, security and happiness

Socialist positions—among which is the communist one—are born in youth and even in adolescence. They are **idealistic** positions that arise naturally from dissatisfaction with the pain of observing **injustice**. See how in

the world's abundance is distributed in an **incorrect** way , it is outrageous. There are millions of people living in immense poverty and thousands living in immense wealth. There are people so wealthy that—if they so desired—they could pay the entire world's population \$10 an hour for 10 hours of work. While this act is good in itself, it would make no difference in bringing lasting well-being to anyone.

The important thing is to try to understand the difference between abundance, well-being, security, and happiness. **Happiness** is the congruence between **intention and action**; a happy person acts with **good intentions** and achieves **good results**. Now we know that **good intentions** are based on respect for the **human rights of all**.

When an idealist observes that someone has more than another, he or she considers it unjust, in principle, because it pains him or her to see someone **suffer** poverty while another lives in **overabundance**. He or she is right about the observable situation, but not about how he or she judges the **reason** for the shortage. The idealist always classifies this fact as an action **of the ego**.

of the one who possesses the wealth.

Jesus Christ knew that the premise of salvation and balance is “love one another as I love you” (John 15:22). In our modern version, the concept is expressed by **respecting human rights** as an expression of solidarity (of love) with one another, feeling equal, and feeling united in rights and obligations toward one another.

In the reforms that Protestantism proposed to the precepts of the 16th-century Catholic Church, **welfare** (well-being or happiness) is defined as the congruence between intention and action. Being right with God, Protestant **welfare** , is a reflection of physical, mental (moral), and economic well-being. The way to achieve this well-being is through the application of good intentions, what we call a job well done, work that generates **shared well-being**, which benefits **everyone**, not just a few.

The richest men in the world mostly provide the **highest-paying jobs in the labor market**, meaning they generate **abundance for all** their collaborators, employees, and suppliers. They do not exploit them, as socialists claim, who see wealth as the result of the “exploitation of man by man” (Karl Marx 1818-1883), who conceive of the entrepreneur as the abuser with the power and strength that comes with owning capital. Bill Gates and Elon Musk are two of the richest businessmen in the world and their companies employ employees who earn some of the highest salaries in the labor market. They represent the entrepreneurial model condemned by communism, as they discard the principle of paying **each person according to their needs** in favor of the capitalist idea that rewards each person with **what they deserve for their work**.

The questions arise: How do we assess **the quality** of work? What and who determines how much each person should earn? In communism, **everyone** must

earn the same because **everyone** works and **everyone** is equal. In capitalism, **each person** should earn according to the type of work they do.

In nature, we identify living beings with quantitative aspects and qualitative values that depend on their complexity and evolutionary level. What is quality at work? It's the energetic difference that each worker applies according to **their intention**. And what is **intention**? The energetic quality we call **knowledge**. And what is knowledge? It's the expanded vision of the world that is obtained through education, study, preparation, and the development of technical, artistic, intellectual, and other skills.

That's why we consider the right to education one of the foundations that drive a society's progress. History shows us this: countries progress by opening up and improving people's access to better educational options: better schools, universities, training and teaching centers.

Knowledge is the skill in the best handling of different energetic manifestations. We call **brute force** directly applied physical force, I would say primary force applied **without higher conscious intention**, and intention only exists when it is known to exist, when people have been educated, intellectually trained, and know that their effort has a **higher intention**. A **higher energy** knows new aspects of reality, which is why its intention is higher. When our level of knowledge is greater, we value it **more**, and we value it because it **has value**, because it processes more energy, possesses a higher energetic intensity, applies energy in a more refined way, and achieves better results in achieving its objectives.

The reason these companies are more successful than others is that they are focused on information management. They have applied a principle we've already discussed: **everything in the universe is energy and possesses information**. These companies manage the knowledge of the quantum world; they are the companies of the future, and their ethical governance could allow us **to fulfill** human rights at a level we cannot yet imagine. They are the ones that will truly put the immense energy of the universe at the service of humanity, the ones that can make it a reality that we are all equal, the divine mandate of equity: **to love one another**, Sri Aurobindo's (1872-1950) ideal of human unity, because we now know that we are all **energy with information**.

***Not everything that counts can be quantified,
and not everything that can be quantified counts.***
Albert Einstein (1879-1955)

With everything we have analyzed, commented, what we have seen, what experience tells us, we know that it is not by distributing **the money among everyone**. How do we solve the problem of **injustice**, but by distributing knowledge, giving human beings the necessary tools through knowledge that allow them to rise in the scale of appreciation of their work.

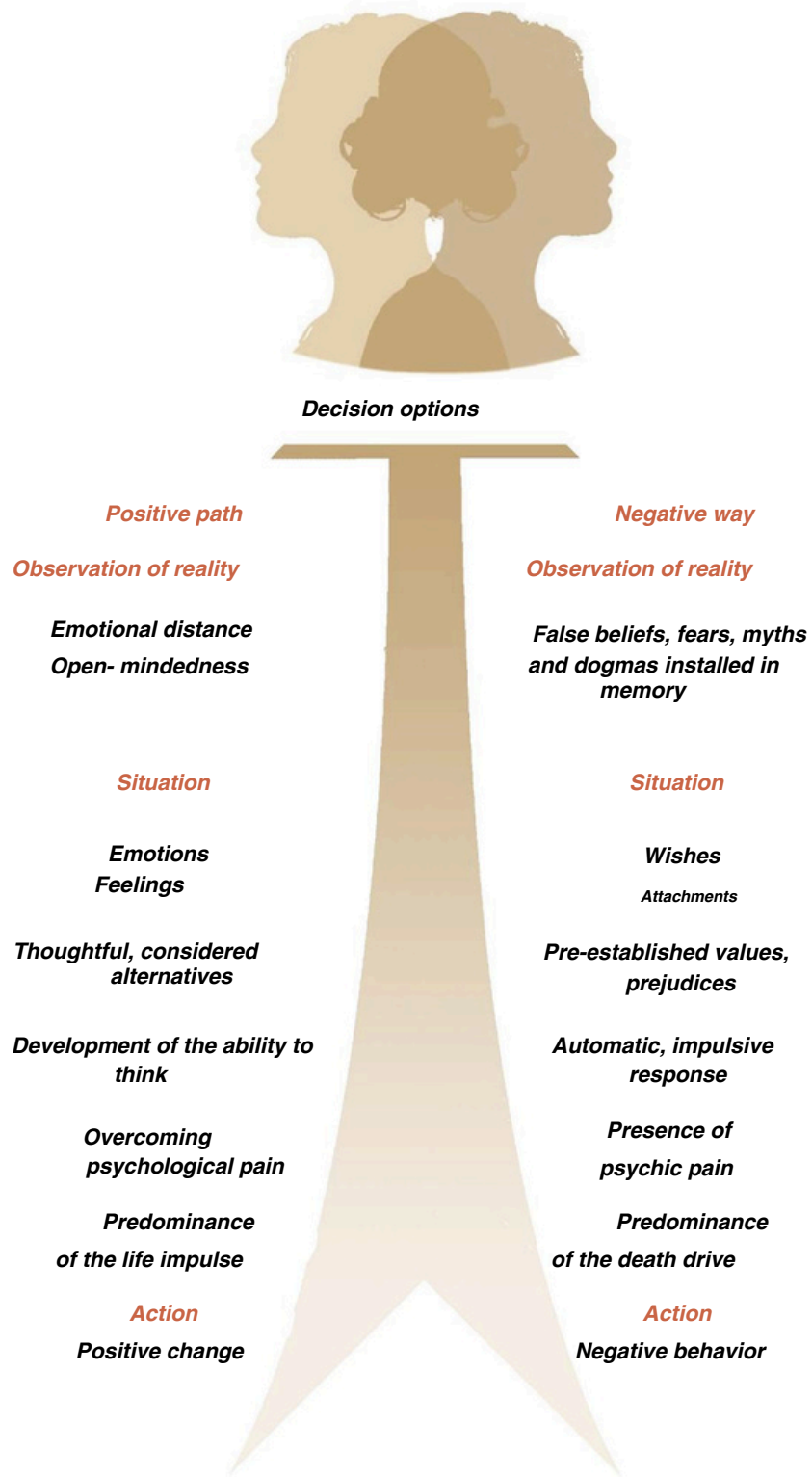
The communist system fails to distribute wealth because it is based on the principle of ***giving everyone what they need***. It sounds fair, but it doesn't work for two reasons:

- It doesn't ***qualitatively*** define what each person needs. For example, the Cuban regime defines 1,800 calories as the daily requirement for each human being to live, and its goal is to obtain the necessary calories to distribute them among the people via ration cards. It considers that this is what every Cuban needs, and seeking more is not permitted. ***Private ownership*** of energy is prohibited, and raw materials belong to the state, which is responsible for distributing them equitably among its citizens, as it does all goods and services. Some Christian fanatics believe that Cuba is fine because ***everyone is going to heaven***, everyone is poor, no one exploits anyone, almost no one works, and almost no one produces anything. They obtain everything from their scarce natural resources or from what their ***supportive brotherly peoples*** give or lend them, even if they never repay.
- Their idea that justice lies in widespread poverty disqualifies the qualitative character of the human being. Just as the ego is the main enemy of the capitalist who hoards abundance, so too is the fanatical and ignorant ego the main ally of the communist idealist. In both cases, the ego occupies such a large internal space that its self-centeredness prevents them from observing the reality of the world, the reality of others.

The fight of opposites

In the universe, two opposing forces coexist: one that strives for life and the other that strives for death. The ego possesses both instincts, and human beings are said to have the capacity for ***self-determination*** or ***free will***, meaning they can choose between the intention of life or the intention of death. We can also view this dichotomy as action and stillness, light and darkness, or ethically as the choice between good and evil. The intention of the universe is toward life—that is God's intention—but the tendency of the universe is toward entropy, ***passive equilibrium***: static things tend toward disintegration, destruction, and disappearance, so we can relate them to darkness and evil.

That's the struggle between ***opposites***. Well, the human ego, as part of the flow of the universe, also possesses these two positions: that of action and that of inaction, that of work and effort or that of passivity and inactivity. It is its self-determination that decides.



The psychoanalyst Melanie Klein (1882-1960) said that the human being, upon **realizing that he exists**, yearns **to live**, but simultaneously realizes that he is going to **die** and from there arises the struggle of opposites: the two primordial instincts that determine the acting, thinking, and deciding of the human being.

- The life impulse: which commands the **ego**: live, create, work, love your neighbor, give, participate, fight for the good of yourself and humanity.
- The death drive: which commands the **ego** to possess, obtain, accumulate, subdue, abuse, destroy, kill. Thus, the person becomes **selfish**.

That's why I believe that evil lies neither in the origin of the universe nor in the evolutionary process, but in adistorted personal or collective consciousness. Human beings have **free will**; they are the ones who choose, who provoke **evil** with their actions .

Socialist thought

When we think that all human effort has the same value and say that all energy applied through effort is equal, we are mistaken, since we contradict the flow of energy in the universe, where different vibrations produce different effects. Noise is different from harmony. But the ego asks, why do I, who do more complex work, deserve the same as someone who does physical labor? Why do I, who know more, earn the same as someone who doesn't know, even though I made the effort to learn, to study, to accumulate knowledge? What good is it if I get the same as someone who doesn't know? Then the person who works stops making an effort.

Communist systems destroy wealth by distributing it equally among everyone. Since no one is interested in making an effort because everyone gets the same, there are no positive incentives to generate wealth, which, when not reproduced, eventually dries up. The result is widespread poverty, although theoretically **everyone should be happy because everyone is equally poor**.

The ego knows how to distinguish between good and bad, between right and wrong, and knows that well-generated abundance produces dynamism, life, and movement. Energy drives energy; life is energy expressed in movement; it is not stillness or stagnation. A person fulfills himself best if he has the energy to fulfill himself, to **live better**. But for that , **work** is essential ; the universe possesses everything human beings need, but to have aclear vision of it, aperson requires intention **and** conscious **work**.

Without work there is no well-being, without well-being there is no happiness.

For nature to bestow its blessings upon us, we must apply knowledge to matter, that is, work. Therefore, when the incentives to work disappear, intention is diluted, and freedom—the ego's capacity to decide what it wants for itself—is inhibited.

I call the impulse that moves me to do something freedom. The self—my ego—chooses between one thing or another, between doing or not doing, between studying or not studying, between working or not working, and I am the one who bears the consequences of my decisions. In totalitarian socialist systems, the people lack freedom, because freedom implies choice, and in them, the State exercises total power to decide without objection what it deems best for each and every person. Freedom opposes having a single version of reality; it opposes systems that are governed by a single truth, where the only valid criterion is that of the State. Democracy believes in freedom.

Although social democratic forms of government exist, totalitarian socialism does not allow for visions different from the ideology of its leaders; it does not accept the **option of change**, and without change there is no evolution. Totalitarian systems oppose the intention of the universe, which implies change, movement, and evolution. And their solution is **to avoid freedom**, which inhibits the human spirit because they prevent people from expressing themselves and choosing their own path to self-realization. This is how we see the Cuban people today, who can only express themselves through their sensuality and music, fundamentally sensorial experiences. They would like to do so in their cuisine, but there's no food.

The businessman

An entrepreneur, a businessman, is **an energetic organizer**, someone who organizes certain forces and capabilities to transform them into objects or services useful to people, who produces useful things to improve human life, who produces and generates profits in the full sense of the word.

But what does **useful mean**? We know that the ego is part of the **soul**. The **self**, the **ego**, knows how to measure reality because it has a sense of time and space, which allows it to distinguish between what is **quantitative** and what **is qualitative**. quality; one refers to the number of units of something and the other refers to what something is made of.

The tool the entrepreneur has to carry out his work is **the enterprise**: the union of **capital** with **organized labor**, whether human or mechanical. The purpose of this unit we call an enterprise is to process energy to produce something: a **useful** object or service that responds to the impulse of evolution, that generates a change that gives us something better, something with more qualities, something the ego considers **qualitatively more beneficial**. The best is equivalent to the good; that's how we classify what gives us a better quality of life.

The main rights of every human being are: the right to life, equality, security, liberty, food, environmental protection, housing, education, health, work, recreation, culture, legality, freedom of expression, freedom of worship, etc.

I have been a construction entrepreneur, and my qualities have been that of a good administrator and organizer. Among other things, I have built houses. From my experience and my work, I observe that one of our human rights is the right to decent housing, a roof and walls that protect us from the adverse conditions of the environment around us: from the inclemency of cold, heat, rain, lightning, wind, and pests.

This simplified means ***four walls, a roof, a window (to let in light and air), and a door to enter and exit.*** In theory, this satisfies the human need for protection from animals (including other humans) and the elements. But I wonder: is that all we want? Even the most primitive peoples have it, even nomads who manage to move and set up their homes at every stop. This is where that characteristic of the soul, which knows how to distinguish ***qualitatively***, comes into play, along with the ego when it desires abundance and confuses what is abundant (quantitative) with what is good (qualitative).

People want more: windows, insulated walls, sturdier roofs, more lighting, electricity, bathrooms, and sanitary facilities; more rooms for cooking, sleeping, resting, and socializing; more privacy, a garden, a terrace... All of these spaces require light, doors, and windows; running water, drainage, heating, and air conditioning for hot weather... Sufficient electrical outlets, gas installations, internet access, a garage, closets, a storage room, bathroom and kitchen fixtures. And the furniture and appliances in the home: refrigerators, stoves, heaters, ovens, screens, computers, tables and chairs, beds, sheets, and blankets for sleeping; dishes and cutlery for eating; and many accessories such as tools, shovels and spare parts, plants and flowers, and alarms for protection...

To ***satisfy*** a human being's right to housing, what is the correct option? Four walls with a roof, a window, and a door, or the one described in detail? Who decides between each of these options? Who determines what each family, each individual, deserves? The answer is ***the market***.

Evaluating all the alternatives and choosing the type of housing that best meets the consumer's needs and capabilities determines the choice. The purchase of the product depends on the amount of energy a person has, expressed in the value of the money available. The buyer's ability to produce these resources depends on the type of work they do (the energy they process) and the knowledge they have accumulated to perform their job adequately: their educational level, their economic capacity, their sociocultural level, and the social security status of their country.

of origin or residence, etc. And the *intention*, the *inspiration* of your spirit to be better, to be worth more, to process energy better.

Satisfying the fundamental rights of human beings by considering the quantitative and qualitative qualities of the universe is a task of immense complexity, as is all reality.

An entrepreneur founds a company to produce something *good* for people, whom we call *consumers* because they *consume energy*. The entrepreneur produces *something* that contributes to a better life. Following the rules established by the market, he responds to the needs and purchasing power (money) of consumers, aiming to improve their quality of life.

The needs that the environment and worldview impose on the ego are often confused with an incorrect concept of *happiness*.

We have seen that happiness is the congruence between *intention and action* and has nothing to do with possession, which is merely stagnant, immobile energy. Satisfaction depends on how human beings, through their intention, apply this accumulated utility. Whether their goal is the good of all or selfish accumulation, happiness depends on that choice.

And that's where the collective ego's false belief identifies the entrepreneur with evil. Because it doesn't realize how the entrepreneur generates wealth. The collective ego assumes that wealth is born from evil, from the *exploitation of man by man*, or from surplus value as the value of surplus labor not paid to workers. True value lies in the useful energy possessed by an object that serves human beings' evolution.

When the entrepreneur accumulates wealth, he is judged from the perspective of the poor (who lacks information): *he has been successful because he is selfish; he has much more than he needs*. Let's return to the examples of the houses. To the human being who lives in the precarious house, what he has seems normal and sufficient because he knows nothing else; it is what he has and what he can aspire to with the income from his work. To the person with the surplus house, it seems normal because it is what he can acquire and maintain with the product of his labor. But the person with the precarious house, when he learns about the surplus house, desires to possess something like that. Desire is a primary need of the ego that drives evolution. Those who have less ask themselves: Why can't I own a house like that? They feel it's unfair, and this feeling of inequity (since we're all equal) is what power-hungry demagogues exploit to tell the people they're going to take what the rich have, redistribute it among everyone, and create a more just society, based on dispossession and unproductivity.

The poor and the ignorant often fall into demagoguery. Sometimes they are people of good faith who believe that widespread poverty is the solution to problems. But as in *misunderstood Buddhism*, they believe that diminishing desire eliminates need.

possessive but of use. I don't care whether the house I live in is mine or not; the important thing is that I'm living in it, I'm enjoying it. I didn't choose it to possess it with attachment, but to use it.

So, we must not confuse the end with the means. It is said that the end does not justify the means: a good end makes use of good means; bad intentions cannot produce good ends; negative intentions produce negative results; good intentions generate good results.

The company

There are good companies and bad companies, good companies are projects of good entrepreneurs and bad companies are carried out by bad entrepreneurs. Like all surrounding realities, the two coexist, occurring in the same time and space, but they are not compatible. A person's intention determines their product, as is clear when Jesus tells us: "**No good tree bears bad fruit, nor does a bad tree bear good fruit. Each tree is known by its fruit. Figs are not picked from a thornbush, nor are grapes cut from a briar patch. A good person speaks good things, for good is in his heart; and an evil person speaks evil things, for evil is in his heart. For the mouth speaks out of what the heart is full of**" (Luke 6:43). In the same way, Jesus tells us: "**Give to Caesar the things that are Caesar's, and to God the things that are God's**" (Matthew 22:21). I understand this as ethical balance and a clear notion of justice, where each thing corresponds to what is proper to it: the material with the material, and the spiritual with the spiritual.

The **spirit of abusiness** is to produce something useful; if it produces something useless, something that's useless, the market rejects it because no one buys something that's useless. A business is like a living being; it needs energy to survive, and if it doesn't receive the energy from sales, it suffers a loss.

We once founded a company that produced glass tiles for roofing. We had the knowledge, the capital, and the labor, and we started the factory. We produced a tile that, in our opinion, met all the required thermal, waterproof, and resistance requirements. We didn't sell a single tile; we filled the factory with manufactured tiles, and we used up all the capital, which was transformed into a product that no one wanted. We closed the factory and sold it to a company that manufactured flat glass. Although the spirit was good, the market rejected a product we believed in, and the company failed.

The market governs supply and demand, and once again, the collective ego, burdened by false beliefs, confuses and judges the market as incorrect, as the cradle of financial speculators, bandits (which some are) who take advantage of the consumer's ignorance and sometimes pass off bad as good. But the market itself is neither good nor bad; it is the practical expression of the consumer's will; the market positively values the company that produces.

goods that meet the public's expectations and negatively value the company that produces useless objects, which sooner or later disappears.

Let's delve deeper with an example: the wine industry. A company that farms to produce wine and sell it to consumers engages in one of humanity's oldest enterprises. It's based on agriculture, produces wine, and consumers buy it. Wine generates pleasure for the taste buds and the mind. In excess, it intoxicates and alters consciousness; part of the ego likes this (pleasure, escape, addiction, etc.). However, an alcoholic doesn't fully realize what they're doing, and we all know that. Those who get drunk know that they don't have full control over their actions and can kill themselves in an accident or even someone else in the accident. So, we have to ask ourselves: are the company and entrepreneur who produce wine to blame for the accident? **No**, the product is **useful**, it's good, but the consumer's use of it depends on the consumer themselves. If their intention **is to get drunk**, they are responsible. Those who have the freedom to **self-determine**, to decide whether they drink to enjoy themselves or to get drunk, or both, are consumers.

Here's another example: John used a hammer to kill Peter, so the hammer is evil, and so is the person who makes it. The intention of those who make hammers isn't to use them to destroy, but to use them to build, and practically all hammers in the world are used for building, except for the one someone decided to use to kill.

Wine is a pleasure for the palate, but in excess, like everything a human being eats, it is harmful; it's like saying that pork is bad because Peter died of indigestion from eating it.

in excess.

It can be very subjective to apply a value judgment to a company, since the true judgment, negative or positive, is given by the market. From my point of view, any productive company that generates **well-being**, that contributes to humanity's progress toward good, is good. The generalized negative judgment of a company is more emotional than real if it produces useful products that generate well-being. But well-being is not a fixed concept; it depends on the information we have at the time of production and our perception of reality: 70 years ago, white bread was considered highly nutritious; now we know that the whiter the flour, the more toxic it is to the body.

The capital

Reality shows us that the **capital-labor relationship** has served humanity's evolution throughout history, and the entrepreneur is the one who provides **the energy to make it work**. How does the entrepreneur contribute this to the company?

Let's first analyze what **capital is**. Money represents the energy value we place on an object; let's use the example of a \$10 bill as the equivalent of one man-hour of labor in a developed country (the one that best pays for human effort). Capital is a concentrated, moving energy that gives **life** (energy) to a company. That's why it's called **social capital**, as it provides sufficient energy or value for it to carry out its work in society.

Let's return to the company that produces hammers. They are very useful tools for construction and are produced in many different shapes, with diverse qualities and features, from many materials, and with a wide variety of uses and applications. They operate under several physical laws that combine intention and motion to concentrate force on an object. To drive a nail efficiently, you need a hammer. This is where the fundamental concept of **efficiency** comes into play.

What is efficiency? It is the most effective use of energy. We say an object is efficient when it gives us the best result in terms of its energy consumption. A motor is efficient compared to others when it gives us the highest speed in relation to the energy it expends. Efficiency produces the greatest amount of energy with the lowest energy consumption. This is a very important factor in understanding the economic valuation of human effort.

An efficient human being is more energetically productive than an inefficient one, who lacks sufficient capacity and, when applying his or her energy to work, achieves lesser results. Efficiency depends on **capacity**, that is, on the **quality** of the energy applied to work. Capacity depends on the knowledge a person possesses. The better the intention (will) and capacity (knowledge), the better the results.

That's why companies require trained and efficient personnel to produce a product. A good hammer that can compete in the market also requires high-quality raw materials and the necessary machinery to produce it efficiently. This is achieved by hiring good personnel, obtaining good raw materials, and using good machinery to obtain efficient results: useful hammers that consumers can use favorably and that are better than others on the market.

The first factor that an entrepreneur contributes to creating a company is capital, the accumulated energy that he possesses.

Another factor will be his own ability and work; he is the first employee of his company, who applies his effort, ability, and will or intention to create a business. In addition to his capital, he contributes his time and work to start it, to keep it going, and to gather all the combined energy required for production.

Another condition that the entrepreneur must comply with is the law. The legal framework of the country, state, municipality, and the location where the company is located, as well as the quality and safety standards, many of which are internationally agreed upon.

And the last fundamental factor for the company is the worker, the laborer (the one who acts with intention), who combines his energy to transform a series of energies into the production of something.

The worker

The worker has to meet some requirements:

- Have the intention, the will to work. A person who does not intend to work cannot collaborate in any company, and the employer must determine whether the worker is capable and willing to use that ability.
- Have the skills required to perform the job you intend to do. Returning to the hammer factory, a hammer handle is turned (shaped) using a manual or electric lathe. If the worker doesn't know what a lathe is and how to operate it, even if they have the will, they lack the ability or the necessary knowledge. The lathe operator must efficiently operate the lathe to successfully produce hammer handles. • Be as efficient as possible so that with the right effort, the right knowledge, and the right tool, they can produce the highest possible quality products that meet the company's intended utility characteristics.

If every skilled worker in a factory brings his best will, his best intention (effort) and his adequate capacity with the most efficient equipment (for example, electric lathes, not manual ones), the best product with the highest quality can be produced and put on the market for the consumer.

The consumer must know that the product exists, otherwise they won't buy it. That's the goal of marketing and advertising. The energy required to raise awareness of the product increases every day because the media becomes more and more expensive, making it very difficult to promote.

Let's look at an example: it's said that a minute of advertising can cost several million pesos. One wonders: why so much? The calculation depends on the audience and the energy the commercial conveys. If a show's audience in the US is 150 million people and 200 million in other countries, then 350 million people are watching the message.

If we consider that 1% connect with the commercial and drink a Coca-Cola that costs one dollar, that's already 3.5 million dollars that the Coca-Cola company's television advertisement generates.

Price is the amount of money expected to be paid for a product; it is an agreed-upon amount. **Value** is the amount someone is willing to pay.

Pay for something. Value is subjective, price is not. Value isn't based on anything inherent to the object itself. A thing is worth the emotional value one places on it, and price is the money one pays for it when purchasing it. Two people can value the same thing differently: one buys it, the other doesn't.

Let's look at a specific case: Lionel Messi, a high-performance athlete, a soccer player considered **the best in the world**. Why would a soccer team pay a player \$100 million a year? How could that possibly be good for both the player and the team?

Consider the number of people who play soccer around the world: 270 million children and adults play in the streets, in schools, and in parks. Plus those who watch the games: 4 billion people. What does it mean to be the best in the world? Hundreds of millions of people admire Messi because he's the best and the public wants to see him.

We all want to see the best, because that activity has the direction and meaning that defines evolution. **The best** results in something that attracts everyone's interest. Hence the passion for Nobel Prize winners, Olympic and world champions, actors recognized with Oscars or Emmys, and so on.

Messi is just another soccer player. What makes him exceptional?

- His intention: Messi lives to score goals.
- His genetic characteristics and the physical and mental abilities his nature gives him.
- His willpower: He does everything necessary to **optimize** his energy: exercise, nutrition, breathing, rest. All his training prepares him to be as efficient as possible. His spirit: It is said that great champions **have an unyielding spirit**.
- Messi has the tenacity and **consistency** to focus all his abilities on the goal he pursues. He has a spirit that has **the intuition and sense** to follow the path marked by his intention, which is to be the best soccer player and goal scorer in the world.

In short, we can say that the best player in the world, like any other human being who wants to be the best, must align the energy contained in their body, soul, and spirit. If they do this, they will succeed, just as everyone else succeeds in whatever activity they choose in life.

Dialectical materialism vs. quantum physics

Human rights consist of every person having the resources to obtain, achieve, and satisfy their needs. We've already touched on the topic of housing, which can be Type A or Type B. Type A can cost \$1,000, Type B can cost \$10,000, \$100,000, \$500,000, one million, ten million, or one hundred million. What makes the difference?

One of the fundamental human rights is the right to work and to decent and adequate remuneration. However, in almost 10% of the world's countries, a minimum wage does not exist. In some, such as Sweden, Denmark, and Finland, because wages are set between trade union cooperatives and employers; in others, such as Eritrea and Somalia or Qatar and the United Arab Emirates, because they have not yet legally established this right for the working population. However, in the rest of the world, labor laws guarantee a minimum wage, which theoretically is the payment a person receives as minimum compensation for a given period of work.

We've said that **good**—good deeds—tend to follow the flow of **evolution**. Evolutionary change is fundamentally a qualitative concept, not a quantitative one, but a quality one. That's why one product is **better** than another: a hammer can be good or bad, and that depends on the quality of the tool, not the number of hammers manufactured. So if we apply a purely quantitative view to the need for housing, then four walls, a roof, a door, and a window satisfy the concept, but if we apply a qualitative view, everything can vary.

When the socialist-communist system preaches that everyone should be given according to **their needs** and not **their abilities**, because it considers that to be fair, it fails to explain the meaning of **needs**. For example, the Cuban Communist Party believes that four walls and a roof, sometimes with water, sometimes not; sometimes with electricity, sometimes not; a pair of **shorts**, a shirt, shoes, going to school, and eating between 1,800 and 2,400 calories (the figure may vary) is enough. And if the people have that, they should be happy.

The origin of this vision is that its founders confused the **quantitative** with the **qualitative**, quantity with quality, and eliminated the latter concept from their analysis of reality.

This problem has very deep philosophical roots that come from schools of thought that were unaware of quantum physics.

We know that everything is made up of atoms, but we don't see them, nor can we observe molecules. We see the objects and organisms composed of them, but we are unable to perceive more detailed manifestations of reality because our senses have limits. We confuse the information our senses give us with reality. To gain a broader view of reality, we must use other capacities: the instruments of the soul (intelligence among them) and those of the spirit, which are intention and will.

Physics shows us that there is a strange property that consists of quantum entanglement between atomic particles, of which the atomic body itself Einstein was amazed, a property that allows us to think that energies with similar tendencies perhaps share similar information because they are found

vibrating at the same frequencies. Equals recognize each other because they are both the same; they have the same origin and a similar destiny.

The foundation of dialectical materialism, a doctrine originally proposed by the fathers of communism, Friedrich Engels and Karl Marx, in the 19th century, is that "reality has material existence and nothing exists outside of matter"; to understand it, they rely "...on the data, results, and advances of science." For dialectical materialism, ***ideas have aphysical origin; that is, matter comes first, and consciousness follows***. It only accepts the visible aspects of the universe, the physically framed reality that defines ***not*** the essence of things but their characteristics and manifestations: "The development of science definitively destroys the idealist belief that the world is based on the supernatural, on the spiritual."

They confuse the image of reality with the immense and incomprehensible reality itself: "...the world can only be known by virtue of its materiality and its objective existence in time and space... the fundamental forms of all being are space and time, and abeing conceived outside of time is as absurd as abeing conceived outside of space."

However, quantum physics has suggested in recent decades that what we call ***space*** and ***time*** are away of perceiving ***how much information is shared by*** the objects that make up the universe.

Quantum physics demonstrates that reality is made up of particles that possess information; everything is made of the same thing, so we can assume that an original ***reality*** does exist. Now, what causes this original reality, according to the theory of quantum physics? We know that it is a potential energy that is realized, that generates the vibration and information that particles possess, but until now ***we don't know what this primordial energy is***. What we do know through nuclear and quantum physics is that everything in the universe is motion determined by the ***information*** contained in the particles that make up the atoms, which constitute reality.

The quality of life

The ***spirit*** of fair labor laws must be one that allows workers to meet their needs and obtain their rights (social security) through their work (devoting their energy to an object or objective). In return, they receive remuneration (the payment of their wages) and the labor rights granted by law.

In its budget planning, companies must consider all factors, including salaries, health, retirement, and housing ***benefits*** (IMSS, Afore, and Infonavit in Mexico), and the necessary support for employees' livelihoods and progress. Therefore, some companies consider other benefits for their employees' well-being: uniforms, education, savings funds, food supplies, medical services, cafeterias, etc.

We believe that what workers **need** is both quantitative and qualitative. If my environment is poor and limited, that's my need, but if I have a broader view of reality and the options that can meet my needs, which is already common in the world of globalized information we know through the media and social networks, I'm not satisfied with the minimum and I want to improve my living conditions. Why do we want more? **To improve.**

To improve is **to evolve**, to exchange something for something of higher quality, it is the intention that sets in motion that universal will to change, and we have already shown that for that, to improve, we must apply a force: **work.**

So what is a fair wage? The wage that allows the worker to acquire four walls, a roof, a door (their reality), and the possibility of **improving the quality** of their housing. This qualitative drive toward a better quality of life is what communism **denies**. If a Cuban has an expensive watch, he becomes suspicious: where did he get it? If no one earns enough to buy that watch, it must be reported, because there are only three ways to acquire a luxury item: 1. he stole it; 2. he exploited the labor of many to have the surplus to buy the watch on the black market; or 3. it was a gift from a relative who emigrated to another country, a matter that must be proven before the authorities. If this is not possible, he is labeled a criminal in a country where **fairness is only what is essential.**

That is the part that communists, even some Christian socialists, do not understand, they confuse what Jesus said **regarding poverty of spirit and detachment from material goods**: "Assuredly, I say to you, it is difficult for a rich man to enter the kingdom of heaven, and it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter the kingdom of God" (Matthew 19:23), with which they forcefully affirm that it is impossible for a rich man to go to heaven, only the poor can enter it.

By forgetting the intrinsic **qualitative** element necessary for universal evolution, they unwittingly fall into the great injustice of communism: inhibiting and prohibiting individuals and their communities from aspiring to be better. Being better is being different from what I **was** before. Being qualitatively better is achieved as a result of studying. Learning gives me a broader vision of reality, enriches me with new points of view, and broadens my knowledge. Doing the things I do better, applying my energy better, qualitatively improving my work, having greater clarity of mind, improving the context around me, and contributing to the evolution of the world is what makes the difference.

Therefore, we can say that a minimum wage in any country should be the equivalent of a person's primary needs, basic rights, and income that allows them to achieve a **better quality of life** and educate their children better so they can **progress** and achieve aspirations.

We want our children to be better than us and for that we educate them, we train them, we align their energy in the direction of good,

We guide their intentions to be better than their parents. This desire is purely qualitative; it's a matter of reinforcing the energy they process by teaching them how and why, setting their life goals so they can later make them a reality, achieve self-realization. Aspiring to be better and surpassing oneself is something positive, something desirable. Education should be **aspirational**; it should foster the development of the best capacities of each individual and of society as a whole. In Cuba, children are taught to be equal because that's the right thing to do. If they're different because they aspire to be better, they're **aspirational** because they want to be better, to have a better life. And since that requires money, then what they want is to exploit others to achieve it.

The legal framework

The **law** is not established by the company, but **by the system of government**. In a democratic republic like Mexico, the people delegate power to three branches: the executive, the legislative, and the judicial. The legislative branch issues the laws and is made up of the chambers of deputies and senators (Congress), which are elected representatives of the entire population.

Let's compare two similar labor markets: Mexico and the United States, neighboring countries with 3,100 kilometers of shared border. Mexico was conquered by Catholic Spaniards, and the United States was colonized primarily by Anglo-Saxon Protestants, who achieved independence 30 years apart.

The hourly wage paid to a worker in Mexico is four times lower than that received by a worker for equivalent work in the US (1.8 **vs.** 7.25).

Why this difference? Although both countries signed the same United Nations Charter in the 1950s, each country determines its wages according to its circumstances, and our realities are completely different. Mexico is much poorer than its neighbor. Wealth is equivalent to the energy a country possesses or processes. The United States produces, processes, distributes, and consumes far more energy than Mexico, not only in quantity but also in quality. The wage reflects this reality: the United States generates and consumes four times more energy than Mexico.

The workforce must be valued based on the reality of the worker in the country where he or she works and must meet all the needs established in the International Labor Standards of the ILO, the UN specialized agency on labor and labor rights.

The market

Now, let's not forget that products are made to satisfy the market and currently the displacement of people (labor) and the transfer

The expansion of knowledge (technology) has led to the expansion of markets. E-commerce, financial flows, the speed of communication and information, logistics for transporting goods, and systems for preserving and refrigerating perishable products, etc., allow markets to become not only local but global.

Global trade requires product prices to be **competitive** worldwide. A hammer produced in Mexico must be competitive worldwide, both in quality and price. A company's production efficiency must take into account various factors that enable it to offer competitive products in the market.

Maquila involves transferring capital, technology, and raw materials (if appropriate) from a developed country (with high wages) to a less developed country (with low wages) to produce an object with cheaper energy, lower wages, and more relaxed regulations, and to make competitive products of sufficient quality for distribution in the local market and worldwide. Thus, our hammer manufactured in Mexico with foreign capital and technology will compete with one made in Mexico, with Mexican capital and its own technology.

The maquila industry has been one of the productive activities that has boosted economic growth in countries such as Taiwan, South Korea, Singapore, and Hong Kong. The so-called Asian Tigers also focused on educational development, the export of technological products, and the influx of foreign investment in infrastructure projects. Japan had already been ahead of them since the 19th century. In one of its history museums, we only find paintings honoring Emperor Meiji (1867-1912), who initiated the opening and modernization of the country. In them, we see how the emperor sent Japanese students abroad to learn about and bring Western technology (knowledge) back to his country. On the other hand, in Singapore, the history museum speaks for the entrepreneurs who founded the main companies: railways, transportation, steel, motors, etc.

Let's try to understand the career of a very successful entrepreneur: Steve Jobs (1955-2011), the founder of Apple, who upon his death left a fortune of 10.2 billion dollars (5.5 in Apple shares) and whose company by 2023 has the most valuable brand in the world: Apple.

Is it fair for someone to accumulate such a large fortune? In the capitalist system in which Jobs developed, this is perfectly justifiable, because it represents the value the market places on the wealth his company can produce. The product Jobs developed revolutionized the world of personal computers, both desktop and laptop, and later mobile devices with its cell phones. The market price for the energy generated by Apple is appropriate for a technological revolution of that magnitude.

There are exceptional individuals who generate changes in the realities of their time and in world history. Like Alexander the Great, Napoleon... or Steve Jobs. The **user-friendly** experience of Apple products, its constant innovation, its functional design, the connection between its different devices, and its privacy and security features make Apple a leader in its market.

Technology has revolutionized the world; we have access to almost all knowledge from devices, even at our fingertips. There are search engines like Google, where you can ask anything you want and it will answer, or applications that use artificial intelligence, like ChatGPT. Imagine what education will be like in the future! Past generations were taught in school to take advantage of their memory skills; now, memory is in the computer. Before, we looked for information in encyclopedias, books, even in the monographs we bought at stationery stores. Now, devices have endless data, articles, interviews, videos, etc. Today, we have to teach children how to use a computer and how to organize and use the information available to take advantage of **that knowledge**, which, if not applied to positively change the world, **is useless**.

The entrepreneur's vision

Where does the drive that gives rise to a business come from? There's a certain degree of **intuition**, that ability to perceive something clearly and immediately, which adds to a person's capacity to **create something**, to produce something useful, high-quality, and competitive. A business emerges from **the entrepreneur's vision**, from what the founder or founders (partners) of a company saw as their goal. It comes from the **intention and will** to do something, and what drives that movement is the positive part of the **ego**, that internal desire that arises from connecting with the **universal spirit of evolution**.

We have said that the entrepreneur is an **energetic organizer**, who combines capital with information (knowledge and labor) to produce something that is useful to the people who consume or buy it because they consider the relationship between the cost of the product and the benefit it provides to be adequate. This is what is known as the company's **mission and vision**, what we ultimately call **the spirit of a company**. When that spirit is correct, when it takes into account everything we've mentioned in this book, success is **almost** guaranteed. Almost... because there are **unforeseen** factors that cannot be seen at the time of decision-making. This uncertainty factor is called **risk**. There are unexpected circumstances, such as the consequences of the COVID pandemic in 2019, whose global solution was lockdown and vaccines. By locking down the consumer

At home, the consumption of various products and the use of many services that consumers didn't need stopped. Businesses that didn't have sales lost the **energy** they needed to keep running and went bankrupt.

After awhile, they had to close and lay off the workers because they didn't have the resources to continue paying them, so the founders and partners lost their investment, as the energy they invested in their foundation was lost, vanished.

The **risk factor** is something communists have a hard time accepting, because they believe that since the state owns the company and the company provides the workers with jobs, no one can question the justice of the model. The state provides the resources for the creation of the company; no one owns it; the workers work, and the government compensates them fairly. If the company fails, no one in particular is responsible; that abstract entity, the State, is responsible for assuming the losses, even if the production cost is required to be subsidized. The quality of the product isn't important; all that matters is that it's **sufficient**.

The case of Cuba

Let's look at Cuba's sugar industry, for example. When communism came to power in 1960, the country produced six million tons of sugar a year. Since Cuba only consumed one or two million, the rest was exported. This generated an enormous amount of money (and energy) that flowed into the country each year, as sugar was one of the main products produced there. When communism came to power, the sugar mills were expropriated from their owners, the Lobo family, of Jewish origin, who were considered exploiters of the people. From then on, the government became the new owner.

The company was left without **the spirit** that created it, because that spirit belonged to the founding owners and reflected the desire for change, for the company's evolution (employees, information, and energy-capital). It was then thought that simply by working on it, it would function by inertia, and the company would naturally reflect **the new spirit** of its new owners.

The communist spirit didn't consider quality, so there was no reason to worry about the product's quality. Cuba took its sugar off the market to sell it at a subsidized price (much higher than the market price) to the Soviet Union, which bought it in solidarity to help its sister nation of Cuba. Several things happened:

- The industry began to be **politically directed**, losing its purpose, since its usefulness to the people was not to produce quality sugar, but only unrefined sugar and deliver it to the Soviets (it was not yet known that standard sugar is less harmful to health). The production of refined sugar requires enormous energy.

- The enormous needs of the change of government reduced the resources allocated to the maintenance of sugar mills and processing plants. The machinery suffered the natural wear and tear that all equipment suffers with use, resulting in less efficiency and less production for the same amount of effort (with the same amount of energy). Without the capital to modernize the equipment, it aged and produced less and less (the empire was to blame for the unjust blockade it imposed on Cuba).
- Before creating the company to do it well and be competitive, the owners took the time to learn everything about the industry in which they were going to invest their capital and trained themselves to start and manage it well. Upon the arrival of communism, they sold five million tons of sugar annually on the international market, which they produced in their *mills* (sugar was then for Cuba what oil is today for Arab countries). The new owner, the Cuban state, knew nothing about sugar production. Its managers believed the money the owners earned was solely a product of **worker exploitation**. Without any knowledge, qualitative insight, quality supervision, and equipment maintenance, productivity declined year after year.
- Since in socialism everyone is equal and wages are based on need, not ability, the workers, particularly the sugarcane cutters (cutting sugarcane is one of the most exhausting and demanding jobs there is because it is done outdoors and requires perfect synchronization with the machete), when they realized they were receiving the same pay or salary as those who did much lighter work, either did not work at all, or pretended to work and cut half the cane they had previously cut. With less cane to cut, more cutters were needed, so as brothers in solidarity, even President Fidel Castro went to cut sugarcane with the **volunteer brigades**.
- Management lacking a sense of entrepreneurial spirit, poorly maintained equipment, and cane cutters who were cutting less and less sugar: lower sugar production. Of the 155 sugar mills that existed in Cuba in 1960, only 56 remained in 2021.
- When the supportive people of the Soviet Union began to suffer the consequences of their own economic crisis (1986), they removed the subsidy (the money they were given) on Cuban sugar and paid it at market price, which was much cheaper than due to the application

of new technologies in the sugar industry of other countries. Cuba declared an **economic emergency** due to the **empire's economic blockade** and called for solidarity from its own people, which meant less electricity, water, services, food, etc.

Communism

The purpose of discussing Cuba is to understand how the founding ideologues of communism (Engels, Marx, and Lenin) in their conception of man and society ignored the qualitative aspect of human reality. Although Marx asserts that reality is not independent of human activity (the sum of its productive activities), in its most popular version, **Marxism is opposed to the idealist point of view**, considering that reality is not a consequence of the spirit but the spirit of reality. In its time and from its different perspectives, the materialism from which all its theories derived remains with the vision of the dominator and the dominated and interprets the possession of wealth as the law of the strongest present in nature: the strong dominate the weak and kill them (like the lion the gazelle) or exploit them to enrich themselves. Hence the importance of abolishing classes. Once classes are abolished, **the underlying institutions** are just, and it is time to begin a fair distribution.

The formula they propose: **to each according to their needs**, which leads in communism (the utopia of abundance) to real equality, treats inequality of income or wealth between individuals as something relatively inconsequential. This can imply inequality in consumption, since some people whose “needs” are greater choose to consume more than others whose “needs” are lesser. Communism is about voluntary inequality; in capitalist society, it is about involuntary (forced) inequality. And it goes even further: in communism, the collaborative work and purpose implicit in social activism create bonds that foreshadow the future society of collaboration and even altruism. The primary objective of such social activism is... pedagogical: the learning of social cooperation, and only secondarily, the improvement of the economic conditions of the working class—or any other group whose interests are promoted in this way: gender, race, or ethnicity.

I insist, their definition of what needs are is very confusing and **the natural laws** they observed (the strongest dominates the weakest) do not contemplate what **the laws of human beings could be**.

In Russia in 1917, the injustice of the Tsarist system legitimately saw the people starving to death so they could live like the emperors and nobles who naturally deserved everything. They had sent soldiers off to World War I without food or equipment, and the few who returned had done so.

They were exhausted by the losses. The exploitation of labor was absolute, and the people, especially the peasants, lived in misery; the economy was paralyzed. After the revolution, the construction of the new communist system was very costly in terms of resources and human lives. Even so, the energy reserves in Russia and the efforts of the people produced anotable improvement.

Stalin's (1878-1953) ruthless force forced the people, through authoritarian policies and persecution, to follow the five-year plans and develop a collectivized agricultural economy and a heavy and machine-based industry, in whose efforts millions of human beings died. For several decades they managed to advance, and greatly, towards that "brilliant" USSR that took millions of citizens to university, hundreds of award-winning athletes to the Olympics, and reached space before anyone else... until its enormous inefficient bureaucracy and the poor allocation of resources after Stalin's regime stagnated economic growth in 1980, deteriorating industry, which became obsolete, uncompetitive, and faced supply difficulties.

The Cold War arms race and the invasion of Afghanistan accelerated the crisis from which Mikhail Gorbachev (1931-2022) emerged. He promoted **glasnost** —political reforms toward greater transparency and democratization—and **perestroika** —reforms that transformed the centrally planned economy into a market economy. Although some more humanistic Soviet leaders, like Gorbachev, allowed the market (the application of the law of supply and demand, which is how **nature works**) to prevail, they ignored the qualitative element and believed that human beings, **out of solidarity**, would tolerate differences in capabilities. **Ego** disagreed, and reality began to prevail: inconvenient military leaders, voracious new politicians, and the erratic decisions of then-President Boris Yeltsin led to the collapse that ended the entire farce of the communist system in the USSR in 1991.

Now, viewed without passion and, as they say in Spanish, **with hindsight**, we can think that communism produced **something positive**: it clearly and realistically highlighted that there was indeed a truth in the exploitation of man by man, and the **powerful** of the world, the capitalists and privileged few who wield power, **were frightened**, because the **danger** and **threat** of communism spread everywhere thanks to the anti-communist propaganda of the Cold War.

Since the Russian Revolution, the powerful have had no choice but to ease up, to cede some of their power to the lower social classes, to the workers. Thus began **the social struggles of workers' groups against exploitation**, and these pressures forced the owners of power and world wealth to share corporate profits with their workers. This led to the creation of labor protection laws in many countries, including what we know today as **the protector state**: "with the market as much as possible, with the state when necessary."

Let us not forget that at the beginning of the 20th century English children over the age of 10 worked 12 hours a day for 2 shillings (10% of a pound), which

They couldn't even feed themselves, and the state tolerated it. In this way, we must recognize that communism, even in its failure, bequeathed anew **state of consciousness** to humanity, a greater recognition of the contribution that **labor** makes to production, with the opportunity to better balance relations, what we know today as **labor justice**.

The revolution of consciousness

The 20th century, the century of **the revolution of all revolutions**, brings as its principal revolution **the revolution of consciousness**. In **essence**, we are all equal, with the same rights and obligations and the same human dignity. This is away of understanding Christ's words: **we are all equal, children of the same Father**, and the message of **love one another**, which has become a reality: last century, we went from one billion inhabitants to seven billion inhabitants. With the proclamation of human rights and the legal commitment of many countries to improve the living conditions of their populations (improvements in public health, nutrition, personal hygiene, and medicine), we are now eight times more inhabitants and produce enough to continue increasing in number, despite the level of overexploitation of the planet's resources. In general, we live much better than in the 19th century.

From my point of view, this is because this new consciousness aligns **humanity's intention** to be more and better, aligns human effort in the positive direction of the universe as never before.

In the 19th century, when there were only one billion people, the vast majority were very poor; by the 21st century, when we've reached eight billion, 15% of the population lives in extreme poverty, and more than 50% of the population lives **much better** than 90% of the population did in the 19th century. And the famous 1,800 daily calories required by humans are now consumed by 90% of humanity.

Although these are global data and the specific realities of each region and country in the world should be observed, **failing to understand the above is failing to understand** the reality we are experiencing today.

Consciousness: is perceiving reality, realizing something we didn't know.

Conscience: is the **moral** knowledge linked to wisdom that tells us whether something is right or wrong, the proper interpretation of that reality.

For me, this difference is fundamental, because the proposal of this book is based on the idea that the evolution of consciousness is the result of the **interpretation and true application** of what consciousness perceives. The analysis of **reality** Through science, we produce the knowledge that allows us to better understand human beings and the universal context. We realize what the

reality, what the world around us is like, how and what we are. Understanding the process of evolution allows us to draw **true conclusions**; **truth** is the result of humanity's drive in accordance with the evolutionary flow.

The right direction: the common good

We understand **evolution** as the change that moves us from one position to another in order to gain a better and more comprehensive perception. The elements that expand our capacity for observation and allow us to make appropriate assessments are quantitative and qualitative.

- Quantitative refers to the quantity of things or their parts, the number of units of the same object that we can observe in reality. • Qualitative refers to quality. I interpret it as the

difference between a particle and an atom. The atom is more complex; it contains more energy than the particle, since **it combines** the energy of the particles that comprise it. When particles join together, they create a new reality, **the reality** of the new atom, and so we say that the atom is **more** than the particle. This **quantitative** difference (sum) constitutes the essence of the **qualitative difference**, which allows us to differentiate **the true value** of things and actions (results) in the world.

Knowledge of their reality constitutes a people's **culture**, hence their **worldview** and the development of that people's **consciousness**. It manifests itself in all spheres of life, as in the application of technological innovation: by developing knowledge, their awareness of reality enables the application of that knowledge to improve the living conditions of their inhabitants. That is why we differentiate countries as developed and underdeveloped, or developing countries; the former are richer countries, and the latter are less wealthy countries that seek to live better, **both quantitatively and qualitatively**: to have a longer and better quality of life.

The European people were the **fastest-advancing** in their time, and the reason was that their historical process allowed them to accumulate more wealth than **potential energy** and more spiritual wealth, to refine their intentions, and to know how to best apply that energy for the benefit of the people. But we can realize that the evolution of peoples does not come about through the accumulation of wealth, but through the evolution of consciousness, which is what applies that wealth, that accumulation of energy, in the **right direction: the common good**.

A good example of this is Germany, which in the last century after the First World War, generated an **unsuspected** energy in human beings,

against the **utopia** of a better world based on nationalism, the superiority of the Aryan race, and anti-Semitism. For Hitler (1889-1945), the world should be dominated by the superior race, the German Aryans, and should be purified of inferior races and beings (Jews, blacks, the sick, gypsies, homosexuals, etc.). Hitler made the mistake of eliminating the quantitative aspect of humanity and focused on the qualitative. Unlike communism, he failed to consider that even nature evolves by generating species quantitatively, and in the process of natural selection, a greater number of individuals prevail in whom the best adaptive characteristics are present based on their ability and intuition: energy and spirit. And he wrongly concluded that by eliminating those he considered evolutionarily weaker, the best adapted would improve.

The combined energy of all, combined with the intention of all, is far more powerful than mere quality. Reality is simultaneously quantitative and qualitative, and this truth prevailed. **Fascism** was defeated by the **alliance** of those Hitler feared and those he despised. And we all know the end of history.

But that destructive force generated by the misdirected energy of Hitler and the Nazis, in its defeat, shows us that the **union** of the energy and intention of the majority was **the right path**, despite the devastation, the millions of dead, the petty interests, and the personal projects of the ego. The emergence of that **consciousness**, that awareness, was what engendered the spirit of the United Nations to open the **collective consciousness**. toward what is expressed in the **Universal Charter of Human Rights**. The treaty, understood **quantitatively and qualitatively**, expresses the **universal will** of humanity that, united, working together (properly channeling energy), respecting the rights of all, we may achieve an improvement in the quality of life for all peoples.

And quantum physics shows us that energy is practically infinite, **everything** is energy, what we need is to learn to harness it, channel it correctly, with **awareness** and with the **knowledge of how to do it**.

Capitalist republican democracy

Today, despite the successes of social democracy in the Scandinavian countries, many European peoples recognize that capitalist democracy and the republican system of government constitute the safest form of progress (evolution), where **the capitalist spirit** means the following:

Organize material and human energy under the laws (norms) dictated by a democratically elected government (reflecting the will of the majority), with the republican division of powers: executive, legislative and judicial, which tends to protect citizens from gigantic egos like Hitler's, by giving power to **the majority** (the diversity represented in society).

It combines wills, unites efforts, clarifies objectives, and when it meets **the forces of the market**, that is, of the consumer, where once again we are all represented, since we are the ones who choose and value the products on the market, it generates that duality of strength and intention, which is naturally **expressed** in the **will** to evolve.

Winston Churchill (1874-1965), the English statesman who managed to integrate the allied force that defeated fascism, said that democracy was a bad system of government "but that there was no other way." This bad part of capitalist democracy, among other things, is manifested as the waste produced by **the consumer society**.

The environment

We all wonder how, in a world that wastes and **throws away** so much food, there can still be people who are hungry, even in rich countries? This phenomenon, like the energy waste produced by consumption, is the kind of problem humanity must solve, because we now know that this waste produces what we now call **pollution**.

Pollution affects the **Earth's biosphere**. This surface layer, which is the sum of all ecosystems and where all the objects and living beings that constitute Earth's reality are integrated, "its reality includes the four kingdoms of nature in one, **the biosphere**."

Waste is the product of human **intention**, the intention to improve, but that initially appropriate intention can lead us to errors due to a lack of a broader and more complete view of reality. Previously, we didn't consider waste harmful to the environment because it **was so scarce**, it was only produced in a few countries, and there was a naive idea that "wise" nature would take care of it without a problem. But when many producing countries became involved and invented or discovered petroleum-derived products (fuels, gasoline, plastics, fertilizers, and detergents) or atomic energy sources, which produce hazardous waste that is difficult for nature to process, we began to saturate the environment with pollutants. By unbalancing ecosystems, we affect our planet's biodiversity.

With this, large-scale **environmental depredation** began. Predation has always existed in the world; since time immemorial, species have emerged and disappeared, often due to interspecies depredation or the depredation of their habitat or natural environment. Species evolve or disappear; they cease to be what they were before, becoming adaptively better, or they disappear altogether. This is the evolutionary process we have already explained.

The cycle of life naturally ends with death. Every living organism dies, and many organisms also feed on the waste products of dead plants and animals. Environmental degradation has occurred.

Naturally, throughout the planet's history, the fragile balance of ecosystems has found a way to change, to generate new adaptation processes toward new ecosystems. This has existed naturally for thousands, millions of years. But modern pollution is not an easy change to accommodate in nature; it is the result of the production of unnatural surpluses. Take, for example, the situation at sea.

The degradation of the sea includes two phenomena:

- With all the water on Earth flowing into the sea, much of human waste ends up there, carried by rivers or dumped directly into seas and oceans: fossil fuels, illegal dumping of toxic waste, fertilizers and pesticides; pharmaceuticals, nitrates, phosphates, plastics, fecal waste, and even radioactive substances. This pollution affects all living beings that inhabit the sea and marine ecosystems.
- **Overfishing** reduces the **number** of individuals of a species faster than its reproductive capacity. Humans extract more energy from a species than it can produce, and thus the number of units (energy) the species has decreases until it disappears.

This phenomenon also occurs in terrestrial environments: the conversion of natural ecosystems to productive systems (agricultural or livestock), soil and water degradation, deforestation, urbanization, pollution, climate change, overexploitation of populations (animal and plant) and the introduction of exotic species.

Knowledge of these phenomena alerts us to what ***we can do to ourselves***, since we are just another species in the fragile balance of the biosphere, and this has ***awakened*** a new ***ecological awareness***. This awareness has taken note and is now beginning to act, creating all kinds of ***ecological movements*** that are sometimes also very confusing.

Let me explain. The idea that nature is at the service of humankind is slowly changing to a new concept: ***everything is integrated into the biosphere***, which is true. But sometimes this concept confuses us, and we think that ***everything*** that alters nature is bad. This is the simplified (reductionist) idea of many environmental movements, which neglect the systemic assessment of the behavior of the environment as a whole, where the flows of matter, energy, and information are interlinked.

A sustainable vision of natural resources develops the ability to ***achieve sustained economic prosperity over time (for future generations), protecting the planet's natural systems and providing a high quality of life for the people who inhabit them***. Hardline environmentalists are mistaken and become enemies of what they claim to protect, since sustainable development (environmentally, socially, economically, and politically sound)

organized and applied), it gives greater quality to the environment. Although poorly applied, it effectively destroys; what we must do is move forward well, making good use of space and resources, modifying as little as possible and compensating with creativity, intelligence, and wisdom what is modified, always within the framework of a comprehensive, systemic, sustainable vision.

Holists consider that the whole is more than the sum of its parts; the isolated analysis of its elements cannot explain an aspect of reality.

Here's an example. In Texas, USA, there are large expanses of uncultivable, semi-desert land that support a natural population of several animal species, including white-tailed deer. Traditionally, they had been hunted for their meat (energy), their heads stuffed, and their hides and hooves. Overhunting was driving them extinct, so the government banned hunting them. Soon, and in the absence of their natural predators, their population increased so much that they became a pest species that destroyed grasslands.

The government then assessed how many deer the land they lived on could naturally support (energy production from naturally growing plants) and issued hunting permits to kill the surplus. In this way, the number of deer that can be hunted in the 180 natural parks in the state of Texas is calculated annually, and permits are issued to kill the surplus: a specific number of does and bucks in each location.

They now have a hunting industry that generates a lot of resources for park protection, environmental education, and tourism services derived from hunter visits. At the same time, they maintain an adequate number of deer and other species protected by the same type of programs. This is what we call a **win-win** relationship.

win, the environment is preserved and people have a better quality of life: sustainability.

As a human species, we have an obligation to restore the Earth's ecological balance, sustain progress, generate well-being for communities, and foster a more just and equitable relationship between people and the environment, which is the right direction for evolution. In short, to distribute the universe's energy in a way that fosters a higher quality of life for all living beings.

Development: five examples

If we observe the evolution of peoples, we can better understand their causes and effects. That's why, by observing the evolution of a region, we can better understand our own evolution.

Let's briefly analyze the economic development of five places or areas in the world:

- I. The European zone
- II. The United States
- III. Japan
- IV. Developing countries
- V. Cuba

I. The European zone

The European continent has been a melting pot of cultural exchanges, and its consciousness has developed through a historical process that includes several influences:

- The ancient Middle East (Sumerians, Assyrians, Chaldeans, and Babylonians), Egypt, the Phoenicians, and Jewish culture.
- Greece and Rome (whose values spread with the empire). •The Arabs (continuers of Greco-Roman culture).
- The Renaissance. •
- The Protestant Reformation (changes in Christianity).
- The wealth of conquered and colonized countries. •The Enlightenment and the expansion of knowledge through printing press. •The Industrial Revolution.
- The French Revolution (the republic and democracy).
- The Napoleonic Empire (which spreads the ideas of the French Revolution).
- The two world wars (human rights and the incorporation of women into the labor market).

What we observe in these great **revolutions** is that what is truly changing is **consciousness**; the process of evolution of consciousness is what determines the history of Europe.

This has been the impulse that Europe has developed throughout its history, ever since the Greek philosophers asked themselves: Who am I? Why am I here? and channeled the human spirit into the search for truth, to find the **reason for living**. Europe awakened to that search and continues to advance in it. With the Industrial Revolution, Europe was at the forefront of technological development, harnessing natural forces with the energy produced by machines, initially **the power of steam**, and then, in the 20th century, the super-energy of the atom. We can think of Europe's progress as both **quantitative and qualitative**.

And curiously, they came to know the true meaning of **freedom** when the ideas of the Enlightenment and the French Revolution liberated the creative forces of their population, when energy began to be distributed more equitably, when their concept of freedom (faculty of

do with my energy what I consider best for myself and others) was clearer.

Freedom is a condition of the **spirit**; the spirit **requires** self-determination to act; it requires its intention to determine the will, even when it follows the dictates of intuition. Intention requires freedom from the ego, and that freedom was restricted by the **monarchy** and the **empire**, which subjected it to what was **legitimate divine design** and the privilege of the monarch, even if it entailed the subjugation of the impoverished population, deprived of any rights.

From the dissemination of these European ideas arose the drive for independence of the world subjected by the empires of their time that also subjugated them, and at the end of the 18th century this drive became widespread and the independence movements of the colonies and kingdoms dependent on Great Britain, Spain, Portugal, France, Belgium, Holland, etc. began, which would culminate well into the 20th century with the independence of Africa and Southeast Asia, plundered to the point of ignominy.

They wanted the energy represented by their raw materials: gold, silver, copper, grains, tea, coffee, sugar, diamonds and precious stones, agricultural products, porcelain, silk, wool, cotton, linen, ivory, fur, dyes, etc., and the energy produced by the work of their inhabitants, not to be taken by the imperialist countries, but to use these resources for their own benefit.

And yet, what liberated the peoples of the world was the energy of the spirit and the natural human need for self-determination in freedom. The tangible proof of well-directed liberation was given to us by Mahatma Gandhi (1869-1948) in India, one of the greatest spirits of humanity, who liberated his people not through war but through the **pacifist** force of the spirit, civil disobedience, and peaceful resistance. Gandhi generated enough energy in the world to force the British Empire to liberate India; that is a demonstration of the force of the spirit applied with faith.

Jesus said: “...**if you have faith the size of a mustard seed, you can say to this mountain, ‘Move from here to there,’ and it will move; and nothing will be impossible for you.**” But what is **faith**? It’s the concentration of energy with the right intention. Faith is doing what I believe when the belief is appropriate. And it can do anything, but move mountains? **Faith** in science (in the study of reality) led us to understand the atom. Understanding the atom led us to understand **its power**, its energy (the energy of its particles), and to use that power. That initially led us to build the atomic bomb, and atomic energy moves mountains, destroying and building. Which shows that reality is **included** in Jesus’ message : faith moves mountains.

II. The United States

Let's analyze the progress of this region of North America.

Numerous indigenous peoples inhabited the present-day United States before the arrival of Europeans in the 15th century (Spain, France, Portugal, Great Britain, and the Netherlands). Native peoples lived in archaic, semi-nomadic cultures based on primitive agriculture, hunting, and fishing. The first British settlers arrived in 1607, and from then on, the flow of European migration became constant. They sought **freedom**, a way to break free from the will of kings and powerful people who prevented them from progressing or improving.

The Europeans, with a far superior cultural and technological development, brought the ideas of the Renaissance, the Protestant Reformation, and a series of advances that contrasted with the culture of the Native Americans. Although small in number at first, the migrating Europeans began to increase their populations by establishing towns and cities on the east coast of North America, and they had no difficulty subduing the original populations. Upon their arrival, the vast majority were poor and had to dedicate their energy to working the land's resources to produce what they needed to survive.

The **spirit** that had brought them there, the spirit of freedom they brought with them, prevailed and finally culminated in their independence from Great Britain in 1783. Their attachment to individual, family, and community work as a fundamental value developed a work culture that allowed them to steadily prosper. The American Indians never accepted working for whites, so these Native communities were increasingly displaced westward and eventually diminished in number or segregated into **Indian reservations**.

The trilogy of European culture, culture of freedom, and culture of work, gave rise to another of its core values: the right to property as something earned through the effort of one's labor. English nobles did **not** work or apply their effort to direct labor; they were hereditary owners of the lands and manufacturing workshops, even of the peasants and workers, who depended on their permission. It was from this dependence that the settlers who migrated to the United States fled; they did know how to make the land produce and manufacture all the tools they needed, since they possessed the technological knowledge and knew how to apply it. Furthermore, the new territories were theirs, having been taken, exchanged, or bought from their former owners (the natives) and made them their property.

- Culture of freedom: the right to channel their energy where they wanted, how they wanted, and for what they believed (awareness of freedom).
- Technological culture: accumulated knowledge of reality (scientific awareness).
- Work culture: they knew how to apply their effort, energy, knowledge and technological capacity (awareness of well-applied effort).
- Ownership culture: they knew what belonged to them by right of appropriation, acquisition or exchange (ownership consciousness).

The combination of these four **qualities of spirit** gave them **the freedom to work on their property with applied technology for the generation of wealth and well-being**. With this culture, they created the nation that by 1950 was **the most powerful nation in the world**, demonstrating that when **intention** guides effort in the right direction, **it generates wealth**. When wealth accumulates in a nation united by the same ideals, it produces enormous energy: the concentration of all accumulated energies. In its heyday, the United States integrated all the virtues of Europe and applied them to a vast territory, with its raw materials almost intact, and which it **harnessed** with a clear conscience for the creation of a nation. However, they made the mistake of not integrating the native populations and, later, the Black slaves brought from Africa (emulating the British who had exploited them) into their process. Situations of discrimination that to this day constitute major problems in American society.

III. Japan

In a process very similar to the one China is currently undergoing, the **Empire of the Rising Sun** transformed itself from a practically medieval structure into a modern society in just four decades, beginning in 1868. The restoration of the emperor as the country's leader, the end of the caste system, openness to Western culture, the right to private land ownership, trade with the West, the beginning of an industrialization campaign, and the modernization of the military would be the foundations of this development process.

Japan became convinced that the European path to knowledge was the right one. The emperors of the Meiji dynasty sent a huge number of students to the world, who, upon returning, applied their knowledge to benefit the modernization of their society. Thus, the country saved centuries in its evolution, acquiring the scientific knowledge accumulated during its time. Militarism and its imperialist project led Japan in the 1930s to fascism and its participation in World War II, upon whose defeat the new constitutional democracy was built with American intervention. Later, the maquila industry would bring the capital that allowed them to develop their own technology and well-being.

It is important to note that Japan is a capitalist economy where the quality of life of the population is based on quality over quantity. Their houses consist of a bathroom with **almost** a room: four walls, windows and sliding doors, the room (large or small) houses a living room-dining room-kitchen-bedroom that serves with its screen divisions for all activities. They have absolutely every service: water, electricity, sewage, heating, air conditioning; all kinds of appliances: refrigerator, grill, microwave, washer, dryer, food processors; all the high-quality, designer, elegant, beautiful, and functional kitchenware: porcelain, mats,

The fabrics, the furniture. They have the essentials, the necessary, and more, all in perfect order; everything is smart, even the toilet. Although their transportation is comfortable, efficient, and sufficient, their cars are small but high-quality: safe, durable, fuel-efficient, beautiful, and comfortable, which is why they are very well positioned, even in the international market. The same is true of their traditional food, which is simple, beautiful, tasty, nutritious, and varied, using a maximum of natural products—one of the tastiest and healthiest on the planet.

The Japanese are disciplined, hardworking, and thrifty. They stoically endure economic hardship and deeply respect their government (even when crises due to abuse or corruption are frequent). The monarch is a symbol of the nation and the unity of its people, as he has been for over a millennium. In short, although it is a country with a highly evolved civilization, it occupies small islands with over 100 million inhabitants, has almost no fossil fuels, and few natural resources, and is the third-largest economy in the world. It imports raw materials, processes them, and exports finished products with great technological value. Effort and well-applied work have developed one of the highest standards of living in the world.

IV. Developing countries

Although there are enormous differences between the countries conquered by Spain and Portugal and those subjugated by the Netherlands, France, or the British Empire, all paid a huge price for it, having suffered the exploitation of their raw materials and the energy from their labor for more than 300 years. This extraction of energy caused much of the backwardness they face today, as they have had to redirect their strength and energy through processes of independence, civil wars, dictatorships, and misgovernment that still keep them reeling today.

Pre-Hispanic America was conquered, not colonized. The wars of conquest and the subjugation of indigenous peoples disrupted the development of indigenous cultures and imposed the conquistadors' way of life. Although initially they were adventurous soldiers, the conquistadors brought the Catholic religion, followed by Spanish administration and culture, with its vices and virtues: new technologies and tools, a society divided into distinct classes (nobles, clergy, and indigenous communities), well-being in the hands of a few, and resources flowing to mainland Spain. The devaluation of work and wealth: ***work is a divine punishment, and wealth confuses and distances believers from the values of poverty inherent in Catholicism.*** This misconception of who produces surplus (wealth) and the way in which it is produced (work) is a mental obstacle we have not yet been able to overcome.

But the backwardness of Third World or developing countries isn't only due to the methods imposed by the imperial countries that conquered us; there are reasons that are our own. One example is **corruption**, the concept that **power is for the benefit and abuse of those without it**. Latin American politicians and their associates, for the most part, steal in multiple ways:

- Employing family members or friends even if they do not have the necessary knowledge or profile for the job assigned to them.
- Granting concessions (mining, highways, gas stations, energy production, etc.) and contracts for goods and services to those who receive a percentage (bribe).
- Obtaining a percentage of the raw material they consume. •Receiving benefits (trips, meals, gifts) from those who favor.
- Approving contracts unfavorable to the government and favorable ones to people or companies.
- Forcing the authorities under their command (police, judges, etc.) to extort money from the population, which will then be distributed up the chain of command. • Accepting false invoices for materials and services that never arrive that are never granted.
- Rigging competitions and bidding for products and services. • Overcharging or undercharging for services and permits: construction licenses, operating licenses, driving licenses, transit permits, import permits for sanitary or health regulations, etc. •Selling justice to the one who pays the most. •Tolerating theft, kidnapping, kidnapping, blackmail for work, etc., in exchange for payment or participation in the business. •Favoring political or personal friends in exchange for benefits.
- Selling the passage of laws that favor individual or group interests. • Using **power** to pressure the press and the media communication.
- Preventing corrupt officials from going to jail.
- Speculating on privileged information to capitalize on the capital gains of land or properties for themselves or their relatives. •...etc.

V. Cuba

It would seem that Cuba is the subject of this book, but it is not. It is mentioned because it is a model of socialist communism that makes evident the fundamental weaknesses of this system. Also because it lives a paradox: it is one of the

the poorest people in the world, even though today the Cuban people are not dying of hunger, as is the case in Sudan, Mali or Haiti, nor are they experiencing the social chaos that those countries suffer.

In Cuba, even poverty is orderly and there is respect among its citizens. What is lacking is production; no one works hard. The work done is merely to achieve **survival**: four walls, a roof, a window, a door, and the required 1,800 calories. Until recently, it was thought that the US embargo was the cause of the economic paralysis; however, today Cuba maintains trade relations with many countries, including the US.

The blockade hasn't only affected the island's economy; the human rights crisis is the most important factor in improving relations between the two governments: terrorism, drug trafficking, immigration fraud, and human trafficking. The underlying reason for the crisis is that Cuba produces almost nothing because there are no incentives to work or the freedom to do so, so people don't want to work. If the government owns everything, as it was the nobles and clergy in medieval times, no one has the freedom to produce for their own benefit.

Work is how nature and the world evolve, improve, and grow in number and quality: without work, there is no production; without production, there is no wealth. That's why Cuba's trade balance is so negative. Its openness to foreign investment in tourism is proof that it can be done. But Cuba has almost nothing to trade with other countries; it doesn't allow private **initiative, private property**, or freedom of opinion or action. And this book shows, through the knowledge provided by quantum physics, that those **values** that are not permitted in Cuba are precisely those that produce the surpluses that accumulate wealth in capitalist countries and raise people's standard of living.

One wonders, if Cuba produces almost nothing (a minimum of livestock, agriculture, seafood, and raw materials like tobacco and rum), where does the government get the energy (the money) for the four walls with a roof, for the shoes, the t-shirts, the few medicines, the terrible transportation, the limited electricity, water, and minimal maintenance? And we see that it gets it from:

- Remittances in dollars sent by exiles from the U.S. • Income from tourism and hotels, which, although largely operated by foreign companies, the government owns the infrastructure and hotels and charges them rent.

By 2023, they had 80,000 rooms with an average occupancy of 50% in various categories. This industry was highly criticized in its origins, because it could contaminate the population by seeing how the capitalist tourists lived, but it has worked well for them to compensate for the Russian subsidy. Furthermore, Cuban workers in the industry (approximately 1.5 million) fight to work in contact with the

tourists for the possibility of receiving tips and small gifts.

- The entry of solidarity aid from the towns.
- The very low-priced oil and gasoline subsidies provided by supportive countries like Venezuela, Mexico, and Russia. •The export of healthcare services at very high prices, with healthcare professionals receiving a small portion and the Cuban government retaining the surplus "to continue training doctors and nurses." •Loans that are later forgiven by these **countries**.

supportive brothers.

It's worth clarifying that sister countries of solidarity do exist, and they are generally "learners" of the communist system, grateful for the model and technological information needed to **efficiently** implement communist methods of government. It's not easy to change the worldview from receiving a salary proportional to one's effort and ability to receiving an **equitable** salary based on each person's needs, which are determined by the State. This requires a very consistent and manipulative demagogic and propaganda strategy.

But this book is not intended to be a treatise on Cuban history or evolution; it aims to share knowledge and raise awareness through the realization that scientific knowledge—if human beings understand the significance of its discoveries—sets a course and gives meaning to life. Nor does it intend to pass judgment on the historical process of peoples. The analysis of its evolution and practical results allows us to glimpse how the expression of the forces of nature is also found in the development of nations.

A strange case: China

It is important to understand that knowledge of reality involves enormous potential energy, but if it is not applied, if that force is not harnessed through the possibility of work, it is **wasted energy**.

There's no point in investing in training an engineer to eventually become a taxi driver, because training a good taxi driver is much cheaper than training an engineer. But for a nation to progress (as it is today in China), it requires that **the spirit of the people**, the **intention** of that people and their government, their conscience, be oriented toward progress, toward the desire for **a better quality** of life, surpassing the mere instinct to live and survive.

China is a true mystery and a miracle that is astonishing the world. In 1912, the situation of instability and poverty, coupled with administrative corruption and the abuses of the nobility in the Chinese imperial government, forced the last emperor to abdicate.

Everything was for the emperor .

and the surrounding aristocracy, and **nothing** for the people who were literally starving. After a period of instability and a failed attempt at a republic, in 1949 Mao Zedong (1893–1976) led the country towards communism with the establishment of the People's Republic of China.

Following Mao's death, the country shifted toward a market economy with a state capitalist approach. Although the government remained in the hands of a single party, the Chinese Communist Party, headed by General Secretary Deng Xiaoping (1904–1997), who served as China's supreme leader.

It is a dictatorship focused on the well-being and progress of society through work, which has lifted more than 500 million people out of poverty and into a consumer society. In China, there are state-owned (strategic), collectively owned, and privately owned enterprises. The generation and accumulation of wealth is permitted, but without proper respect for human rights, as information, surveillance, and the control of population behavior are tightly regulated by the government.

It is very complex to understand what its inhabitants can enjoy, because they are creating something that we could consider the **most advanced** country of the world of the last 50 years, with zero tolerance for freedom of expression and thought. They live in a culture where use is valued more than possession: my house is mine for 100 years, but the property belongs to the government even if I can rent or sell the right to use it. The government doesn't lose actual ownership; use is **equivalent to private property**. And the same pattern is repeated in practically everything: the government reserves what it considers **strategic** for the functioning of the country, but allows the **usufruct** to be enjoyed by the person who **produces it**.

To deny China's immense progress—the productive force of its 700 million working people—is **to deny reality**. I consider it an obligatory exercise for the West to try to understand, to comprehend, China's evolutionary process: what does it want? Where is it going? Understanding it fairly, carefully, and appropriately, to make it an ally, can generate mutual benefits for the development of humanity.

The **hard data**

Now, we will try to demonstrate our ideas with statistical data on some of the topics we have mentioned in our writing.

We have said that organized and efficient work with the correct intention is what produces the well-being of the inhabitants of a country.

First principle: wealth produces well-being

When wealth is distributed **correctly**, it produces **shared well-being**. and shared well-being produces peace, tranquility, security and resources for

satisfy all the needs demanded by **universal human rights**.

Three statistical indices confirm this idea:

1.- The gross domestic product (GDP)

This measures a country's entire production: the monetary value of all goods and services produced by a country or region. These include agricultural, industrial, forestry, energy (oil, gas, gasoline, electricity, etc.), and services (transportation, tourism, restaurants, healthcare, education, etc.). Everything produced by companies or individuals in the formal economy, where intention (direction) and willpower applied to effort (work) are combined to obtain a **useful object or service**. By measuring the Gross Domestic Product, we measure **a country's capacity to produce wealth**.

The formula is:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{intention (direction) + will} \\ & + \text{effort} = \\ & \text{Production} \\ & = \text{Wealth} \end{aligned}$$

The sum of these three factors generates production and production wealth.

2.- Per capita income (CPI)

This index tells us the **average** income of people living in a country over a given period of time. It also tells us the monetary value of the wealth generated through labor distributed among the working population.

Since it is an average, it does not determine what each person receives, as some will receive less and others more, but it does speak to the average capacity for consumption of goods and services (in quantity and quality) that a person can acquire.

A country with many inhabitants can produce more **quantitatively** than another with fewer inhabitants, but when dividing the production among the inhabitants, the factor can be modified, much among many can be less than little among few: **$1,000 / 1,000 = 1$ (1,000 million / 1,000 people) = 1 million per person**

$$10 / 2 = 5$$

$$(10 \text{ million between 2 people}) = 5 \text{ million per person}$$

Therefore, the **per capita** income index is based on dividing production by the population.

3.- The human development index or happiness index (HDI)

It measures the happiness of the people of a country or region. The **Gross National Happiness** indicator is multidimensional and encompasses nine domains: well-being, health, time use, education, cultural diversity and resilience, good governance, community vitality, ecological diversity, and quality of life.

The result may be a little subjective since the measurement is more comprehensive (holistic) and psychological, but sampling allows for a very close assessment of reality.

There are many interesting development indices to analyze, one of which is the number of patents a country issues. A patent is a right to the exclusive use and commercialization of an invention derived from applied knowledge. When something new is discovered that is *useful*, something that can be used both quantitatively and qualitatively, this invention acquires value, and the patent guarantees the right to use and commercialize it in accordance with the law.

In other words, when sensory experience (intuition) is combined with intention (derived from scientific and technical knowledge of reality) and the will to achieve it (work), a discovery (an invention) can be generated. Discoveries develop products that help improve people's quality of life and thus generate wealth (concentrated energy).

We selected data from five countries with contrasting statistics: the United States, Finland, Mexico, Cuba, and Haiti. It's interesting to observe the differences because, while Haiti is theoretically a democratic, parliamentary, and capitalist country, it's much worse off than Cuba, being communist; and Finland, a country with a capitalist parliamentary social democracy (I would call it a democratic humanist capitalism), is at the highest levels of development.

<i>Country</i> 2022	<i>GDP (annual)</i> One billion USD	<i>PP consumption in households</i> USD	<i>IDH</i> place
USA	25,462.70	52,127.28	21st
Finland	280.83	26,334.27	11th
Mexico	1,414.19	8,220.91	86th
Cuba	107.35	4,808.86	83rd
Haiti	20.25	1,778.61	163rd

In the two World Bank graphs (GDP and CPPH [datos.bancomundial.org/indicador/](https://datos.bancomundial.org/indicador/NE.CON.PRVT.CD)

NE.CON.PRVT.CD), there is a perfectly clear relationship between a country's production and the distribution of average income between consumption per person, but when observing the places they occupy in the human development index, we can see how well-being does not significantly affect the populations of Mexico and Cuba, and in the case of Haiti, the situation is much worse.

The origin of Haiti's situation lies in the *culture of slavery* to which the island was subjected by French colonizers. It was France's most important colony in the 18th century, producing half the world's sugar and coffee and providing the largest market for the slave trade.

More than half of the enslaved people were African and worked in the

Plantations. Slavery in Haiti generated one of the cruelest cultures ever invented by humankind. The landowner owned **his** workers, whom he could sell, beat, rape, and whip at will. Slaves had no "human rights" whatsoever, and their average lifespan was 21 years.

In 1791, the subjugated population revolted, initiating Haiti's independence and becoming one of the first countries in the Americas to abolish slavery. Its leader, Toussaint Louverture (1743-1803), was a slave who led 50,000 other slaves to rise up against their owners, landowners, and the country that had subjugated them: France. They burned plantations, burned cities, and massacred the white population in revenge against their slave owners. We might think this was **justified**, but **violence and abuse beget violence and abuse**, and Haiti has been unable to break out of this vicious cycle in more than two centuries. Its greedy and corrupt leaders, whether elected or dictators, have been unable to overcome this "tradition." An example of this was **Papa Doc** and **Baby Doc**, father and son dictators who exercised power for 30 years in the mid-20th century with **violence and abuse** of hunger, terror and **voodoo** (a pseudo-religion of African origin).

Second principle: the greater the energy use, the better the quality of life

Another way to confirm our positions is to look at global oil production and see how it is consumed around the world.

Fossil fuel production (energy derived from petroleum) has grown from 3 million barrels per day in 1930 to 33 million in 2012 and 94 million in 2020. We can see that the most developed countries consume more oil than the less developed ones: In the United States, 3.2 billion liters are consumed

per day, which, distributed proportionally among 338 million inhabitants, gives us a per capita consumption of 9.4 liters per day. This adds electricity, plus all the other energies consumed in the US. While in Finland, each person consumes 5.44 liters of fossil fuels per day, developing countries such as Mexico and India consume 2.6 liters per capita per day in Mexico and 0.72 liters per capita per day in India.

• **United States** •
Finland •
Mexico •
India

9.54 liters/per inhabitant/per day
5.44 liters/per inhabitant/per day
2.6 liters/per inhabitant/per day
0.72 liters/per inhabitant/per day

This reflects that the more developed a country's standard of living, the more energy each of its inhabitants consumes or processes. Although there are no verifiable statistics, it is estimated that the Cuban population consumes 0.52 liters/per capita/per day, so the consumption ratio of a poor country to a rich country can have an enormous difference.

The greater the human energy exchange, the better the living conditions. This **proves** that when human beings flow with the rules of nature (of evolution) and progress from the simple to the complex, their energy consumption generates greater well-being.

In all of this, it is very important to view human beings as **consumers and energy exchangers**. When people eat, they transform the energy produced by plants (which in turn transform the energy produced by the sun), and when they transform that energy through their intention-will-work into useful things, human beings **fulfill their transformative function**. This is how humanity is part of that mandate, that universal will manifested in evolution. When leaders encourage freedom of spirit, promote work, and seek justice, as has been the case in Finland, that is when the best results are achieved.

The happiness index

At this point, very interesting questions arise: Why is Finland, with lower per capita wealth, happier than the United States? Finland, being a parliamentary-capitalist democratic republic, has found a way to **distribute** wealth more fairly: it has a functioning economy that allows the population to pay high taxes that entirely serve to fund **a social welfare state**.

Like all Nordic countries, which rank highest in the happiness indexes, Finland inherits the "Viking" culture, in which leaders (kings) were not chosen based on ethnic origin, nor did they inherit a divine right legitimized by "the Pope" as is the case with Catholic Europeans. Positions were earned through strength and leadership (solidarity) exercised over their community. The **merits** of a good warrior, brave and supportive, allowed them to challenge the king in turn to see who was **the best** leader. Being a king was not a matter of inheritance but of ability and leadership in the community.

The countries of continental Europe and the British Isles (England, Ireland, and Scotland), on the other hand, inherited the culture of Imperial Rome. The right to exercise power through hereditary means destroyed the Roman Republic and also prevented European kingdoms and principalities from exploiting the best qualities of their people through meritocracy (rule by those worthy of their abilities). Monarchy and absolutism allowed a **useless king**, incapable of governing but a king by inheritance and divine right, to exercise power. He, in alliance with the clergy and other nobles, dispossessed serfs and slaves, also by divine right. This generated a caste culture, a culture of social class superiority, and the legitimization of slavery.

Upon its independence, the United States inherited the **mistakes** of its colonizers, and to correct them it had to live through not only a civil war but a whole series of social struggles to recognize the rights of women, African Americans and minorities (universal human rights), the same

which continue to reproduce themselves in conflicts and social differences that are still far from resolved. This is why the United States, while one of the richest countries, is not one of the happiest.

Haiti's independence was born from a force imbued with a "thirst for revenge": the revenge of the enslaved against their enslaver, who doesn't even recognize the quantitative value of **humanity** in others. It wasn't driven by a positive ideal; only the need to free themselves from the yoke was what allowed them to shake off the slave regime. But the negative energy of revenge and violence has remained to this day, unlike in the United States, where American liberals, idealistic in a different way, have constantly fought to eradicate inherited vices.

Idealism and fanaticism

Why are Cuba's leaders, who have led it to the poverty in which its population lives today, so popular among Latin American idealists? I believe the answer has to do with their **initial intention**

It was good. They overthrew the dictatorship that was stifling the people in poverty and "liberated" them from the capitalist yoke. They gave them **freedom within the dictatorship**, driven by a sense of justice. Once in power, close to the communist system (the USSR was the example), they inherited the mistakes of the founders of the Soviet Union by eliminating the qualitative factor from everyday reality.

Why has Ernesto **Che** Guevara (1928-1967) always been a symbol of Latin American idealists? **Che** Guevara didn't fit into the Cuban bureaucratic structure; he went to Bolivia to continue "making the revolution" and die trying. Idealists around the world generally don't fare well; they suffer and die for their ideals, especially when their ideas **fanaticize them**.

Fanaticism causes passion **to cloud** reason and prevent clear observation of reality and analytical thinking. People become fanatic because they place their **faith** in what they believe and convince themselves that this is the only form of truth; at that moment, they lose objectivity and eliminate internal and external dialogue. For the fanatic, there is only one path: the one they believe in and are willing to give their life for. Therefore, they must eradicate **the freedom of thought of the good people**.

Fanaticism is a model where **the people must think like their rulers**; anyone who doesn't is ridiculed, repressed, imprisoned, or killed. A few years ago, a phrase attributed to Che Guevara circulated: "The rich cannot be asked to distribute their wealth; the only way is to take it away from them," as the Cuban government did. But by taking away people's **freedom**, they inhibit and eliminate **initiative**, the spirit of evolution, the natural energy that drives effort toward work, creativity, and the projection of options that lead to a better quality of life. This is how **no one in Cuba works** to create.

surpluses because the surpluses do not belong to those who work them, but to the government. **If the sense of justice** is to give **to each person according to their needs** (those that the government considers), there is no incentive to work.

But yes, the Cuban Revolution was carried out in good faith, its **intentions** were good at the beginning.

The ego

And so, in these specific situations, we can observe an example of humanity's evolution: the constant struggle between the creative intention (good) and the paralyzing and destructive intention (evil) , or vice versa. I believe that evil is not a creation of God, but rather the sum of human character defects manifested in the ego, where the freedom to act is combined with a misguided ego.

If the positive mandate is: "love one another" (John 13:34), because **we are all brothers and sisters** , having the same origin. The ego tells me: "This is for me alone," "I don't agree," "I am absolutely right in everything I think and I won't **tolerate** being contradicted," "I want **everything** for myself and my loved ones, nothing for others," I am going against the natural movement of evolution, which requires positive forces to achieve its objectives. When the positive spirit oriented toward work, effort, solidarity, and justice is **realized**, these peoples progress; otherwise, they do not prosper.

I think that leaders, rulers, idealists, ayatollahs, etc., who exercise **the political vocation**, are normally well-intentioned people, but **power** It confuses the ego and leads it to a distorted reality. Political power and economic power (money) make a person feel superior because their reality is that they **have** the power and money that others **don't have**, so they think, "I must be superior." But they don't realize that this power and money originate in **the community**. If the other weren't there, who would I govern? Who would I work with in my business? Who would I serve in my professional capacity?

We are a **social body**, we evolved to be **homo sapiens sapiens** Because we learned to act as a group, with each other. So, to fulfill this evolutionary impulse, we **all have to do it together**, and the only way is by mastering our **ego** (our selfishness) and finding ways to benefit **everyone** from everyone's work .

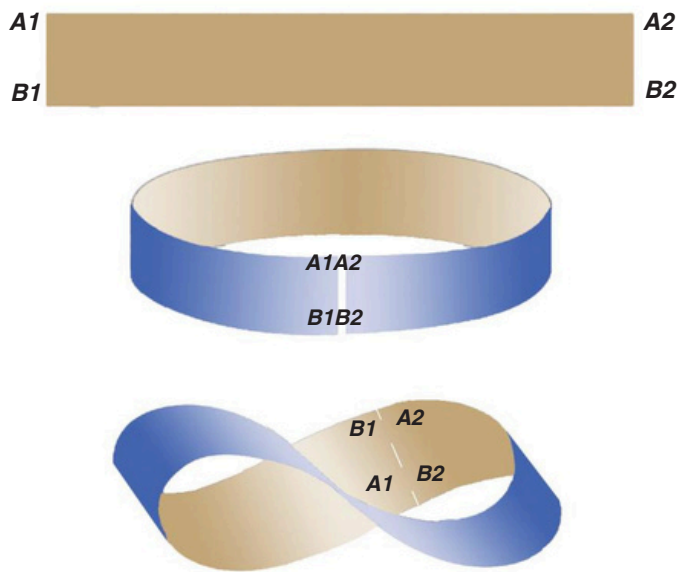
The enigma of the Moebius strip and idealism

For me there are concepts that are difficult to understand, I do not understand them but **I intuit them**, I sense them : the concept of infinity, quantum superposition (where

a particle can be in two places at the same time), the impression that ***the Moebius strips make on me...***

The film represents the cyclical nature of many processes, the unending, the infinite, the eternity... in it, we cannot define the beginning and the end. I don't understand it; I see it, I contemplate it, but ***I don't comprehend it.***

I know that it has two qualities: the objective one (the tape, the object) and the subjective one, which is what ***I don't*** understand.



The simplest way to make a Möbius strip is to take a strip of paper, twist one of its sides, and glue both ends together to form a loop. This creates a one-sided strip, which mathematicians call a non-orientable object. It's impossible to determine which side is top or bottom, inside or outside. If you start walking on the top side of the strip, when you walk all the way around and return to the starting point, you'll be standing on the bottom side of the strip without realizing it.

That's probably what happens with idealists: they do understand the objective (quantitative) part of reality, but not the quality (qualitative) part, as happens to me with the Moebius strip.

A greater and better understanding of reality —***where knowing ourselves plays a vital role***— allows us ***to understand*** (discover the deeper meaning of) the reality that surrounds us. Understanding gives us the tool to know what to do, to identify our ***intentions***, and thus to apply ***our freedom*** to correct self-determination, to direct our energy through work (effort) in the direction of what we believe makes ***us*** happy.

Vocations

Let's explore some ways to understand our place in the world:

Holiness: It is lived by those who focus their vision and faith on **the love of God, their neighbor and themselves** and dedicate themselves to the work of serving others and their beliefs, even at the cost of their own life.

Spiritual Leader: He possesses natural and spiritual qualities oriented toward good intentions. Through his **intuition**, he acquires knowledge superior to that of his contemporaries. What he **intuitively knows**, he assertively communicates in the **language of his time**, which expresses an **expanded worldview**.

Idealist: With the direct information provided by his senses (what he observes), he comes to the conclusion that reality is unjust. His good faith launches him into a **relentless struggle** against injustice, in which he commits his entire capacity to even give his life for what he believes in.

Entrepreneur: His vision and nature lead him to fulfill his mission: to integrate a **work-technology-capital** model to create **useful objects or services**. He has avocation (intuition), faith and the ability to achieve it.

Entrepreneur: He believes that the wealth (energy) generated is his, because he sees it as **the result** of his effort or the work of his parents and therefore he is certain that it **belongs to him**.

My profile as an entrepreneur and businessman drives me to share the ethical code of what I consider **to be a good businessman**:

A good businessman is clearly aware that when he produces an object or generates a **useful** service (good for humanity), he does so **with justice**: correctly applying and distributing the profit he obtains **from the marketing or sale of his product** to:

- strengthen your company, ensuring its survival in modern times to update it and perfect it;
- compensate its workers and collaborators in accordance with the benefits provided by law and their human rights;
- reward its shareholders with the dividend they are entitled to for having invested their **surplus energy** in the company;
- Pay your taxes appropriately, which is how you give back to the society in which you live and on which you depend to ensure **collective progress**, which is your manifestation of love and solidarity with your neighbor.

Professional: Perfects **his knowledge** in some specialty, studying or learning how to do certain things better, which allows him to develop a

more valuable work and providing a better product or service to the market. They generally receive better compensation in return for their effort and improvement.

Scientist: He fulfills his calling through the tools provided by science and technology. He develops his knowledge to investigate the causes of the phenomena that interest him. He places his faith in the *pursuit of scientific truth*.

Physician: His vocation leads him to dedicate his life to understanding the human body, its functioning, its ailments, and its possible solutions. His faith in medical science, his love for his profession, and his dedication to his work through study and practice make him a *good* doctor and a *better* human being.

Politician: Their vocation is *public service*: they place their faith in serving their community, preparing to share their knowledge and will to achieve the development goals of the society in which they live, pursuing the common good. When they succeed, they are a channel for achieving great good in the community. When politicians are *perverted* by egotistical vices—the ambition for power, corruption, money, or their arrogance in refusing to accept their ignorance—they cause serious harm to others.

Thinker: The philosopher is the conscience of the society of his time, often representing the deep contradictions of its culture and civilization. His guiding faith is the validity of questioning the meaning of life.

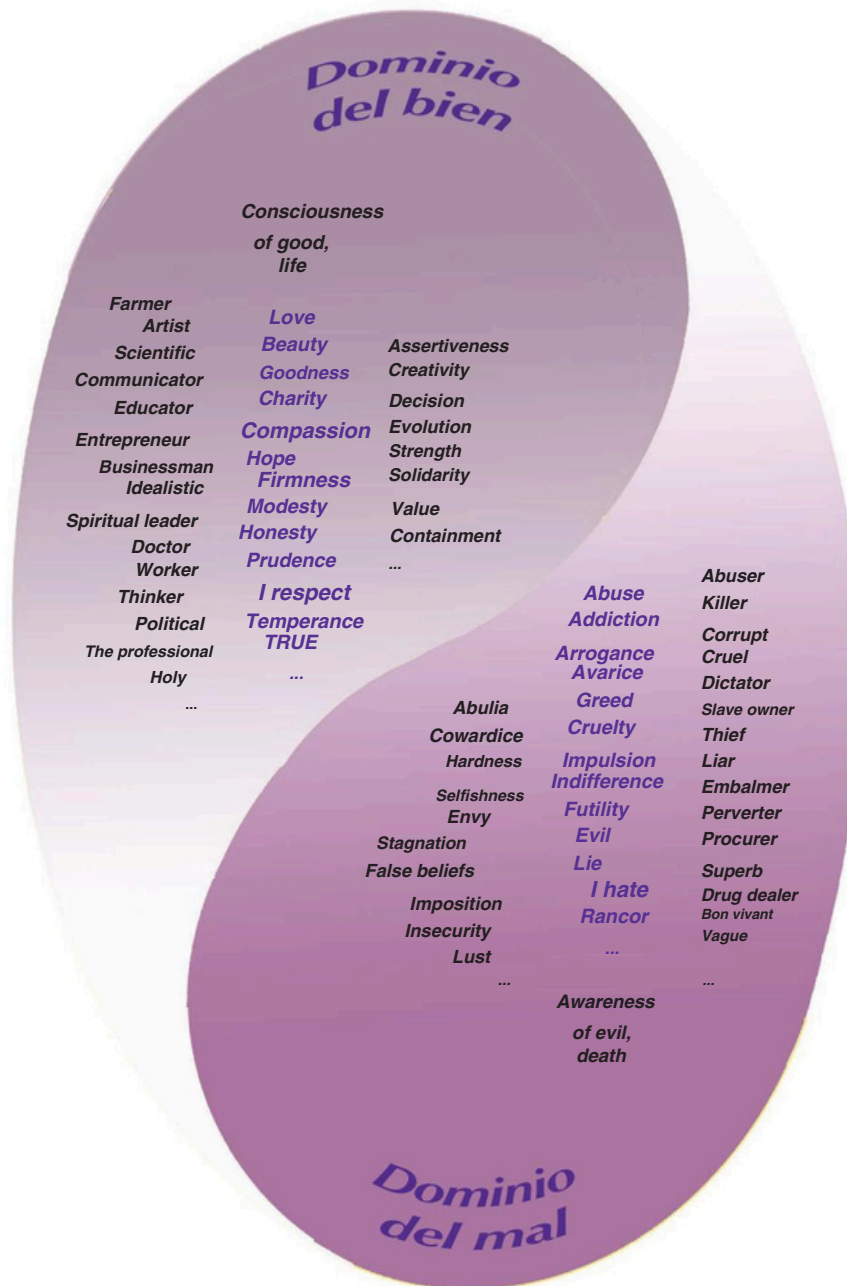
Artist: Develops natural abilities and inclinations to acquire tools of expression that allow him to recreate reality by interpreting it in his own way. Faith in his creative ability, his experience, and his craft lead him to subjectively express his individual *interpretation of reality*.

The role of the artist is difficult to define. Some are rewarded and recognized in their time, others are forgotten and rediscovered later. There will always be those who have the will to say something, and others who only speak to themselves. The true artist is honest with themselves and with their work as an expression of their very personal vision of the world. Art is subjective, and some artists easily find universal languages that allow them to connect with the world: empathy, harmony, beauty. Others generate experiences of confrontation, criticism, and uncertainty.

The capacity for artistic appreciation is a skill that also develops in a variety of ways: education, observation, and historical or cultural references. Unfortunately, in our time, the art market and the trivialization of the art object have conditioned the ways we perceive and connect with the true aesthetic experience, the one that excites our senses and moves the heart and even the soul.

We could compile a huge catalogue of the different vocations and activities of human beings, because we are all equal in our potential energy (a quantitative reference), but not in our energy of realization (a qualitative reference), which is determined by **the quality** (benefit) it produces for the community in which we are inserted.

However, there is one concept of equality that I consider valid and very important: the fact that in civilized societies we are all equal before the law. We all have the same rights (the universal rights of man) and obligations, respect for and obedience to the laws emanating from the community.



The creative entity

Knowledge doesn't provide us with the basis for understanding everything. For example, when it comes to the question of when the spirit reaches human beings, our understanding of this concept varies depending on how we interpret **the event** from different perspectives.

Spiritual leaders agree. Buddha tells us: "Your Buddha is within you." Jesus tells us: "May they all be one, as you, Father, are in me and I in you, and may they also be one in us." And the philosopher Hegel: "The divine spirit is your spirit."

I wonder: Where did the creative entity of creation go? Where has it been since the **Big Bang**, and where is it now? I believe it lies in creation itself, that the creator and the created merged into one and manifested in their **creative will**, but that it is only present in **the human spirit**.

In Hindu culture, everything created contains its own spirit, which is why they refer to a multitude of gods as objects of creation, but they agree that the spirit is in the object.

I believe that the spirit manifests itself in all creation, but it is only **present** in the human spirit, we are made in **its image and likeness**. and we manifest the same **qualities**: we have will (as he expresses it in creation), we have creativity, we have the capacity for self-determination (free will), we have the capacity for intention, etc. All of these are the qualities that we attribute to the creator.

To apply this knowledge

Knowledge that isn't applied, energy that isn't realized, is wasted; it doesn't fulfill its purpose. We've already said that studying engineering to become a taxi driver is pointless. So how do we apply **the knowledge** available to us?

Let's make an analogy with building a house or a home. To accomplish this goal, we need:

- Someone has the interest and **energy** (capital) to transform certain materials into a home (consumer product). (Individual, legal entity, government institution, etc.) And who intends **to** obtain (credit) or use that reserve (surplus energy) to build a home. • Hire someone to **design** the home. Someone who knows how to plan, develop, and organize the construction project according to the **quantitative and qualitative needs** of the person who will live there.
- With this data the designer (architect, engineer, master builder, etc.) determines both the size of the home (factor

quantitative), as well as its quality (qualitative factor), according to the materials available on the market, the client's preferences and their capabilities for formal and aesthetic resolution of the project. •When the owner approves **the project**, a budget is developed that corresponds to what they are willing to spend (the energy they are going to invest).

- It must include a **structural calculation**, where engineering knowledge is applied, so that the elements supporting the home (walls, columns, beams, slabs, etc.) are adequate.
- It also considers the type of **finishes**, the **qualitative** part of the dwelling. The budget includes everything that the construction of the size and quality required by **the** owner will cost. The monetary amount represents the energy needed to achieve what is required.
- Once the budget is approved, the construction company is hired. This company will manage the money (the energy) the owner has to satisfy their need to build the home. **The project** is the way in which the owner's desires and intentions are interpreted, along with the necessary materials and skilled **labor** (the work) to **make it reality**.
- The construction entrepreneur must have available: —The money to do it (**the energy**). — Plans that show **how to do it**. — The materials. — The workforce. — Will and ability.

One of the requirements for developing the project is **labor**, the energy that construction workers must apply to build a home. The team, the group of workers needed, includes the following workers:

- The laborer, who contributes his physical strength, carries materials, shovels sand and gravel, uses the wheelbarrow, and performs all the necessary heavy manual labor. His knowledge is basic, as he follows the instructions given by **the foreman or construction foreman**.
- The journeyman apprentice is the one who assists the journeyman in his duties, providing him with the materials and tools so that he can concentrate on his activity.
- The bricklayer is the one who, following the instructions of the corporal, the master builder, places the materials or executes the work in the proper manner.
- The officer applies his energy to the knowledge of his craft. There is

masonry, blacksmith, carpentry, plumbing, electrical, etc. officers. They all have a **knowledge of the trade** that the laborer and the apprentice **do not have**.

- The construction foreman oversees all fronts of the project; he is the foreman's assistant and must be **familiar with all trades** in order to supervise them.
- The construction foreman combines all the knowledge possessed by the laborer, apprentice, journeymen, and foreman, plus the capacity (knowledge) for organization and administration. He is the one who **directs the execution of the project**, under the supervision of the architect, engineer, and owner.

The scale moves according to the **knowledge** of each person involved in the process of building their craft, knowledge that is acquired through practice, teaching, intuition, but primarily through the **intention** and **will** of the person.

Greater knowledge and greater effort lead to higher **quality** work; a good bricklayer makes good walls, good plastering, aligned windows, etc. A wall is a wall, but it can be well or poorly made, depending on the bricklayer's will, strength, intention, and knowledge of his trade. This is a more skilled job than that of a laborer; **qualitatively**, both make the same physical effort and consume the same energy, but one does more skilled work because he combines his knowledge with his effort, combining two forces: physical strength and mental strength (knowledge), and therefore his work is more highly rated. This same phenomenon is repeated across the entire scale of construction work:

- The laborer does what he is asked to do with his physical strength.
- The apprentice does what he is told and also learns: he makes the physical effort that is required of him plus the intellectual effort of learning.
- The journeyman performs his trade, but previously learned how to do it. apprentice and worked as a laborer.
- The corporal uses his physical energy to go back and forth and give instructions. He applies the knowledge he has of the work of the laborer, the apprentice, and the journeyman, because he was all of these.
- The construction foreman doesn't learn in school, he learns **by doing**. He is a master because he knows how to apply physical force well and has the knowledge of all his subordinates, **plus** the knowledge of organization and administration, which he can perfect by studying.

This **qualitative scale** is the one that **idealists** or followers of egalitarian ideas do not take into account, their faith in the equality of people blinds them, their conception that we are **all** equal does not allow them to distinguish **quality**. different in people. They start from the fact that we are all human, this is a

True, but the potential energy that we all have at birth can be developed, improved, and enhanced.

This qualitative growth depends on many factors: hereditary, environmental, cultural, educational, geographical... But in the words of Lenin: "...communist work, in the most rigorous and strict sense of the word, is free work for the good of society... voluntary work, outside of norms, work... without setting conditions on its remuneration, work carried out out of the habit of working for the good of society and in accordance with the conscious attitude towards the need to work for the common good..."

So they think that the laborer, the apprentice's assistant, the journeyman, the corporal and the foreman, the engineer and the architect, all should **earn the same** because they have the same rights because they are all equal, and there should not be an owner (capitalist or exploiter), because the government is the only one who has reserves to invest, it is the one who owns everything and the one who decides what each one needs.

This **distorted view** is what creates the greatest differences, not in the existence of the human being, since every person has the same characteristics in their fundamental essence, but in the development of the individual life of each human being, where the **qualitative** factor determines the quality of life.

That is why in the construction group:

- The helper **earns more** than the pawn.
- The officer **more** than the assistant.
- The corporal **more** than the officer.
- The construction foreman **is more** than the corporal.
- The engineer **more** than the construction foreman.
- The architect **more** than the engineer.
- And we assume that the homeowner or buyer honestly generated enough with their work and effort to obtain a loan or have the capital (surplus energy) to invest in building their home.

Capitalism therefore rewards **each person according to their abilities**. And each person is free to choose what to do with their surplus. A construction foreman can save his surplus, compared to what a laborer earns, to build his own home, to spend it on a party, or he can use it to **better** educate his children, so that they have better opportunities by becoming more qualified and more knowledgeable. Those of us who love our children aspire for them to be better than us. We fulfill our **mission** by allowing **them** to build a **better world** and fulfill that mission of **growing** our conscience, our abilities, our collective responsibility. Note that nature is **qualitative**; the plant and animal kingdoms differentiate "quality" and recognize it.

This way, we can realize **how and where** we can improve. If we understand that our progress is proportional to the effort we put into doing things well, no matter what level we start at, **qualitative** advancement depends on effort (the energy we apply), our intentions, and the resources we have available.

And here another fundamental factor comes into play: the **means** we have available to improve ourselves. These means can be those provided by our parents or those provided by the government we have. Throughout the world, there are private (pay-for) schools and public (free) schools, or only government-run public schools. School is the place where children receive formal knowledge, since at home and in the environment around them, they learn informally through repetition or personal experience. The quality of our future depends on the quality of the teaching provided by the school system, and that quality depends on the educational **intent** of the school and the ability of the teachers who teach there.

The quality of the education students receive depends on teachers' knowledge, their teaching skills (didactics), the quality of the textbooks students use, the technological support available, and the curriculum. There is a method for assessing the educational quality of a school or institution, a measure that ranks them from best to worst. They are all schools and seek the same thing: to educate, but each one teaches based on the resources available to it. With more resources, they can pay their teachers higher salaries, select the best teachers, those who are most knowledgeable, the most qualified, and those who can best convey the content.

For example, Harvard in the United States and Oxford in England are known to be among the best schools in the world, **but** they are also among the most **expensive**, costing parents the most money (energy). So, it's the wealthiest who can send their children to these schools, since they have more surplus energy to invest in their education. Idealists consider this one of the **vicious circles** of capitalism: the children of the rich are better educated and therefore have more opportunities. So why don't governments grant scholarships to their best students to attend these universities, as was done during the Meiji Dynasty, when they sent their most outstanding students to study at the best universities in the world, so they could bring that knowledge back to Japan? The reason was that the emperor and the ruling class had a clearer vision of reality and power, and intuition led them to do so.

Today, China is an example: the country with the most scholarship holders in the world, in the best universities, acquiring the knowledge necessary to return and sustain their progress.

We must all, through democracy or whatever system of government we have, make the best effort to have the best ruler we can, because he or she leads the most important enterprise in our country: the government, and our future largely depends on his or her decisions.

Communist systems eliminate the concept **of quality** from their ideas about equality and justice. This qualitative element is intrinsic to the origin of the universe; it emanates from the creative will. But the philosophy of **communism**, dialectical materialism, doesn't **believe in the existence** of anything outside of space-time, the material world. Their materialist concept doesn't allow them to understand the divine origin of creation, and so **they deny it**. Their dogmatism convinces them that the universe created itself, based on their **fanatical faith**.
in the reality and material understanding of nature.

For those of us who believe that God indeed exists, **heaven and hell** exist in this life. These states of consciousness become reality in God's present, which is our existence here and now. We believe that heaven and hell occur in this moment in which we are living, where we know that **hell** is unhappiness and **heaven** is happiness (peace, harmony), where we understand that happiness is **the kingdom of God** and unhappiness is **the kingdom of Satan**. And all of this is within us, in the uncontrolled passions and character defects that our **ego** produces through our misguided desires, or in our virtues and our desire to live "as God commands."

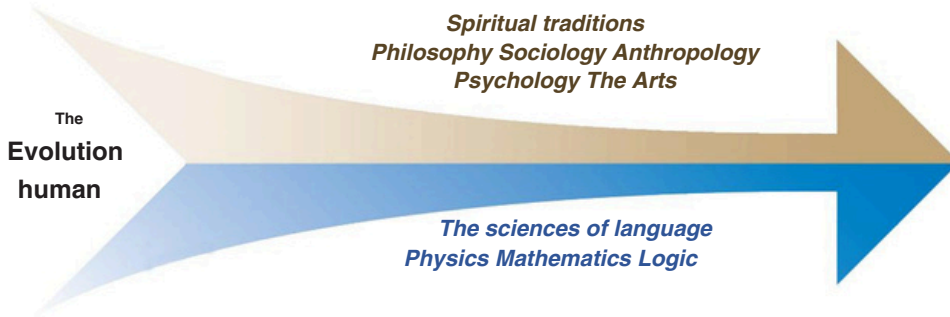
We know that living as God commands is a law that emanates from the contact of our ego with reality, which **reconnects us** with our true origin and allows us to realize that in our essence we all desire the same thing:

- I live without violence, **I do not attack, I do not kill.**
- I respect what is mine, **I do not steal.**
- Respect my physical and sexual integrity, **I do not attack, I do not abuse, I do not viola.**
- Live in trust and truth, **I do not lie.**
- Being respected by my children, **I respect my parents.**
- Being treated well, **I treat others well.**
- To be treated with dignity, **I treat others with dignity.**
- To be treated fairly, **not abuse.**

I want us all to do well, I fight and work for my own good and for that of others.

Our **intention**, the reason we desire self-actualization, lies in our actions, in the application of our energy. If we have a high level of consciousness and orient our **ego appropriately**, in accordance with that higher level that is certain that the other is like me, we will inevitably be good and live in peace and harmony. But if we are self-determined and tend toward the **ego's selfishness**, from a low level of consciousness, being racist, abusive, cruel, envious, resentful, greedy... if we exploit the needs of others, even if we have qualities, prestige, power, or money, we will live with evil, anxiety, alienation, unhappiness.

If we are convinced that what our **ego** desires is what **everyone else desires** because we share the same nature, divine nature, we can find the formula to **be better people**, to be close to or parallel to that force, to that **evolutionary will**.



The ethical imperative

We understand the ethical imperative as something that must be fulfilled, something that is inherent to human beings, and something that is universally valid. It consists of seeing others as if we were seeing ourselves, recognizing that others have the same rights and obligations as we do, not only before the law but before everyone else.

The ethical imperative determines that *I* must behave towards **others**, as if the **other** were **me**.

This concept is fundamental, since it is the basis of the norms and laws that must govern collective behavior in an evolved society.

It is closely related to the conception of good and evil that we have analyzed in this book, since it is the human **ego** that resists accepting the ethical imperative as a standard of personal conduct, acting out of selfishness and performing negative actions toward others.

The ethical imperative is aright and an obligation so fundamental in the development of consciousness, that realizing that the existence of the other is like mine, that we have the same rights and obligations, that our origin is sacred to both and that we must abide by that ethical imperative is its ultimate and most important objective, and consciousness must emanate from it . that governs our daily actions.

Let us remember that consciousness is the person's ability to perceive reality and recognize themselves in it, while **conscience** is the moral knowledge of what is right and what is wrong , based on each person's knowledge of themselves and their ability to act in their environment.

Thus, by adapting to the ethical imperative: seeing others as oneself, humanity will fulfill its destiny and the dream of a world of peace and harmony will be achieved.

The differences that exist in the way societies around the world approach the concepts of the ethical imperative are due to the fact that their development processes also follow different paths. Today, there are still communities with archaic levels of consciousness, while others have higher levels of consciousness. This is attributable to their own development processes, some of which we have already discussed.

We must not forget that the process of human development emerges through evolution, progressing from the instinctive responses of the animal kingdom—mammals and primates—to ***Homo sapiens sapiens***. It is only through the process of civilizational development that we have been able to declare ***the universal rights of man***, as recently as 1950. More than 10,000 years have passed since the discovery of agriculture for us to recognize each other as equals, and yet many signatory countries are still in the process of implementing them.

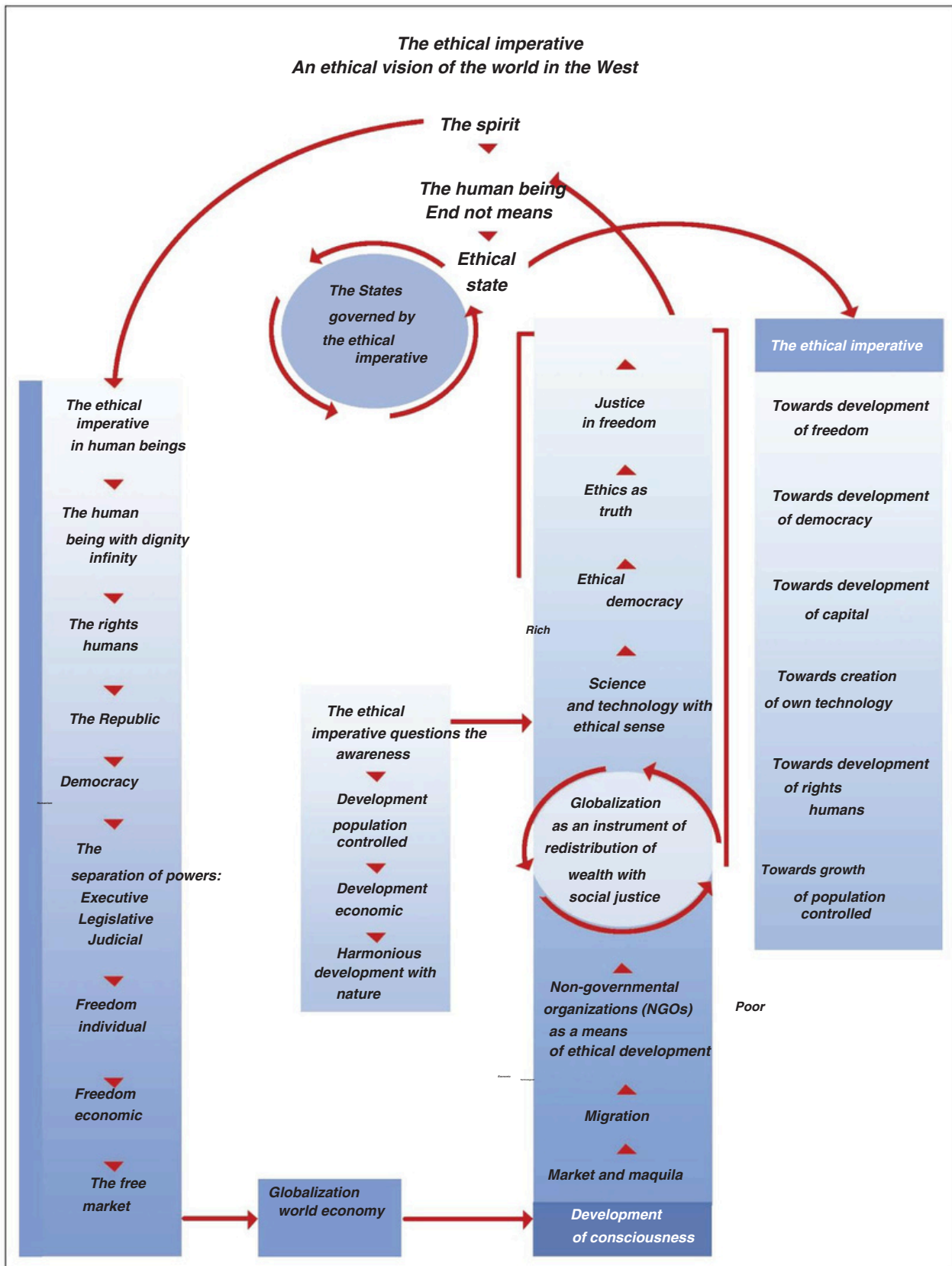
Evil is not intrinsic to humanity, but rather a consequence of the selfishness of human beings who desire everything for themselves based on their primitive instinct for survival. But it is overcome and divinized when the capacity for self-determination is exercised in the development of consciousness and the application of the ethical imperative.

***And the best is yet to come!
Love, health and well-being***

The ethical imperative An ethical vision of the world in the West

The Spirit creates every human being with infinite dignity. The ethical imperative is the organizing principle and starting point that allows us to have an ethical vision of the world. Thus, Western humanism leads us evolutionarily toward a democratic and republican society, where the division of powers guarantees that power is not concentrated in the ego of a single person or a single group. In developed countries, constitutional respect for human rights, individual freedoms, and social protection create the conditions for the development of prosperous and successful societies.

However, ego and globalization have other currents. A development of consciousness based on the regulating principles of the ethical imperative makes the globalization process an instrument for the redistribution of wealth with social justice, transferring values, capital, and technology from rich countries to poor countries that possess the labor force.



Being an entrepreneur

Managing a business in all its aspects requires specific conditions for the development of its different facets.

- First: that the country where the company is established practices a free market economy.
- Second: that said country be governed by a constitution that, among other rights, enshrines individual freedom and human rights.
- Third: that in said country there exists a rule of law that establishes and allows respect for the conceptual precepts of the “right of the parties” and fair and adequate trials.

These are the ideal characteristics of an optimal environment for business activity. They are not absolute limitations, as businesses can be created in less favorable environments. For example, in regimes with less freedom, such as dictatorships, where business risks are not only those inherent to the market, but also those that respond to the interests of state power.

The rules of the game for companies in leftist or communist regimes, where the system is not one of free enterprise but rather of state-governed economies, are dictated not by the market and the company itself, but by the corresponding authority. In this way, company management obeys political rather than economic dictates, which completely alters its essence by transforming it into apolitical management, with entirely different rules.

In our analysis, we will refer to companies created in democratic countries, with free market economies, with constitutional and, therefore, legal foundations, based on these two principles and on the application of universal human rights.

We will start by analyzing the free market.

The law of movement and exchange of energy governs the universe.

In simple terms, this means that human beings, when metabolizing the food we eat, process the energy it contains and use it for our physical and intellectual activity. All movement requires energy. This energy exchange is known as “economy,” which is nothing more than this energy transfer and its cost-benefit, which is perfectly evaluable, whether in a simple way or through more complex mathematical processes. Universal energy transfer is perfectly understandable, and free market economies obey the simplest rules of the cost-benefit of this transfer.

To better understand this concept, we must analyze it in terms of the most common activities. What happens at the nearest or most convenient market where we buy our food to live and carry out our activities?

What we know as a good traditional market (modern supermarkets will be analyzed differently) offers a wide variety of products: meat and fish of all kinds, fruits and vegetables, groceries, etc.

And there are many merchants, butchers, greengrocers, and fruit sellers. Each one displays their wares for public view, and each one sets the price they deem appropriate for their product.

We, the buyers, walk the market and freely choose from among the various qualities and prices offered what suits us best, what we like most, what we crave most, what we believe offers the best price-quality ratio. The dealer sets the price of his product according to his own judgment and decision, and the buyer acquires it according to his own will and desire. And the exchange takes place: the dealer delivers the product and the buyer pays. All with the absolute freedom of the parties, each according to their will and interests. Something as simple as that is the free market. A market is the clearest example of a free market economy, where transactions are carried out under the simplest rules of cost-benefit.

Now let's take a closer look at a single product, for example, the tomato. A vegetable with multiple uses in the kitchen, both in salads and stews of a wide variety of kinds, tomatoes are sold by the kilogram in the market and come in a variety of qualities and prices.

The value of the product in the market depends on a variety of factors:

I. Tomatoes are produced in irrigated and rainfed fields, therefore
Therefore, its harvest is subject to multiple factors:

The quality of the land.

The quality of the seeds.

The quality of fertilizers.

The amount of water, neither too much nor too little.

The plagues.

The cost of tillage machinery (including fuel).

The cost of labor in different processes.

The cost of energy for irrigation.

The cost of crop cleaning.

The cost of the harvest.

The cost of packaging, etc.

The quality of the product and the tons per hectare depend on all of us.
the above factors; adding them all together gives the production cost.

II. Then the second part of the process begins: the introduction process.
The introducer must set a purchase price that allows them to make a profit by adding:

Cost of loading the product.

Cost of transfer.

Depreciation of equipment.

Fuel cost.

Cost of breakdowns and maintenance.

Operating cost (driver).

Cost of roads.

Cost of introduction to the dock (parking, etc.).

Download cost.

Taking these costs into account, plus your profit, you must sell your product at a profit margin that allows you to continue operating and manage market variables regarding product quality and its value on the day it is introduced to the most convenient wholesaler.

III. Wholesale-retail sales

The retailer or "merchant" (the one who sells in the market) must know the current price and assess the quality of the product. They are the ones who best understand the price and quality of the product, since they are the ones who sell it to the consumer.

In the sale price you have to consider: The purchase price.

The percentage of expenditure.

The quality of the product.

The volume of buying and selling.

The cost of storage.

The cost of handling.

And you must sell at a price that will give you a profit that allows you to survive in business.

IV. The market

The merchant buys his product from the Central de Abasto or introducer and you have to consider:

The value of the acquisition of the product.

The cost of transportation to your market.

The download and placement of the product.

The rent of the premises.

Cost of aggregates (electricity, bags, etc.).

And sell at a comparative price based on quality and workmanship, competing with the other 20 stalls selling tomatoes in the market next to him. Added to all this are the factors that influence price variation: seasonality, distance from the market, production variations, etc. All these costs—which are calculable and scalable, barring unforeseen events—mean that the consumer price is variable; that is, it is the free market price, and it is their decision whether to purchase it or not.

It is important to note that an entrepreneur is involved in each of these steps.

The agricultural producer entrepreneur.

The introducing entrepreneur.

The intermediary entrepreneur.

The merchant businessman.

And everyone has to master their business skills.

By analyzing a single product—production, transfer of the product, introduction, and marketing—we can analyze the reasons why the market needs to develop in a democracy, whether parliamentary or republican, where there is a division of powers (Legislative, Executive, and Judicial), and in a free market system, in order to be able to exercise the profession of entrepreneur with openness and freedom.

Democracy

In a country with a centralized economy (in the hands of the government) or in a dictatorship, even if it is capitalist, there are distortions of reality in the factors of production—such as land ownership, seed distribution, sale of agricultural equipment, labor costs, etc.—because they involve unrealistic decisions. If someone sets the price of tomato seeds, this distorts reality that affects the entire process. The same applies to the importer, since setting a purchase price distorts the market with prices that do not correspond to the cost-benefit reality, that is, to real market costs. The same applies to the intermediary: the purchase and sale price cannot be set, because they either go bankrupt or become unjustly rich. Nor can it apply to the dealer: if the purchase and sale price is fixed, it does not reflect the buyer's reality.

These distortions, forced by power, political and market decisions, fallen, destroy the processes of reality and disrupt the economy.

There's no shortage of examples throughout history, and the most recent are, in order of seniority, Russian and Cuban communism and the Bolivarian socialist dictatorship of Chávez and Maduro. All three distorted reality "by decree" and ultimately plunged their people into poverty and depredation.

Freedom is an indispensable condition for the development of the world's economies. Producers, intermediaries, importers, and merchants must be able to act with complete freedom: to choose who to buy from, how much to pay in all processes, and to whom to sell. This is the essential condition of the market; forcing even one of these processes distorts reality, and sooner or later, reality prevails.

In legally egalitarian systems, everyone is equal, but in poverty and marginalization. History and everyday reality demonstrate this.

New market processes

The main characteristic of supermarkets or online shopping platforms is that the merchant concentrates all products in a single location, real or virtual, and offers each product at a fixed price.

For example, in supermarkets, there are up to three varieties of tomatoes on the shelf, each with a specific price that is unmatched in the same location. On the other hand, on online shopping platforms, the same product is offered by different retailers at different prices. The consumer decides whether to buy there or go to another supermarket or platform to acquire it more cheaply. It may seem like a price is imposed, creating a market distortion, but the market has its own adjustment mechanisms, and consumers end up recognizing the real prices for each product. Furthermore, most consumers don't shop at just one supermarket or platform and end up identifying which offers the best deals on each product.

Conscious consumers know they must have alternatives and patience, because while it's true that supermarkets generally have better parking, air conditioning, hygiene, etc., it's also true that their prices are generally higher than those of popular markets. Neighborhood stores, due to their low sales volume, high fixed costs, and lack of inventory, are neither cheaper nor more convenient to shop at—which is why nine out of ten new stores close—so consumers only make emergency purchases there. Meanwhile, online shopping platforms offer a wide variety of options for the same product from an electronic device 24 hours a day, from wherever the shopper is located and delivered to wherever they need it.

Neither supermarkets nor online shopping platforms generate market distortions. On the contrary, if we understand that their objective is to offer the best price to the end consumer, without distorting or forcing it, mass purchasing, mass introduction, and mass distribution of the product allow for greater efficiency and better prices.

Let's take the example of Walmart, which currently has thousands of stores and two million employees. Its founder, Samuel Moore Walton, was a frugal man who never moved and used the same car for years as long as it worked. He imposed these austerity policies on his companies, both in terms of salaries and purchasing requirements, always with a single objective: reaching the end consumer with the best price. That was the main goal of market competition.

This allows us to gain insight into the principles that an entrepreneur must possess to be considered one. We will list the characteristics required to be an entrepreneur, which are neither unique nor universal, which is why there are as many ways to manage companies as there are shareholders and executives.

The characteristics of an entrepreneur are many, ranging from having inherited wealth to having started from nothing. However, good entrepreneurs are not the product of chance. Let's compare a business to the human body: The skeleton supports

the body; the structure of bones, tendons, and muscles is what keeps it upright and moving. In a business, this function is performed by accounting, which provides knowledge of all its components; it is the information that supports the business and identifies, through control and auditing, where flaws may lie.

In the human body, the heart and circulatory system distribute the oxygen and energy that cells need to function properly.

In a company, this is the role of finance, which allocates resources to the various departments that require them to function properly.

In the human body, the nervous system informs and issues orders for its functioning; in companies, it is the chains of command and organizational hierarchies that operate by ordering and monitoring objectives.

In the body, muscles are responsible for moving the entire system; in businesses, economic resources are the tools for mobilizing and regulating the company.

And finally, the brain is where all information is concentrated and where all the conscious and unconscious commands that move, motivate, and drive the entire body are generated. In companies, this function is performed by the board of directors, which concentrates information and establishes policies. The CEO is responsible for carrying out the processes, procedures, etc., to achieve objectives and successfully fulfill the company's goals.

It's important to emphasize that the primary objective of every business, whether creative, commercial, industrial, service-oriented, or otherwise, is to achieve a differential in costs and sales value that generates a profit. A business without profits sooner or later collapses, fails, and closes.

Any business owner, whether small, medium, large, or giant, must be aware of all the processes that must be carried out in their company to achieve their objectives.

It's said that entrepreneurs are born, not made. This is partly true, since it must be acknowledged that such birth can occur throughout life. What is true is that, at some point, a person must make the decision to become one, to become independent, and they must be aware of this, that every venture, as such, entails risks, and that the company must face the market and succeed with profits.

It's difficult to classify or describe all the types of businesses or enterprises that exist. There are classifications that categorize companies, among other characteristics, by size. Thus, there are companies:

- Personal •

- Family

- Small. The famous SMEs, which are the vast majority and generate the most jobs due to their number.
- Medium. Companies with fewer than 100 employees and a departmental organization.
- Larger. Companies with between 100 and 1,000 employees, with specific, specialized characteristics that require greater skills and management policies.
- Large. Companies with between 1,000 and 10,000 employees; these are companies with large production and service volumes and a complex organization.
- Transnational. Companies with between 10,000 and millions of employees, which are the most complex business expressions.

In this regard, three fundamental aspects must be taken into account: first, the size of the company does not change the market objective: the best product or service at the best possible price; second, the accounting processes, the famous and miraculous balance sheet: the debit-credit ratio is the same for a one-man business as for a million-man business; and, finally, profit: whether a one-man business or a million-man business, profit is essential for its survival.

And here appears the first universal characteristic of the entrepreneur: he must be aware of his objectives, understand the pros and cons of his business, and recognize the cost-benefit of what he does, otherwise he will not survive.

The second characteristic is that you must have a deep understanding of your product. If you don't precisely understand the purpose of your company or your product, you won't be able to achieve your business goals.

The third characteristic: you don't necessarily have to be an accountant, but you do have to understand the debit and credit processes and have constant awareness of the financial status of your small shop or emporium, because otherwise you won't be able to make the right decisions.

The fourth characteristic is that you must have the broadest possible vision of your product's market and the competition, otherwise you will have a hard time surviving.

The fifth characteristic is that there must be congruence between the time, capacity, and commitment requirements of your business and your personal life. Succeeding financially and failing emotionally or morally ends up being a bad outcome in life. This phenomenon is very common among entrepreneurs: businesses that sacrifice families and families that sacrifice businesses.

There are currently schools that teach some subjects related to the work of an entrepreneur, for example, accounting. In five years, they train an accounting professional, an accountant. But an accountant is not necessarily a

Entrepreneur. There are schools that teach marketing, but a marketer isn't necessarily an entrepreneur; there are also schools that teach mechanical engineering, but a machine designer isn't an entrepreneur. Through experience and intuition, entrepreneurs weave together all this knowledge to achieve their business goals.

In all companies, owners, board members, and directors should have a general idea of what they do, although they can assign specialists to each of the areas they cover. For example, a construction company carries out specialized projects in drinking water, urban development, housing, schools, roads, etc., according to its scale and the specialized departments within it.

There are issues that are universal to all businesses, and one of them is accounting, a very important subject for any entrepreneur. It's essential for entrepreneurs to understand their sales and profits; that is, the basic accounting concept that allows them to determine the value of a company of any size, whether it's a corner store or General Motors. Of course, there are many factors that affect these processes; in large corporations, these are computerized processes that follow pre-configured programs, but the fundamental concept is the same: maintaining costs to establish a competitive selling price.

Another aspect every business owner should understand is their product's market and its competition. In terms of both transparency and price, the automotive industry lends itself well to this analysis: What car should be manufactured? At what price? Well, there are small, medium, and large, cheap and expensive, economical and economical, work and luxury, and so on. Each car manufacturer must select its market and define its competitive segment in terms of quality and price.

Thus, the cost-benefit concept we apply in our daily lives is very similar to the one we apply in business life: What activity am I going to develop? What are the cost-benefits for my potential client? If I can do it correctly, the company will have a chance of success; otherwise, it won't.

In this way, we outline, to a greater or lesser extent, the profile of an entrepreneur and the knowledge and skills they need to successfully carry out their activities.

It is believed that increasing academic knowledge facilitates business success. This is not necessarily true, as continuing education generally improves a specialty, and unless the company focuses on that specialty, it is not always useful for business activity.

Practical experience in business life often broadens knowledge more than studies, unless the latter focus on the business activity itself. For example, the development of accounting programs

computerized programs aimed at a specific area of the company and focused on a practical and necessary activity of the company, which enrich the executive's knowledge and are automatically applied to the company's objective.

In this way, we are gradually realizing that, in some ways, entrepreneurs must be "specialists in generalities"—in their company and the environment in which they operate. This refers to the day-to-day handling of reality and the challenges that arise, which shapes their entrepreneurial character, their experience, and their understanding of the viability of different perspectives that require immediate actions and solutions to continue advancing their objectives. This is how this entrepreneurial sixth sense develops, allowing them to expand their experience and knowledge of their field of action.

There are no special characteristics that define an entrepreneur, as entrepreneurs come in all shapes and sizes, with all sorts of temperaments, emotions, feelings, passions, and even abilities. Different productive activities require different abilities; there is no one-size-fits-all approach.

However, a hard-working entrepreneur has a much better chance of success than one who dislikes effort. Consistent, solid, and ongoing work is a formidable tool for overcoming obstacles, as are discipline and order. All positive activities contribute to entrepreneurial activity. A person who is disciplined and orderly in their work reflects this attitude on their colleagues, helping them perform their duties well. But it is also true that other virtues, such as creativity and intuition, sometimes play a decisive role in the success of a company.

The ability to unite and delegate, the ability to bring other people together, is one of the objectives of a business. Creating the company's spirit and identifying it with its purpose, while convincing others that this is the right thing to do, is a great business quality, as is knowing how to delegate specific, crucial functions to the right person for the company's successful performance.

This requires possessing or developing strong leadership skills, a particularly challenging task, as this is a gift that not all entrepreneurs possess, but one that is essential to cultivate for a company's successful performance. Leadership is not about giving orders, but rather "knowing how to give orders." Every company requires a leader or a board that functions as a unit. Without corporate leadership, there is no order in the company, nor is there a definition of objectives and processes needed to achieve success. Success depends largely on the clarity of these objectives and processes. The more people in a group identify the objectives and processes, the greater the chances of success for a company.

In today's world, digital communication is increasingly the way people and businesses communicate. Because of this, personal communication is gradually being lost in businesses, which represents a great risk. A true entrepreneur must understand the most intimate aspects of their business.

their collaborators, not only at work but also in their emotional states, and this can only be achieved through direct contact. Likewise, meetings with senior executives are where the spirit and goals of the group are communicated. Over time, these become diluted, and if they are not reaffirmed as a group, they end up becoming bureaucratized and lost. Faced with this situation, real-time videoconferencing platforms, such as **Zoom** or **Teams**, have been a positive response, as they allow for eye contact and the observation of the nonverbal languages with which each person communicates, establishing closer contact despite the distance.

One of the greatest risks of growth is closely linked to communication technologies. Being informed is not the same as being convinced. If there is no consistent overall vision of the group's objectives, it is very difficult not to waste enormous energy on confusion, misinterpretation, and confusion. Personalized contact and communication between the entrepreneur and their key collaborators should never be interrupted or blocked.

There is no better leadership than that of a hardworking, focused, direct, knowledgeable, and open-minded entrepreneur. They will be leaders in their own right, regardless of their personal qualities and flaws, because it is through observing reality that one learns and identifies the true qualities of an entrepreneur.

A collaborator who feels respected will respect, and a collaborator who feels cared for will care. Leadership can be a natural gift, but it is also acquired, not through study but through practice and discipline, but above all through controlling one's temper or the passions that disturb relationships with colleagues.

Intellectual honesty is an excellent aid in the leadership and management of a company. Deceiving or concealing flaws, failing to learn from mistakes or hiding them, or failing to call things by their name in successes or failures only obscures the vision. The entrepreneur must be honest with his company and his collaborators. He must not extract from it, or from them, more than what is fair and correct. This is known and perceived by all and should be a value demanded by the company, since failure to do so distorts its spirit.

An entrepreneur's spirit of sacrifice and effort are necessary, especially at the beginning of a business. Knowing how to sacrifice a little of the present for a more promising future gives the company a greater chance of success. Maintaining a company's financial health should be a priority for every entrepreneur. No company goes through crises of various kinds throughout its life, and financial solvency is the main tool for overcoming any type of crisis. Extracting more capital than necessary, even from consolidated profits, exposes a company to higher financial costs and unforeseen risks. Well-planned reinvestment of profits is the future of a company with growth ambitions.

The balance between business development and the well-being of partners is fundamental. A clear understanding of the company's reinvestment needs and the shareholders' demands for profit sharing is essential, as is the responsibility of a good entrepreneur. The saying "poor companies, rich entrepreneurs" is common. Respecting a company's development policies gives it a better future than limiting its natural growth by extracting profits. Similarly, we often see significant growth through financial debt, which causes internal organizational crises and exposes companies to unnecessary financial risks. Companies that, in the event of a change in interest policies, can suffer severe crises.

In today's world, competition is no longer with the dealer next door, as in the market. Today, the world has a universalized commercial dynamic: flowers produced in Colombia are sold in New York, as are those produced in Holland. Competition has become global. For example, in the hotel industry, the Mexican Caribbean not only competes with Caribbean tourism, but competes with the entire world. Spending a week in Bali, Indonesia, costs a Parisian almost the same as spending it in Cancun, Thailand, the Seychelles, or on a beach in Vietnam. Modern 300- and 600-passenger airplanes have brought all the countries of the world closer in cost. The same is true for consumer goods: modern ships, which can carry 200,000 tons, move goods around the world for less than one peso per kilogram, and large-bodied aircraft can transport modern technology equipment and different types of cargo anywhere in the world.

Amazon delivers products to your home for less than \$10 and does a great business.

Having a global view of the market is essential for any entrepreneur. The modern world is changing the rules of the game, as is the case with that wonderful country, China, which has greatly modified the rules of the game in unpredictable ways.

This reality leads us to conclude that entrepreneurial activity, although universal, has characteristics depending on the country in which it is carried out, which impacts a diversity of human qualities in the business world. Therefore, it is not easy to determine what, if any, universal qualities of an entrepreneur are.

For example, there is the communist culture of development in China, and now in Vietnam, which I would call the culture of seeking ways to do things in the present, with the future in mind, and the culture of "not doing, but wanting."

The culture of "not doing, but wanting"

Visiting China today after having visited it 35 years ago is a very difficult contrast to understand. With a Western, democratic, and capitalist mentality, one cannot understand how a quarter of the country of 1.3 billion

of inhabitants, that is, nearly 350 million, in a single generation rose from extreme poverty to a middle, upper, and elite class, on par with any developed country in the West. But not only at that level, but with a much more promising future, because they simply and simply found the formula to destroy everything old and build, with the greatest possible modernity and foresight, everything new.

While the West, with its enormous humanistic progress, declines, the East progresses and projects itself into the future. Why?

There are two scenarios:

I. The panorama of developed countries

In Europe and the United States, there are two fundamental phenomena: 1.

Psychologically, they feel that they rightfully deserve the best.

2. Having lost the cost-benefit ratio.

All the rich, democratic, capitalist, Protestant Western countries became "protector states," whose main function is to enforce human rights, losing sight of the relationship between work and profit. Their stock markets stopped reflecting the true value of companies and productivity, and became gambling casinos for derivatives (fictitious values). The common citizen began to demand services and became reluctant to make the effort to produce. This generated a vicious cycle of living well, protected, with minimal effort, which has been the beginning of decline.

Their constant dissatisfaction with enriched peoples who want more while giving less has produced a generation of indolent politicians and demagogues who have failed to re-motivate people and have devoted themselves more to *dolce far niente*.

II. The panorama of Third World countries In Mexico in

particular, the culture of "not doing, but wanting" has been generated.

This is a very difficult culture to understand. It consists of obstructing all creative activity through laws, regulations, etc., right down to the constitutional level. These laws establish rules to curb any creative act by citizens and require "permits" for any activity. These permits are subject to the discretion of the politicians and officials in power, who, in addition to imposing the obstacle, in 90 percent of cases demand money to overcome it.

The network of obstacles and permits imposed by constitutional laws and regulations, which must be overcome at all levels—municipal, state, federal—is so complex that we are all familiar with the 10- to 20-year processing periods required to complete the necessary procedures for obtaining permits.

On the other hand, the desire to have without making the effort to produce has generated a policy of insecurity and impunity that, supported by a bad

general interpretation of human rights—which are deeply concerned with the rights of criminals, not their victims, nor with the constant detractors of those rights, who are corrupt politicians—has created an atmosphere of business uncertainty that opposes any creative act.

This psychologically and emotionally fraught atmosphere, rooted even in our Constitution, represents a brake on creativity and generates such a concentration of wealth that it becomes an insurmountable obstacle to development and fosters in our politicians an opportunistic mindset more concerned with power and wealth than with the well-being of the people. And when a spirit of transformation emerges, constitutional obstacles, human rights, and customs and practices prevent any real effort at transformation.

Everyone progresses

In countries experiencing regression, like those in Europe, there is, however, scientific and human progress. New technologies are creating a new world in every sense: cultural, labor, racial. No one can predict the future of humanity, but in the 10,000 years of human history, there have always been obstacles and advances. Today, we have no idea what the societies, technologies, energy sources, ways of thinking, values, and religions of the future will be like. But in the present, when you visit China, you feel the future; if you visit Africa and South America, you feel the present; and if you visit Europe, you feel the past.

Furthermore, a new history is being written in China, one that is difficult for the Western mind to understand. When I asked a guide how the opposition between the Communist Party dictatorship and capitalism was resolved, he replied without hesitation: "With flexibility on both sides."

I've been able to understand little about this dual system that is creating the society of the future; however, there are two things I did understand:

- 1. Land is the property of the government, and it is its sole discretion to decide what to do with it. Therefore, it is the Party Central Committee that decides what to do with it.

This has allowed them to transform their cities and countryside. They have devastated—and continue to do so—their old cities. They demolish everything, absolutely everything, and then rebuild. They relocate those who lived in the old apartments in the old cities to new apartments, demolish the old ones, widen the streets, and create roads and transportation systems.

The method is that the government, being the owner of the land, leases it for 100 years to a developer, who, without paying the initial land cost, builds a condominium, which once finished is sold with 100-year rights and returns the apartment to the original inhabitants.

At the same time, the government is allocating huge amounts of land for territorial reserves and future traffic areas, creating new cities with a perfectly foreseeable and possible future.

In the countryside, the priority is the community and the future. Where a road is needed, it is built, without opposition; where a dam is needed, it is built; where an airport is needed, it is built. Similarly, large reserves are created for future development, without the slightest resistance, and the inhabitants of those lands are relocated.

- 2nd. Human rights over property are subject to the present and future well-being of the community.

With this complete planning freedom and this mixed form of government-business partnership, they are rapidly transforming their entire territory. Twenty-five percent of the population, or 300 million, lives in First World cities, with excellent infrastructure and well-being. China has become the leading source of tourism in all of Asia. Currently, 28,000 apartment buildings are built each year to accommodate the 2.8 million new residents joining the emerging Chinese middle class, which requires housing and consumption.

These new cities are springing up like mushrooms across the country, with a service and recreational infrastructure perfectly planned and executed for the present and the future. Just visit Shanghai, Beijing, and Tianjin to see what's happening in this wonderful country, whose splendid past and ancient culture offer a glimpse into the reason for its greatness.

In Vietnam, there's a town called Ha Long, which is fortunate enough to have an area with a large number of islets, like peaks jutting out of the sea, with marvelous caves. This community receives 10 million tourists a year and has developed ports, avenues, viaducts, drainage systems, drinking water, and electricity—much more than all the tourist developments Mexico has created and "sold." In Cancún, they've been waiting 25 years for a 500-meter-long bridge to be built over the Nichupté Lagoon to clear Kukulcán Boulevard, and we receive the same 10 million tourists as Ha Long.

The fact that they adapt property rights to the well-being of the community has given them a flexibility impossible to find anywhere else in the world. The same flexibility that any Chinese or Vietnamese entrepreneur requires to carry out their projects. Without a doubt, this is a difficult culture to understand.

For Mexican entrepreneurs, understanding the culture of "don't do, but want" is essential to successfully managing their business in a hostile environment. It requires patience, perseverance, and flexibility to overcome the myriad of permits and obstacles that officials impose in most cases.

At the same time, the government has to face multiple obstacles to the development of infrastructure in the country, since land ownership, whether communal or communal, is

(they don't own property, but they do have rights), communal, private, or corporate, creates countless obstacles. For example, the right-of-way for a new highway is a nightmare, as is the construction of a hydroelectric plant. We have created a tangle of rights, ecological values, etc., that make development impossible, and it is in this highly complex environment that entrepreneurs must develop their business.

There are also other factors that entrepreneurs must address. Much has been said about the purpose of humankind on Earth, and it is said to be self-realization and the happiness of the community. It is not easy to clarify these concepts, but starting a business should not be an obstacle to achieving that goal. Entrepreneurship is avocation, the desire to be autonomous, to not have authority at work over one's own will, to experience the thrill of risk, creativity, and independence.

But the company must also be a producer of well-being and happiness.

And this is a fundamental aspect that the entrepreneur's family must understand and support. Businesses and families are jealous of the entrepreneur's time. And in the modern world, where both men and women work, developing a balanced family requires time and attention. Therefore, it is of utmost importance that the entrepreneur's partner understands the company's priorities in terms of time, effort, and sacrifice. The partner must make up for the time the entrepreneur dedicates to the business within the family, always thinking about the present and the future.

Another extremely important factor is the social aspect of your company. Employees are its lifeblood. A healthy, resilient, well-paid team is the cornerstone of success. A fundamental requirement is that the company provide its employees with all the benefits required by law, as growth cannot be achieved healthily if it does so at the expense of its workforce. Employees must receive a fair contribution in relation to their effort, work, and ability, and the value the market places on their role. Furthermore, they must have the social security their job rightfully demands. A fair and timely salary is the first obligation of any company. The next obligation is paying the taxes required by law. And, last but not least, generating profits. If a company cannot meet these three requirements, it has no sustainability or future.

Modern businesses have incorporated social and ecological values into all their objectives. Therefore, entrepreneurs must be aware that their company's sustainability must be not only economic, but also social and ecological.

On the other hand, the entrepreneur must know the personality of his collaborators, their strengths and weaknesses, since a good selection of collaborators, whether executive or lower level, is of vital importance. He must find

Collaborators and executives who can replace or complement their own shortcomings, which requires an awareness of their limitations, since no one is capable of performing all the functions a developing company requires. It is necessary to find and train all people in their areas of opportunity and specialties, and encourage their development. Likewise, you must encourage advancement through promotion within your company, so that all employees see it as an opportunity for future development.

Furthermore, it should promote the values of honesty and loyalty to the company. Recognition motivates the recipient and encourages them to give more of themselves.

Externally, the entrepreneur must establish public relations that are useful to his company, both in the area of its specialty and in the financial and trade union spheres, and project a serious, solvent, and outstanding corporate image in its field of activity.

Every company must have a spirit and a specific objective in its field, and it is up to the entrepreneur to define it, disseminate it, and unite all employees around it.

Companies are living organisms that evolve over time in their technologies and objectives, in step with the social environment in which they operate. It is the entrepreneur's job to understand and assimilate this evolution and encourage it among their employees.

It is essential for entrepreneurs to think about the future and train the people or board members who will replace them upon their retirement. Businesses must be designed not for one generation, but to endure over time, evolving with the social environment in which they operate. Eighty percent of businesses disappear in the third generation, after their founder retires or dies, which is a shame, as these businesses accumulate knowledge and experience that must be leveraged. To achieve this, it is necessary to train executives and partners with the essential skills to ensure the company's continuity. Business management cannot be left to chance, as this is one of the reasons why most companies disappear during generational transitions. Therefore, to face the generational transition, it is necessary to prepare for it, both in terms of management and shareholder composition.

Transnational corporations have accumulated considerable experience in these transitions, and have patents and market positioning strong enough to overcome them. Despite this, many companies fail to survive these transformations.

In general, founding entrepreneurs find it difficult to imagine that someone will eventually have to replace them, and they fail to prepare the company to survive without them, which makes them destructive of their own creation. The ego can be a great enemy of the entrepreneur if they fail to recognize that time undermines the executive abilities of every human being, and that energy and memory diminish with time.

Age. Knowing when and to whom to delegate responsibilities, and training them to do so, is a vitally important task for any conscientious entrepreneur.

The evolution of humanity is accelerating every day, and the emergence of communism (to each according to their needs, not to each according to their abilities), despite its enormous failure, left behind a new vision of society.

The United Nations (UN) published the International Bill of Human Rights, which lists the basic civil, cultural, economic, political, and social rights that all human beings in the world should enjoy. We are far from having achieved universalization of these rights, but we must fight for the right of future generations to inherit a pollution-free world that allows for the continuation of the human species. Modern businesses must be aware of this new worldview and, as they develop and grow, participate more actively in concrete actions to improve the quality of life in their communities.

It is the duty of conscious entrepreneurs to ensure that their companies are a factor of social sustainability. To achieve this, they must incorporate social and environmental actions into their objectives, contributing effort and capital to complement the government's work in this area.

Societies with significant economic inequalities and large marginalized and impoverished social groups are not conducive to sustainable businesses, as they generate social tensions that affect the successful development of any business. It is, therefore, the responsibility of entrepreneurs to improve, within the company's capabilities, its social environment, as this contributes to a better future.

Social and technological changes are now occurring at an astonishing speed, and failure to recognize them is a tremendous risk for businesses. Therefore, entrepreneurs must stay informed about technological developments around the world by participating in fairs and exhibitions related to their industry. This is vitally important, since, for example, a technological transformation in a production line can mean a radical change in the cost of an item, just as a change in the methodology of a service can represent a radical increase in costs and quality. Today, there are companies whose only asset is a computerized system, such as Uber, the world's largest taxi service company, which doesn't own a single rental car, or Amazon, a company that produces nothing and has no industries, yet is shaking up the world's largest shopping centers. The development of artificial intelligence and its application in all the processes carried out by a company and society as a whole deserves special mention. Nvidia is currently the fourth most valuable company in the world, holding approximately 80% of the global market share in GPU semiconductor chips.

Entrepreneurs expect a return on their invested capital greater than the bank's interest rate. And this is where risk comes in. Every business constantly faces the possibility of failure, whether due to external factors—the market, competition, social, political—or internal ones. Entrepreneurs must be fully aware of this reality and be alert to react appropriately should any of these risks arise, minimizing them as much as possible, thus giving the company a greater chance of success.

Global economic crises like the one in 2008, caused by excessive speculation in derivatives on the stock exchanges, which led to the bankruptcy of many companies that were unprepared for such a situation or that did not know how to take the necessary measures to overcome it, can happen again, and only solvent companies that have reacted correctly have survived these crises and continue to operate.

More slowly than it should, the world is realizing that the future does not lie in the theoretically just injustice of socialist-minded people who dream of distributing wealth without producing it. Socialist countries have realized that without productivity, there is nothing to distribute but poverty—as is currently the case in Cuba and Venezuela—and that productivity emerges only when two fundamental aspects of the human spirit are respected: creativity and freedom. And it is in the spirit of entrepreneurs and their companies that the future of humanity lies, since the function of bureaucracy is not to generate wealth but rather to administer it for the benefit of citizens. Governments have never produced wealth; it is countries and their citizens who generate it.

Well-being doesn't come by decree. No one can distribute what they don't produce, what they don't have, and problems aren't solved by taking from those who have done something and giving it to those who have done nothing. On the contrary, those who have done nothing must be given the opportunity to do something by educating them. It is the entrepreneur's obligation to promote this worldview and must dedicate efforts and resources to disseminating it. The future of the world lies not in demagoguery but in creativity and productivity, and these are the business of the entrepreneur.

It's practically impossible to describe the universal characteristics of an entrepreneur, as strengths and weaknesses vary depending on the social, economic, and political environment in which the business operates. Being an entrepreneur is different in China, the United States, or Mexico; however, creativity and freedom, the desire for well-being, the desire to transform the world around us for the better, are characteristics of all entrepreneurs around the world.

In Protestant countries, **wealth**, or physical, spiritual, and economic well-being, is synonymous with being right with God. In our country, with its Ibero-Catholic tradition, it is said that it is easier for a camel to pass through the eye of a needle than for a rich person to enter heaven. Demagogues condemn business activity and the capitalist system, even though this is the only way.

that exists toward well-being. Being an entrepreneur means being on the right side of history, and entrepreneurs must be aware of this and not be confused by demagoguery and lies. The wealth they generate is just, as it is the basis of a market economy where competition exists, and they should not only feel no guilt but satisfaction. What they do with their money—if it's well-earned—is a decision that belongs only to them.

I have previously explained that money is nothing more than the agreement between parties regarding a specific value; it is energy contained in a piece of paper with which one can contract someone's services, purchase a consumer item, or save for the future. In market economies, money knows no borders and moves at prices established by those economies, based on its purchasing power, usually compared to the dollar. Modern entrepreneurs must understand the value of the currency they use in the international market and know how to operate with the exchange rates that exist. Both for acquiring inputs from abroad and for obtaining credit, they must be aware of the alternatives. In Third World countries, we generally have unstable currencies and loans with variable interest rates or with interest rates referenced to foreign markets, which have frequently caused serious financial crises for companies that took out loans that, due to rising interest rates, were unable to repay.

Entrepreneurs must have a political and financial vision that allows them to assess these risks and take them with caution. The company's available funds should not be speculative. The last global financial crisis caught many companies off guard in securities derived from stock markets that collapsed, with the subsequent loss of said capital, which caused almost generalized business crises. The company's funds must be consolidated with internal training, new equipment, new technologies, etc., that strengthen the company and allow it to face competition and the risks inherent to its nature. Therefore, a financial culture is of great importance for entrepreneurs.

Every entrepreneur must grow; it's a satisfaction inherent in the business, but they must be cautious when analyzing several aspects, including the market. They must study the feasibility of their growth in relation to the demand for their product; if this growth is achieved with loans, they must anticipate future interest rate increases; they must also anticipate the personnel they will need to face the challenges that growth demands and have the capacity to solve them. While growth is a requirement for business sustainability, poor planning can lead to acute crises that are difficult to overcome.

A good businessman must organize his time and prioritize it. It is essential to maintain a precise and orderly agenda, as otherwise it creates chaos and disorder among his subordinates. That the executives of a company

Not knowing the when, where, and why creates mental disarray in the work group, which spreads to all employees. Every meeting with employees must have a date and time, and, if possible, a duration, and the points to be discussed must be clearly defined. This is independent of addressing unscheduled issues. Employees, for their part, must have their own agenda with the issues to be discussed. Unresolved or pending issues must be noted to later verify whether they have been resolved. Leaving a company's issues and programs in the dust opens the door to failure and disorder. Everyone must know what to do and the timeframe to achieve it.

The job of the entrepreneur and his or her employees is to maintain and improve productivity, which requires skill, perseverance, dedication, order, and constant monitoring. Improving the performance and efficiency of a company's people and machines must be a permanent objective. In the modern world, technology changes rapidly; therefore, it is essential to have an ongoing training program for all staff and executives, and to constantly update operating systems and equipment, otherwise, companies become obsolete and uncompetitive.

A highly complex aspect of this topic is the emotional balance essential for proper business management. Achieving this balance is very complex due to the internal and external factors that influence it. Below are some characteristics that, while not universally required, promote good business performance.

Health. An organized home life, exercise, and proper nutrition, among other things, contribute to a good mood and mental health.

Patience. Achieving goals isn't just a matter of time, but also of quality and opportunity. You have to push yourself, but always in moderation.

Order. In the car, at the desk, at the office. Mental order is reflected in physical order, and people perceive it and organize themselves.

Discipline. This is a virtue that is instilled in the workplace. Achieving goals and objectives on time and with quality, and fulfilling commitments and schedules, gives employees a sense of order and clear objectives.

Listen. We mustn't forget that we learn not by talking but by listening. Having collaborators who are better than oneself in specific activities is a quality of a great entrepreneur. They must be listened to in order to learn and also to understand the causes of what goes well or poorly in a company.

Tolerance. There is no such thing as a business owner or executive who doesn't make mistakes. We all make mistakes throughout our lives and work. Knowing how to measure, tolerate, and correct them is a fundamental task for every business owner.

Punctuality. Sticking to schedules and projects helps everyone in the company know what, how, and when things should happen, giving them a sense of order and rationality.

Efficiency. It's not about doing things quickly, but doing them all at once. time, well done in time and quality, and not having to repeat them due to errors.

Humanism. For a business owner, it's essential to treat employees honestly, openly, and fairly; to understand their problems; to support them in difficult times; to give them time to express themselves; to consider them as equals, with their strengths and weaknesses. All of this fosters a healthy and fresh relationship.

Strength of character. The employer must establish his authority over his employees and let them know what is expected of their ability and effort, for which they receive fair and adequate compensation. If they fail to achieve their work objectives because they are unable or unwilling to do so, he will take the necessary steps to replace them with someone who is capable and willing to do so.

Temperance. No company exists that doesn't go through times of crisis. Enduring these moments with strength and confidence is essential, and entrepreneurs must reflect that strength in their employees to give the company the time and drive it needs to withstand the tough times.

Being a leader means being hardworking, diligent, respectful, and knowledgeable about what needs to be done. All of this makes an entrepreneur a natural leader. Leadership isn't learned in books, lectures, or courses; it's achieved through knowledge and tenacity in what one does. When a boss knows what he's doing, does it well, and does it with confidence and consistency, his collaborators imitate him. Example is the leader's main tool in any activity in life. Doing what one does with honesty, ability, dedication, firmness, consistency, and perseverance, without failing, without dissembling, without lies, or demagoguery, turns every human being into a leader. In a company, every member must be a leader in their field. The best thing is to achieve leadership status: that's what a great company is all about.

Honesty isn't necessarily related to money and material goods; it's rather an attitude, a behavior, it's living according to one's own truths. And when these truths are applied in business activity, when the entrepreneur is an honest leader, he becomes an example to follow. He is an example not based on what he has but on what he "is": a leader by nature. Being responsible for and owning one's actions, being consistent with what one says and does, is what makes a true leader.

Businesses are built through hard work. Work is personal energy applied to a creative activity. Human beings are creative by nature, and creativity becomes real through work. Personal effort, expressed through work, is the essence of any entrepreneur.

Compliance with the law is vital in business. Those who fail to comply with current laws, including labor laws, do not have a sustainable business. The company must prosper, not at the expense of the law, but rather by complying with it; only then can it have a future.

Be fair to employees and consumers alike. All employees expect safety and well-being for themselves and their families.

When a company offers them that opportunity in exchange for their efforts, it receives greater commitment and dedication from them. The entrepreneur must recognize this and give each person what they deserve according to their ability and commitment. Similarly, consumers expect a good or service that is cost-effective. When a company meets that expectation, it acquires a loyal customer, and the market rewards that effort, establishing a fair relationship between both parties.

A company is not an isolated entity; it is an organism immersed in a social, political, and economic environment, and it must meet the expectations placed upon it, otherwise it loses sustainability and runs unnecessary risks. For this reason, entrepreneurs must be aware of their company's participation in these three realities.

This leads us to delve a little deeper into what a business is and what its economic, social, and political function is. Business is a way of organizing energy, directed toward the production of goods and services for the progress of humanity. Market energy is subject to many unforeseen events (a cyclone, lack or excess of rainfall, etc.). Approximately 10,000 years ago, humankind ceased to be nomads, gatherers, and hunters and began specialized and organized activities. Cities and states appeared, and human activity began to be channeled to maximize human energy for human subsistence and well-being. Agriculture and the domestication of animals began; products of immediate use such as clay pots began to be produced; metals, farm tools, carriages, and so on began to be manufactured. With this came the emergence of specialized workers in various artisanal activities, those responsible for delivering the products of the artisan guilds to those who needed them. And trade and commerce appeared. There were already food producers and producers of goods and services, entrepreneurs, and with them began to emerge the religious, political, and military forces that would accompany humanity, for better or worse, to the present day.

Even then, specialties and specialists began to emerge: the masters in charge of workshops and of perfecting and communicating knowledge. Various specialties were created, which would later require schools and books to disseminate their knowledge. Governments evolved from primitive forms, where the law of the strongest prevailed, to democracy, championed by that marvelous people, the Greeks, and later the Romans, who established Roman law, the great legislation that speaks of order and progress, and consolidated the value and relationships of common accord that would govern the history of humanity.

Since those times, property appears by legal right, not by the force. Previously, the right to property belonged to those who had the power.

It is from these times that the entrepreneur appears, with the right and the organization required to produce goods and services.

To organize something, anything, requires an organizing force, a driving force. For example, to transform raw materials into a usable good in a "cost-effective" way, meaning that the benefit exceeds the cost. When something is done that consumes more energy than it produces, it is not cost-effective, it is not profitable. The role of the entrepreneur, the businessperson, is to produce a good or service with a favorable cost-benefit ratio.

If the farmer produced less grain than he needed to eat, he would die of hunger. He must produce enough for himself and have a surplus for his family, as well as to obtain other goods and services he needs for his subsistence. The business is the same; it must produce enough to pay costs, expenses, and wages and have a surplus to continue producing. Thus, starting from these basic principles, the first entrepreneurs emerged, both in goods and services, and the first laws that regulated these activities. The first farmer was an entrepreneur, a businessman. The first artisan who transformed clay into something useful, into a vessel, was also an entrepreneur.

And so, over the centuries, businesses and governments evolved into the societies we know today.

One might ask: why is the entrepreneur, in some societies, the object of criticism?

Throughout history, social differences have existed, as there have always been those who have more and those who have less. Why? In capitalism, the answer is that each person develops according to their ability. In communism, the answer is that each person develops according to their needs. History has shown that free-market capitalist societies prospered, while communist societies, governed by the state that determines each person's needs, have failed.

The reasons are intrinsically related to the human spirit, which demands freedom, understood as respect for the inclinations, faculties and capacities of each being, having as its limit the freedoms and rights of others.

Every human being is free to choose his destiny according to his rights and obligations, and respect the rights of others.

And here arises what we call "business law," which exists in free-market systems. The Nordic countries—Norway, Sweden, Finland, Denmark—have achieved a society with profound respect for individual freedom, human rights, private property, the market economy, and entrepreneurs and governments. This isn't about unattainable ideals, but about tangible realities.

In what are known as developing countries, where the concepts of social justice are not as clear or as respected, business work is more complex. In these countries, information is manipulated by the

power groups, the education of its inhabitants is very poor, religious taboos are very consolidated, and social differences are very marked.

There is a monopoly on power, money, information, and the factors of production. In short, these are obstructed societies, where social injustice is notorious and the rule of law is deficient, resulting in great social instability.

In these countries, discontent is growing because the media has become internationalized and power groups are finding it difficult to control the situation because democratic forces are becoming more widespread. These people can fall into the hands of factional, demagogic politicians who offer the universality of wealth, taking it from those who have it and giving it to those who don't. But history shows that all they achieve is the universality of poverty, except for themselves and their loved ones.

But in the modern world it has been shown that it is thanks to business activity and the actions of honest politicians that the most prosperous, fair and healthy nations for all their citizens have been built.

This allows us to corroborate that entrepreneurs are an necessary entity in modern societies. And that when states have chosen to be the generators of wealth to distribute it fairly and have tried to forcefully equalize everyone, they have failed. State-owned enterprises lack spirit, for they suppress it by equalizing everyone in their capabilities—something impossible—which nullifies the entrepreneurial spirit, eliminating all creative force, which is the driving force any business requires to overcome the obstacles of the natural entropy of things and people that impede their progress and development.

Being an entrepreneur must begin by valuing that aspiration in its true dimension. It's more comfortable and secure to be a unionized employee or bureaucrat, receiving a fortnightly salary and enjoying the corresponding benefits, than to undertake something risking what little or much one has. It requires courage and a willingness to make the necessary efforts and sacrifices to achieve the desired goal.

Entrepreneurship should not be thought of as a privileged activity or superior to any other. Each of us chooses the path to achieve what we desire in life, and any job has the same dignity as entrepreneurial work. In art, in manual labor, in science, in teaching, and in the simplest of jobs, one can find the satisfaction and dignity that every human being requires to be at peace with themselves.

The real and tangible goal of human beings is the search for happiness. For some, this path may be entrepreneurship.

What is acompany's DNA?

Message to Grupo Xcaret

If we use the shape and composition of the DNA of all living organisms as a metaphor for explaining the behavior of acompany, we can formulate the following reflection.

When we look at the helical structure of DNA, we realize that it's made up of elements that are in turn made up of atoms, made up of particles whose most remote origin stems from the evolutionary process that began with the **Big Bang**. These particles vary among themselves due to their vibration and the sound derived from it. This is essentially coded information.

Information allows particles to form the atoms of all elements and all matter existing in the universe. Thus, particles, elements, and compounds contain within themselves the information required to create the reality that human beings perceive. The universe is "organized energy with information," and everything that exists is included in it, including ourselves: every organ in our body, every viscera, our nose, ears, eyes, arms, and legs—everything that constitutes us—is formed from the DNA passed on to us by our parents.

DNA is organized energy with specific information designed to achieve a purpose. The genes that make up DNA contain general information linked to the entire organism and specific information related to the form and function of each of its parts. This is how organisms function.

Now let's apply this idea to acompany and analyze the essence of what DNA is in it.

A company's DNA is the sum of all the necessary energies, organized with the required information, to achieve the objectives that its founders' mission and vision have given it to compete in the free market of products and services.

DNA contains the information that each worker needs to perform do your job well.

A company's functioning can be compared to that of a living organism. Let's take the human body as an example.

I.-The company's Board is like the brain of the company, which determines the company's mission and vision, its objectives and how to achieve them.

II.- Economic resources: the company's capital and available credit are like the blood that carries energy to all parts of the body.

III.-Collaborators are like the muscles of the body, responsible for the mobility required to achieve objectives.

IV.- Administration works like the glands and viscera of the body, generating the information or substances that keep the organism structured and orderly.

V.- The organizational chart is the map of the company's hierarchies and organization. Its chain of command, the catalog of functions, is its nervous system. The lines of command determine the flow of communication, just as in the human body's nervous system; everything is communicated to the brain to inform it of the state of the organism and its parts. The brain also uses this pathway to communicate its decisions; it is the brain that issues orders: walk!, grab! or think!

VI.- The audit is like the excretory system, which is responsible for purifying the system and discarding what does not work.

VII.- Administration and finance are like the heart, which circulates energy (money or blood) through the different organs that require it and control, measure and dimension it.

VIII.- The purchasing department is like the digestive system that acquires (feeds) the resources that the company requires to achieve its objectives.

We could continue the comparative process, but our goal is to explain that what makes the entire organization or company function is "information."

And information is the DNA of a company.

Knowledge, information about the current state of the company, and the detection of flaws, whether human or managerial, impact the achievement of its objectives as much as the life of an organization.

We can say that a company's DNA is the information it possesses and how it is used to achieve the objectives outlined in the "mission" and "vision" with which it was created.

In our case, Xcaret's "vision" was and continues to be ***unique in sustainable tourism recreation***.

What does this mean? It means offering visitors a unique "recreational tourism" experience. This vision has been defined since our inception, when we conceived Xcaret Park as a natural eco-archaeological, tourist, and aquatic space that offers a series of "unique" attractions, such as its underground rivers, its reef, and its coves. At the same time, visitors receive an immersive experience of Mexican culture and Mexican identity: its culture, its colors, its costumes, its music, its cuisine, its crafts, its history, as each day closes with the showing of Xcaret México Espectacular. At the same time, in the park, we showcase the regional fauna and flora and our deep respect for nature and the environment.

This offering of deeply meaningful experiences, present in both our parks and our hotels, is what makes us "unique" in the global tourism industry.

It is worth exemplifying this process when we introduced hotel services in Grupo Xcaret.

For the Constandse family, the hotel industry wasn't new, as we had already explored it through a previous partnership with Palace Hotels. By reclaiming a plot of land adjacent to Xcaret Park, I managed to convince our director, Miguel Quintana Pali, to build a hotel, on the condition that we wouldn't invest any of the Group's resources so as not to undermine our investments in the parks. This led us to partner with Spanish entrepreneurs to build and operate Hotel Flamenco Xcaret. The agreement, 70%-30% Spanish, included the acceptance of paying an entrance fee to the park for each person occupying a room. For various reasons, this experience wasn't convenient for us, but it demonstrated the Group's hotel potential.

Later, under a project led by my son, Marcos, and thanks to the participation of a good friend of mine, María Cristina Castro, a new land plan was achieved, opening up the Group's potential for hotel development. The vision of architects David Quintana and Marcos Constandse led to the development of the Xcaret Hotels project, which is now a successful reality.

Since the hotels were designed, their entire investment has been immersed in the "Spirit and DNA" of the Xcaret Group, along with its mission and vision. When we opened the first hotel, Xcaret Mexico, it was difficult to ensure that the Group's DNA was conveyed and accepted by the emerging hotel team. A crucial point in the hotels' successful decisions was to maintain the Group's mission, vision, DNA, and spirit. This was achieved because the new generation (David and Marcos) convinced us to invest much more than I had planned to generate a much higher quality hotel concept, on par with the parks we designed, which were already beginning to gain worldwide attention and recognition.

By making the decision to make the lodging experience "all fun inclusive" and incorporating in the rate the indiscriminate use of any of our parks (such as free access to Xcaret Park at Flamenco), we achieved a unique and unparalleled "tourist uniqueness" in the world (comparable only with Disney), which is one of the reasons for our hotel success.

Finally, the company's DNA—doing things right from the start—was properly understood and assimilated in the hotels, which has contributed to their enormous success.

This shows us that DNA is perfectly transferable from one company to another, as long as their mission and vision are aligned.

Today we are a model "service" company that aims to "make happy" its visitors and guests.

The concept of happiness is complex, I interpret it as a state of inner peace, serenity, sensory and spiritual pleasure, stimulation that

It brings joy. As for the Group's objective, I summarize it as "originality, quality, and service."

The company's DNA is reflected in the fact that every person, regardless of their position in the organization, does "the things they are responsible for well." The sum of "everything well done" constitutes the success of our company.

In other words, a company's DNA is "the knowledge each of us has to properly perform our role": knowing what to do, how to do it, and doing it well.

This collective knowledge, this knowledge each of us has about what we should do and the "will" to do it well, is what together constitutes the DNA of a company. If the cook, the waitress, the buyer, the supplier, the cleaner, the assistant, the dishwasher, and the chef of a restaurant correctly interpret their roles, the food, the atmosphere, and the service of that restaurant will be adequate and will achieve the goal of making diners happy.

Likewise, if each of the departments in the organizational structure contributes to harmonizing the internal and external activities of the group, then it will be possible to ensure that the whole "fulfills the mission and vision of the Group": complete customer satisfaction, which is what gives meaning to a service company.

From my perspective, modifying our mission to "create and share dreams" is unclear. Dreams are individual and created by oneself; no one can be forced to have one's dreams. However, ***making the planet happy*** is a clear and defined ideal to which we contribute by fostering happiness in Destino Xcaret's guests and visitors. This is our way of enabling the happiness of humanity. Although we cannot induce dreams in anyone, we can, through our creations, actions, and skills, produce moments of happiness in others.

The way to achieve "that coordination," that good execution of our functions in each department, is through "communication and training" of each of the collaborators in each area, of each company and of the Group, for which a precise catalog of functions is essential.

The DNA of a company lies in the sum of minds, in the knowledge of how to "do things right" that each of us possesses, and in having the ability, the desire, the love, to want to transmit it. This is where practical methods come in to achieve this: organizational charts, job definitions, clarification of hierarchies, operational catalogs, and ongoing training for new employees.

Now we understand that the DNA of the company is not something outside of us, it is ourselves with our minds and work that we transmit.

The DNA of the company, that which allows us to value ourselves and differentiate ourselves from other companies by doing what we do very well.

In addition to our own individual DNA, we also have that of the company. Our personal and family roots also include being better, each of us for ourselves, for our families, for our environment, for our country, etc.

This shows us that, just like a company's DNA, our own good DNA is the sum of the knowledge we have inherited and acquired from our families, our communities, our country, and our world, applied to doing things well.

I don't have good DNA just because of my company, because of Xcaret, I have good DNA because I do things well in "my own life." If I improve my DNA, I improve my own family, work, and social context, and in that way, I improve the world around me.

It can be very stimulating to think that even though my job may seem very simple, like collecting garbage, with my effort and dedication, doing it well, I'm doing my part to make the world more beautiful, and in that way, I'm contributing to the "happiness of all of us." That's the true DNA of acompany.

Our group, which maintains that DNA, that "mission and vision," and the "spirit" with which it was conceived, structured a trust that establishes the guidelines and directives to ensure the continuity of the founders' concept in the future. Preserving the "DNA and Spirit" of Xcaret guarantees its essence and permanence.

Maintaining "our quality and image" as a priority in our actions ensures the Group's continued success.

The concept of "Group Spirit" is often confusing. Defining "mission and vision" as a concrete way of objectifying what an organization's founders pursued when they created it is reflected in the organizational methods and systems required to achieve its objectives.

It is the DNA that must be structured so that the company operates, functions, configures, organizes, coordinates, etc., and meets its objectives. Returning to the metaphor of the human body, it is the physical structure of the organism: concrete, tangible, quantifiable, measurable, controllable, etc. of the entire organism.

The spirit of acompany is like the "soul" of a human being (composed of body and soul, matter and spirit). It is an intangible part of the company that cannot be materialized, measured, or legislated; it can only be "transmitted by example" and explained through concrete actions.

For example:

The group's sustainability is an image, an idea that the visitor "observes" in the way we connect with and respect the environment and nature.

The Mexican identity of the group is reflected in the architecture, the uniforms, the music, the crafts, the Xcaret México Espectacular **show**, the gastronomy, the charrería, the cemetery and in general in the entire treatment of the history and culture of our country, where the Group expresses "its spirit" of Mexicanness.

Uniqueness within the Group is expressed by offering customers a "unique" service that includes a destination that can be used in all its diverse options with a single rate.

The friendliness of service, derived from the traditional hospitality spirit of the Mayan people. The fact that most of our employees are from the peninsula, this traditional spirit has influenced all of us, so that we naturally have the desire to "serve people well."

The cleanliness and beauty of parks and hotels. This is an abstract concept, perceived intuitively. Xcaret is located on land that was originally intended **to be Xcaret**. Its natural conditions and the interventions of architect Miguel Quintana made the park what we see today, reflecting beauty, order, and cleanliness with full respect for the environment.

I've received more compliments on the cleanliness and attentiveness of the staff than on the park's concept itself. Cleanliness in the restrooms reflects many things visitors perceive: hygiene, safety, health, beauty, etc., which create positive moods that contribute to an intense experience.

The spirit of collaboration that is offered voluntarily, out of the conviction that it is the best for the company and therefore for each of us. Everyone's collaboration is what makes the parts "whole" and enables the efficiency of the whole. If I collaborate with the whole to the best of my ability, I contribute appropriately to the functioning of the **whole**. An example is seeing our director picking up cigarette butts and trash he finds on his way through the parks. Strictly speaking, he doesn't clean the parks; he sets an example of how one can help keep them clean.

The good spirits and happiness that employees reflect when they come into contact with the public are contagious. Let's not forget our mission to make the planet happy; happiness is contagious.

The drive to evolve. What makes **Xcaret Xcaret?** Knowing how to harness the potential of the land to make it more beautiful, more usable, more functional, more diverse—in other words, "change for the better." That's evolution, and it's an ever-ending journey. Xcaret Park continues to evolve, always doing so, and the Group, through its trust, guarantees this continuity.

Now, it's vitally important that we understand where or how this spirit was formed. While it's true that it must have originated in the spiritual sum of the worldview held by its founders, it's also something that, if it weren't "in each one of us," the collaborators, simply wouldn't exist.

Just as the spirit of the human being is universal, so is the spirit of a company, here we can say that "it is a dream that is shared" and that

It can only be spread by example. The spirit of Xcaret resides in all of us, who, with our work, dedication, and effort, make it a reality every day.

All human beings have the drive to evolve and change to become better every day: better citizens, better parents or children, better workers. It is our mission in this world and it is what we wish to share with the people we love.

The desire to be better is the only thing that can lead us to a "higher dream": to improve our community, our home, our work, not to please anyone, but to please ourselves. ***Being better*** isn't a corporate obligation; it's a personal choice. "I must be better for myself, for my family, for my own good, for a fundamental reason of humanity."

In this way, we see that if a company has a "spirit," it must invest in it, as it is essential for its success. The company must understand that its success depends on the success of all its members and collaborators, and at the same time, collaborators must understand that the company's success facilitates their own success.

In this way we understand what the Vision and Mission of our company are. company, as well as its DNA and its Spirit.

It all comes down to what we might call ***a combined will***: founders, partners, collaborators—we all integrate that combined force, and we contribute to making reality, not the dreams of others, but our own desires: peace, tranquility, serenity, well-being—what we all hope for, which, when shared, is much more enjoyable and fulfilling.

Marcos Constandse

Founding Partner
September 5, 2024

Memories of my childhood and youth*

Marcos Constandse

****This autobiographical note was developed from a text by María Fernanda García Sada, who will be the subject of a larger and independent edition in the near future***

Fat, ugly, stupid, and shy. These are the clearest perceptions I retain about myself from my childhood and youth.

Two early events in my life marked my tendency to remember difficult moments—where fear is present—more vividly than those that could have been happy. In the first, I see myself rolling down the stairs of a house we called "The Farm"; when I shared this with my mother many years later, she was shocked because the incident had happened when I was not yet a year old. Later, I find myself fascinated by a pond filled with fish, which I would shy away from in fear because my parents had warned us that going near it was dangerous, although I didn't fully understand the danger of such a wonderful thing.

I was born in 1940. These memories have been with me for over eighty years. Although I had a peaceful childhood, in elementary school I began to see myself as different from other children: I was fat, I had a big belly that the others didn't have, and that made me feel comparatively disadvantaged. On the other hand, from the first grade of elementary school on, I noticed some difficulty memorizing what I was studying. I reviewed concepts many times, but despite my efforts, I never got higher than tenth place on tests and exams. When I compared myself to the excellent children, I realized that their effort was much less than mine, and yet I couldn't catch up; I always finished between tenth and fifteenth. This experience slowly led me to the idea that I was dumber than the other students, as I lacked the intellectual capacity of those who achieved better grades with less effort. At the same time, my self-image deteriorated. I became shy and withdrawn, feeling uncomfortable interacting with my classmates or even with adults. Any rough or violent game unsettled me; witnessing a fight between children distressed me; I couldn't understand why one child could hit another. That, coupled with my lack of interest and skills in sports, isolated me even further and diminished the number of my already few friends.

The traditional Catholic education I received at home and at school became my support and escape from the hostile environment I encountered outside my home. The way I embraced the religious meaning of life involved believing that our time in the world was nothing more than

a test that God gave us to reward us with heaven or punish us with hell for all eternity.

With this idea in mind and heart, any adversity was minimized in the face of the prospect of achieving eternal happiness. I remember myself in prayer, weeping, thanking God for giving me the grace to have glimpsed the depth of this truth and to understand that in everyday life, amidst the bullying I was frequently subjected to, any suffering was nothing compared to the mission of saving my soul for eternity.

This was the context in which I spent my time in primary and secondary school. My shy and timid attitude allowed for the abuse I was frequently subjected to. I have some memories of being repeatedly hit on the head by a classmate with a handkerchief tied at one end. I remember playing with some apricot pits in the school hallways, while bullies came to kick and scatter the pits I had worked so hard to gather. I am also rewarded by the pleasant memory of the sweet bread they sold in the school store: particularly a braid of bread with honey or dulce de leche, which I always recall accompanied by a Coca-Cola.

I tried many sports, all with disastrous results. I remember two in particular that were so ingrained in me that they instilled a deep distaste for these activities. The first happened in elementary school when the sports teacher, aware that my belly was a problem for gymnastics or track and field and that I had difficulty running, put me in the goalie role on the soccer team. I was excited; the kids who played well were famous and popular. In my imagination, I could be one of them. The excitement didn't last long; in the first game, a player shot at goal, and I didn't react in time. The ball hit me in the face, and I lost consciousness. I fainted in the goal. When I regained consciousness, I was in the school infirmary, in pain and with my hopes dashed.

Years later, in high school, I tried my hand at basketball. I wasn't too bad at it, but once I accidentally hit a classmate in the face with the ball; he was one of the brawlers and most aggressive. He challenged me to a fight outside the school behind the front court, in a vacant lot where, by the way, a dog was roaming around and had once bitten me on the calf. Hence my fear of dogs, which lasted for years.

That afternoon, I decided not to attend the challenge, despite the immense shame I would face the next day. Word had spread, and a morbid interest in witnessing that boy destroy me had been aroused. After school, I headed home, six blocks from school.

Just as I was about to arrive, a friend drove by on a bus and yelled at me, "They're coming to pick a fight with you." Between the fear that they would come to my house and start a fight with my mom and the remorse for my cowardice in not having fought back, I retraced my steps, ready to confront him and his friends alone. It was a guaranteed beating. A block before I found them, a

My brother Oscar was with a friend who was very tall and strong, and he asked me why I was going back to school, to which I replied that I was going to meet the person who had challenged me and his three friends. He tried to convince me not to do it, but I, more confident in his presence and that of his friend, decided to go ahead.

I can't say it was a fight. I had no idea how to fight, and he was somehow a semi-professional at it. I only remember throwing punches. Suddenly, my brother's burly friend stopped the fight, everything calmed down, and I realized I wasn't feeling any intense pain. It happened—somehow—that the next day the attacker arrived with a black eye. One of my punches hit him in the face and hurt him.

I remember experiencing one of the most confusing feelings I've ever had in my life: a mixture of fear, regret, and happiness. The most notorious bully in school had been beaten by me. It generated a sense of sin for having hit another human being, and at the same time, pride, satisfaction, and joy for having stood up to him and removed one more shame from the life of the boy who was already entering his teens.

Over the years, it's become very difficult for me to recall the intensity of those emotions. Today, I realize I had a diminished, withdrawn personality, the product of a series of insecurities and inferiority complexes. On the one hand, I was very spoiled by my mother and protected by my teachers; on the other, I was belittled, harassed, and mistreated by my peers at school. I found refuge in religion (a source of great serenity and peace for me), in the love of my parents, and in the approval of my teachers, as solace and compensation for those physical and intellectual limitations that caused me a deep complex when I compared myself to my classmates and my social environment.

Around high school, we started traveling as a family to a ranch in Tabasco for the end of the year. At that time, it was a fairly isolated place. To get there, we took a bus to Alvarado. We slept there, and the next day we crossed the river to take a work train, an open-top train we called "the worm." The passengers sat on wooden benches perpendicular to the train's path. When it rained, which was common in that area, a tarp was lowered behind the passengers, so the train looked like a worm from above. We reached a wall in the afternoon, and from there we continued the journey on horseback to the ranch.

These weren't easy vacations for me: my brother and cousins were skilled riders, and I was afraid of horses; they were good at spinning tops, and I wasn't... and this was the case with all the activities we did in the countryside: I was always the last one to do them. During those vacations, we also started going to parties with teenage girls. The girls' consistent refusal to dance with me led me to the conclusion that, in addition to being fat, stupid, and shy, I was ugly. With that combination of feelings and complexes, I began my adolescence.

I must admit, however, that throughout that period of childhood and puberty, I spent many moments meditating or praying, during which I found a profound inner peace. For ten years, from the age of eight to 18, I went to confession at least once a year, as commanded by the "Holy Mother Church." In those confessions, there was nothing to be ashamed of; my daily life showed me that there was no sin in it, including the episode of the unexpected and fortunate blow to the eye from my bullying classmate.

In my reality, not everything was frustration, despair, anguish, or fear. There were many moments of peace, serenity, tranquility, and fulfillment when I felt my conscience was clear. Those moments were pleasant, but I entered adolescence with a deep social inferiority complex.

When I was 14, on my second-year high school subject list, there was one called Civics, taught by a teacher named Jorge Jiménez Cantú, a brilliant professor and aspiring politician. I never understood why it was removed from the curriculum. It addressed the rights and obligations of citizens, the state, civil life, and the ethical and moral values that should govern our lives in society.

I was in the same grade as my cousin Carlos Madrazo. We took Civics classes together. At the end of the year, we got the final exam for that subject. We printed 200 copies and sold them for 40 pesos each. The result: all four classes got ten points on the exam. This caused a commotion and suspicion that something strange had happened.

The school authorities subjected a very poor friend of ours, who was studying on a scholarship from the Institute, to psychological pressure. Under threat of having his scholarship revoked, which meant he would not be able to continue studying, he confessed to the people who had sold the exam.

For me, it was a terrifying moment. I saw my expulsion from high school coming, and although I could have gone to another private school, I knew what a tremendous disappointment it would be for my parents, who saw a model child in that shy, quiet, and well-behaved boy. The sadness would be especially for my mother, because I believe my father, in his great serenity, realized my limitations, which my mother never wanted to see. It would be tremendous... but nothing happened.

Fortunately for me, upon learning that we were the thieves, Professor Jiménez Cantú, who was aware of the important political position my uncle Carlos Madrazo already held, halted the repercussions of the incident. The professor prevented us from being expelled, proposed a new exam, and it was held. It was a tremendous experience for me to perceive that unjust world that, under certain circumstances, alters reality. I realized how certain interests and personalities influenced the consequences of some actions, in this case the political aspirations of our professor and my uncle's privileged position.

That moment opened a deep hole of uncertainty in my awareness of reality, coupled with the stay I had around that same time in Dos Bocas, Tabasco. That New Year's Eve, I accidentally couldn't attend the posadas and festivals in town, and I stayed alone at the ranch for a week. That time

meditation plunged me into a profound questioning of my worldview. It was a memorable end of the year, of enormous emotional and intellectual complexity.

Upon my return to school, entering third grade, I was beginning to become a different person than I had been. That winter at the ranch and the stolen exam combined to give me a kind of enlightenment moment. Something like what happens in the conversion of Saint Paul, the Roman soldier who, while persecuting Christians, falls from his horse, dazzled by a bright light from which Christ asks him: "Paul, why do you persecute me?" Paul experiences a moment of enlightenment and begins his journey to follow Jesus Christ as his disciple.

My first uncertainty wasn't social but religious. One of the strongest beliefs of my life up to that point was the infinite goodness of God. But I perceived a world of injustice around me. I was aware of the immense poverty in which many people lived and the many factors that caused suffering to humanity. I began to wonder how God, omnipotent and kind, could allow so much pain, and if it was necessary to earn heaven.

I remember that this anxiety tormented me both awake and asleep. I had based my life on the belief that I would save my soul so I could go to heaven when I died. But heaven could only be achieved by accepting the reality of human suffering. So much so that human pain became the reason I questioned the omnipotence of God. That God whose faith had been instilled in me by my family and at school, and who apparently couldn't or wasn't interested in avoiding people's pain.

There began a phase that would last three years: doubts, uncertainties, fears... and it became even more complicated when sexual desire became present. God had placed this intense need within me, but at the same time He forbade me from satisfying it. While I found some consolation in the fact that the negative experiences in every human being's life were a path to heaven, the fact that God would place the temptation of desire within me with such powerful intensity and at the same time forbid me from satisfying it seemed deeply disconcerting to me; I couldn't understand it.

I was starting high school. During those two years, I earned top grades and was extraordinarily happy. I felt an enormous sense of liberation and found in my connection to life the beginning of a process of self-realization and responsibility.

In my second year of high school, I had another experience, which, as childish as it may seem, was transcendent in my life. I had a teacher, Anfosi, who taught us math but also substituted for other subjects. One day, toward the end of the year, he gave us a morals class, which was actually a disguised religion, the central theme being the omnipresence and infinite goodness of God. Later, the same teacher taught a biology class in which he talked to us about the animals that live in the depths of the oceans.

He explained that they were divided into herbivores and carnivores, and that predators attack other fish to feed. Then I raised my hand and asked the teacher how he could understand the suffering of a marine animal that was injured or mutilated after an attack, when we had been taught that suffering is a test from God so that as human beings we earn heaven. What does God gain from the suffering of a mutilated animal at the bottom of the ocean? Both the teacher and my classmates laughed at my question, which remained unanswered. As I left the classroom, from the courtyard, I saw an image on the dome of a church and thought: "God is not what they taught me."

I remember a speech contest in high school where I won second place. I uttered a phrase that became a lifeline during that time of uncertainty in my life: "My greatest admiration goes to the human being who gets up every time he falls, not to the one who never falls and therefore doesn't require any effort to get up."

I had begun to relate to the female sex in a unique way. I loved being with a woman, and it became the great passion of my life for the next ten years, from the age of 18 to 28.

What I said in the contest was related to my own life. At that time, I constantly felt guilty, and even though I repented afterward, I couldn't help but do it again. That tormenting process of confessing after each affair led me once to the Altillo Parish, led by priests of the Holy Spirit, where a priest told me: "Stop tormenting yourself and live according to your impulses. God, who loves you, will call you back when the time is right." That advice freed me from guilt and allowed me to live my sexual life without that burden.

On the other hand, having good grades and being among the top ten students in school despite studying much less (I still don't understand why), my circle of friends expanded to include a couple of friends who didn't share my strict religious upbringing and for whom my tortured relationship between sex and religion was incomprehensible. They made me feel much freer despite being in the same religious school. And this feeling grew when I entered UNAM. At the university, I began to learn about multiple perspectives on religion and spirituality from teachers and classmates. There, I discovered freedom of thought.

From that moment on, I definitively moved away from the traditional religious upbringing I'd been raised in. And although I made the mistake of distancing myself from God and all spiritual concerns, this also liberated my sex life and allowed me to make it and my work the guiding principles of my life until I was 28.

My university experience introduced me to a profoundly liberal world. I admit that the university's open spirit excited me immensely. It was the best thing that could have happened in my life at the time, but it wasn't all easy.

The first year, with the momentum I had, I passed reasonably well. But I'm not sure whether at the beginning of the second or third year, I fell into a crisis, not knowing how to simultaneously juggle my school obligations and the option of living life to the fullest. I fell in love with a prostitute, María Elena. There was a stark contrast between her sweetness of character and the harshness of her profession. I dropped out of school and dedicated myself to her. I believed I would protect her from that world I discovered of indecipherable cruelty and rudeness.

I have no idea how I survived those three months doing the terrible things I did for that relationship, but my father noticed.

One morning, I arrived as usual at 4 or 5 in the morning, and he called me. I was lying down. He said, "I see you want to live

like a grown man, that you're in love with a woman. That you've started drinking and smoking. That you have a desire to live like an independent man, and that maybe it's time for you to do so."

Therefore, tomorrow when you wake up, you're leaving the house to live with that prostitute to satisfy your desire for an independent life, with the values you now believe in. This doesn't mean we're breaking off relations with you. You can come back whenever you like, but I don't intend to support you in the life of a grown man you've chosen.

—And how am I going to live?

—Women in your profession support their husbands or boyfriends.

I remember that night as one of the most stormy of my life. My father, always peaceful and balanced, confronted me with reality and saved me from falling. I knew he was right, but I felt deeply unhappy.

I remember that around that time, I had a friend who came every day to a studio I had built in my parents' house. I still consider him the best friend of my life. I waited for him to arrive to talk to him, and I realized I was losing my life's direction at that moment. He showed me the notes from the classes I had missed and told me how I could catch up.

I waited for my father to tell him I wasn't leaving, that I was determined to end that relationship and that lifestyle, and that I was returning to school to catch up on my studies with the help of my friend.

That was the most difficult time of my youth. I remember the fights, the wickedness of those people, and I don't understand how I survived. Yes, there was one person who has intrigued me my whole life. He was one of the most famous pimps in Mexico. He had a scar on his face from a broken glass wound in the middle of a fight. For some reason I never understood, he took me under his wing, and thanks to that, I survived that dark period.

I was able to get through that and then learn to combine my studies with my relationships. That was probably when I discovered love. There were multiple attempts at falling in love. On one occasion, years later, I found a notebook with more than 30 names of girls who were my girlfriends or lovers during my college days, or in

The next four years, until I got married. Whether there were many relationships or not, I can't define. I remember several of them with emotion and nostalgia, two in particular of great significance. I had a girlfriend: Luz María, whom I called "Spanish girl" because she was the daughter of Spaniards. She had a beauty that's hard to describe: blonde, blue eyes, a zest for life, clear and defined values... but I made the mistake of simultaneously maintaining another relationship. Yolanda was my lover; she was there during my student days, through thick and thin, during the joyful life I led, or encouraging me to study, to finish my degree, to improve myself. She generated a vital drive in me and a sexual attraction that I couldn't extinguish until she disappeared from my life. My girlfriend ended the relationship with me. I still retain the feeling of fulfillment and enthusiasm that the presence of both of them, my girlfriend and my lover, gave me. Thanks to the encouragement another friend gave me to take private

lessons together in the subject of bridges (the only one I hadn't passed on the regular exams), I was able to graduate before May 10th and present my mother with her engineering degree on that date.

My memories from my early days of work are many. But I can say that they are all related to the discovery of how work can perform miracles, as it helped me spiritually free myself from a still very limited worldview and desire for life.

When I started working in my fifth year of college, I discovered a natural fascination with work, not only for the work itself, but for the responses it generated. Since I tried to do my job well because I was passionate about it, I learned the trade of a builder.

As I built, I rebuilt my internal world of values. I began to realize the value of perseverance at work, how I could do the job better than the people around me, how I earned the respect of my colleagues and sometimes even their admiration.

For the first time, I felt what it was like to be respected and admired for something concrete: the results of my work. I discovered that doing things well opened up new horizons and generated new perspectives.

As children, my brother Oscar and I imagined ourselves as independent engineers. Later, we shared this dream with Carlos, our other brother, seven years younger than me. Although that age gap meant a generational gap, the idea of working together and being independent was always present.

As an adult, I had to start learning somehow, so my first job was among friends. I started by participating in two construction projects with two friends who taught me how to work. Then my uncle Carlos Madrazo, my mother's cousin, got me a job on a monumental construction site: Nonoalco, Tlatelolco. I started as a supervisor, knowing almost nothing about buildings, and little by little I rose through the ranks thanks to my dedication, effort, and will to do things well. Then my brother Oscar and I decided to open our company at a politically favorable time: we got a contract to introduce

drinking water systems in small towns with fewer than two thousand inhabitants, where the Ministry of Water Resources had no involvement. The Ministry of Health and Welfare, through the Construction Commission headed by Joaquín Álvarez Ordóñez, gave us the assignment. The architect Álvarez Ordóñez was an honest politician whom I greatly admired.

Over the course of seven years—from 1965 to 1972—we brought drinking water to 800 villages, an average of 115 villages per year. With Carlos's help, Oscar and I traveled from town to town in every state of the country. I remember driving more than 100,000 kilometers a year and using up nearly ten vehicles during that time.

But my fundamental experience was that—except for every two weeks, when I returned to Mexico City for a weekend to party with my friends, since I already had money, a car, and everything—I drove alone through all those towns. That allowed me to experience the deepest Mexico of the Ixtlera region, the Highlands of Chiapas, the Sierra de Puebla. I got to know some of the poorest towns in Mexico. I experienced firsthand the misery, the poverty, and the sadness, the history of those abandoned towns, many without schools, electricity, or any infrastructure. Where children walked for miles to go to school, and women walked for miles to carry a bucket of water home.

This experience of living alone, traveling the roads, sleeping on highways, eating in village restaurants or buying cans of sardines and bread at grocery stores, sleeping in town halls or hotels with rags for doors, and living daily with the people of those towns radically changed my perception of the world. The privileged middle-class atmosphere I had always lived in, so distant and alien to the real poverty of my country, faded away. This motivated me to convince my friend Oscar Villarreal, then director of Agua Potable and an honest politician, to pay a minimum wage to the community workers who participated in the projects we developed. Until then, voluntary cooperation was required from the residents, some of the poorest in Mexico, to provide labor and materials to carry out the projects in their towns or localities.

My efforts made it possible to include in the costs the payment of a minimum wage per worker for the communities that collaborated on our projects. I remember this initiative as one of my first meaningful social initiatives, one of the most valuable in my life, as I poured all my experience and management skills into it.

I'll never forget one occasion when the then-governor of Chiapas called us and scolded us because we were paying the minimum wage to the Indigenous people of the Chiapas Highlands, and the landowners and ranchers had complained that we were ruining them. We ignored him and risked continuing to pay them.

Here I must mention another woman who was very important to me and with whom I established a relationship that would last two years. She appeared

in my life when the story with Luz María and Yolanda ended. It was a very complex and difficult relationship, passionate and sophisticated at the same time. She was a divorced woman from a very worldly life, financially supported by an immensely wealthy ex-husband who allowed her to live a life of excesses that I had never known before. It was a dangerous, difficult, and exciting experience that I enjoyed and suffered intensely. It was on the verge of becoming a tragedy, because when we decided to end things, she tried to commit suicide, although fortunately she didn't succeed. She moved on with her life, and I moved on with mine.

At 28, I experienced a turning point in my life, the most significant, because it was then that I met the woman who is still my wife today on a strange trip I took to Brazil. In her, I found the qualities I had always sought in a life partner.

Fortunately for me, the world of complexes and insecurities in which I had grown up was being left behind the moment he appeared. Inna in my life. In Rio de Janeiro, where my friend Nicolás and I had gone to experience the carnival in all its intensity, was where I met her through a curious circumstance.

When we discussed with the hotel concierge how difficult it was to approach Brazilian women during Carnival celebrations, he recommended that we approach a foreigner instead, perhaps an American.

The next day, walking along the sidewalk outside the Copacabana Hotel, I heard two girls speaking English. I approached them and asked if they were American. They replied no, that they were Brazilian, but that they liked speaking English.

Things weren't going well, but I remembered I had four tickets in my pocket to go to the municipal dance, the most important culmination of the Carnival festivities, for which it was already almost impossible to get tickets. Their attitude changed, and they agreed to go with us to the municipal event.

It was a crowd that was impossible for me to understand, everyone standing still, dancing tightly packed together with an infernal noise that quickly stunned me. So I suggested we go out to dinner to Inna, and she accepted, while our two friends stayed at the carnival dance. We walked and talked to a restaurant on the beach. Before dinner, I realized I was discovering the most serene and peaceful spirit I'd ever met, and that she was the woman I wanted for myself.

The daughter of Russian parents, Inna fled Kharkov, Ukraine, a week after her birth, facing the threat of the Nazi army. For two years, they traveled in a wagon through several Eastern European countries trying to escape the war. They finally arrived in Landek, Austria, to a refugee camp run by the Americans, where they lived for five years until Inna's father received a job offer in Brazil. He was a prestigious electromechanical engineer specializing in hydroelectric power and a professor at Moscow University. He moved with his wife and three children.

Inna, now seven years old, traveled to the South American country. They would live there for the next 20 years before my arrival at the carnival.

After a series of events, I returned to Mexico, ending the relationship I'd left behind here and my life of partying. Months later, in August, I tried to reach Inna by phone, and she finally sent me a telegram saying she'd be passing through Mexico for a week en route to Paris. I remember thinking, "This time I won't lose you."

As she got into the car, she calmly agreed to let us go to the Air France office to cancel her ticket to Paris. A few days later, a letter arrived from her father urging her not to continue on to Paris. At that moment, like a veiled marriage proposal, I said, "Your father is right. We're going to Brazil to sort this out."

When we arrived at the São Paulo airport, the family was waiting for us. I got in her brother's car, and Inna got in another car with her parents. On the way, she told them she'd decided to marry me and that she wasn't asking their permission. They had planned for her to marry the son of a Russian friend who lived in France. By the time we got home, they already knew. Now calmer and more resigned, they accepted the engagement, we set a date, and in November 1968 we were married. I consider Inna and I dating for three days in Rio and the day she arrived in Mexico and we canceled her ticket to Paris. Everything that would happen next was crystal clear to us. A marriage that lasted more than 55 years. I can say with absolute certainty that in all that time, I only remember one occasion when I saw Inna angry with me. I spent weeks away from home on work projects, and she never once complained or seemed uncomfortable or suspicious about it. My entire life, I've had a practical, intelligent, balanced, and loving partner. And I devoted myself intensely to my family and my work. A situation that would continue until my retirement in 2011.

However, it wasn't all sunshine and rainbows. As I got married, had children, and achieved business success, a restlessness and dissatisfaction began to grow within me. I couldn't define what it was. I discussed it with my wife and said, "Why, if I have you, whom I love deeply, my children, my siblings, my mother, I have businesses, and I'm financially successful? If I'm so successful and doing so well, why do I feel this existential anguish? What's missing from my life?"

Before I got married, the intense alienation of my emotional and professional life took up all my energy, but once I calmed down and dedicated myself to my family and work, I couldn't make sense of that existential emptiness. Even in my marriage, I tried to find a worldview that would give me inner peace because I didn't understand what was happening to me.

It was then that this new spirit of Marcos—optimistic, joyful, satisfied, confident, in love, who loves his children—would also begin a search that spanned more than 20 years, eager to understand the world around me and my inner world. In it, my humanistic and spiritual concerns

They introduced me to philosophy, anthropology, sociology, psychology and the arts in their various manifestations. There I found great teachers, wonderful teachings and experiences that gradually shaped me.

I now understand that I made a mistake by abandoning religion and God with it. I never held a grudge against the Catholic Church. All the priests and religious figures I met in my childhood, adolescence, and early youth were kind, polite, and affectionate. Nor did I hold any grudges toward the faith or religion I was taught. But my mistake was confusing the religious practices and traditions instilled in me during my upbringing with God, and by abandoning them, I also abandoned the idea of God.

I turned 72 in 2012, and upon my retirement, I delegated all my business interests to my children. Since then, I've been interested in sharing my worldview with others in various ways. Taking as a starting point the book "***I Am We***," which I wrote years earlier, in 2020 I created the Gardens of Evolution and Meditation in the public park in Cancún, where, through monumental panels crafted in Venetian mosaic, I convey my vision of the evolution of the universe and the six major world religions in a journey.

When I reconciled myself with the idea of God and the Absolute, I found the path to the peace of mind I strive to live today. I share my experience of this search in my latest book, ***And the Best Is Yet to Come!*** This publication and this present book, ***The Art of Being an Entrepreneur***, are driven by the desire for my worldview to transcend.

The third edition of

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